

BAPS SAP Style Guide

Editorial, design, and production conventions

For BAPS Swaminarayan Aksharpith publications
in Sanskrit, Gujarati, Hindi, and English

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BAPS Swaminarayan Aksharpith

Ahmedabad

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BAPS SAP Style Guide

Welcome to the in-house style guide for the BAPS Swaminarayan Aksharpath (SAP) publishing team. SAP publishes books, magazines, newsletters, and other literature predominantly in Gujarati, English, and Hindi for a general *sat-sangi* readership.

Most of our English-language work consists of **translations from Gujarati source texts**. Smaller proportions involve Sanskrit material (typically scriptural verses and commentaries embedded in larger Gujarati→English projects) and Hindi material (similarly embedded). A significant body of work is also written **originally in English**.

This site documents the editorial, design, and production conventions for all of that – across Sanskrit, Gujarati, Hindi, and English material. It does **not** cover general English grammar (Garner / Fowler / CMS handle that), but the recurrent patterns SAP editors fix in BAPS manuscripts — Indian-English usages, Gujarati-translation calques, devotional-register issues — are documented in Part 11 Common Editorial Pitfalls.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Use the search bar (top right, or press ) to find a rule or term quickly. Browse the navigation tabs above to read sections in order. Found something out of date or unclear? See Feedback – one click sends an email to the maintainer.

I Need To...

Common entry points organized by task, not topic:

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Recently Updated

Hand-curated; full history in the Changelog.

- **2026-05-13** – Quick Find A–Z index added; long chapters split into focused pages (Editorial now 14 chapters instead of 9).
- **2026-05-13** – Left sidebar now shows every numbered subsection (`toc.integrate` enabled).
- **2026-05-13** – Reversed the *i.e.* / *e.g.* trailing-comma rule to follow BrE convention (see 3.12.7).
- **2026-05-13** – Footnote dash exception clarified for the spaced en dash (see 3.11.2).
- **2026-05-13** – *Earth* / *earth* expanded with theological-context examples (see 3.3.2.3).

Sections at a Glance

Foundational Concepts

Romanization, anglicization, translation, and transliteration – the four terms the rest of this guide depends on.

→ Concepts

Translation & Transliteration

When to translate, when to transliterate, and when to use the OED.

→ Translation rules

Editorial

Tone, capitalization, italics, plurals, quotation marks, and punctuation for prose across our publications.

→ Editorial conventions

Tithis

The 16 named days of the lunar fortnight – *Padvo*, *Bij*, *Ekadashi*, *Punam*, *Amas* – and the *sud* / *vad* fortnight designators. Roman, capitalized, no italics, no diacritics.

→ Tithis rule

Diacritics

The SAP rule (no diacritics in general text) and the in-house macron-only convention for glossary work.

→ Diacritic rules

InDesign

Paragraph styles, master pages, and production patterns for our long-form publications.

→ [InDesign conventions](#)

EPUB Accessibility

Alt text writing, Articles panel hygiene, and reading-order standards for accessible EPUBs.

→ [EPUB guidelines](#)

Scripts & Tools

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→ [Scripts reference](#)

Workflows

File versioning rules, naming conventions, and production handoff patterns.

→ [Workflow conventions](#)

Open Discussions

Conventions the team has not yet settled – Sanstha names, mandir names, gurus, transliteration choices, and more.

→ [Open questions](#)

Common Editorial Pitfalls

Indian-English usages, Gujarati-translation calques, and devotional-register issues [SAP editors](#) fix recurrently in [BAPS manuscripts](#).

→ [Pitfalls](#)

Core Principles

Three rules underpin everything else in this guide:

1. **Consistency over cleverness.** A reader should encounter the same term, the same diacritic, the same heading style every time. Where this guide and instinct disagree, follow the guide and propose an edit if it's wrong.
2. **Versioning is non-negotiable.** Every file output – script, Word doc, Excel, PDF – gets an incremented version number in the filename and an internal version string. Never overwrite. See versioning rules.
3. **Accessibility is editorial.** Alt text, reading order, and structural markup are not technical afterthoughts – they are part of the writing. See EPUB accessibility.

Recently Updated

The “last updated” date at the bottom of every page reflects the most recent commit. Major changes to conventions are recorded in the changelog.

Contributing

This guide is maintained collaboratively by the BAPS DTP team. Anyone on the team can suggest changes – see Feedback to send a note to the maintainer.

Quick Find — A–Z Topic Index

A flat alphabetical index of every rule in this guide. Use it when you know the topic but not the section number. Each entry deep-links to the rule.

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This index is maintained by hand. If a rule is missing or has moved, send a note via [Feedback](#).

1 Foundational Concepts

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

A handful of technical terms from linguistics underpin the rest of this guide. Understanding them prevents confusion when rules pull in different directions – for example, when the same word is *anglicized* in one place but *transliterated* in another, the reasons follow from these definitions.

1.1 Romanization

Romanization is the conversion of writing from a different writing system to the Roman (Latin) script (alphabet). One method of romanization is transliteration. Romanization enables the casual reader who is unfamiliar with the original script to pronounce the source language reasonably accurately.

For most language pairs (e.g. Gujarati–English), building a usable romanization involves trade-offs, as the source language usually contains sounds and distinctions not found in the target language, but which must be represented for the romanized form to be comprehensible.

1.2 Anglicization

Anglicization is the modifying of non-English words, names and phrases to make them easier to spell, pronounce or understand in English. It refers to the respelling of non-English words, often to a greater extent than in romanization. **Anglicized words are listed in English dictionaries.**

WHY THIS MATTERS EDITORIALY

If a word appears in the OED, it is anglicized: spell it as the OED spells it, do not italicize it, do not add diacritics. *Dharma*, *dal*, *puri* are anglicized – so they’re set in roman, not italic. See the Translation & Transliteration Guide.

1.3 Translation

Translation is the process of converting the meanings of written or spoken words or text from the source language into the target language using the words and grammar of that target language. The focus lies totally on conveying the original meaning of the source language text so that it can be understood by those who use the target language.

A comprehensive translation will consider the grammar, syntax and local culture during the conversion process so that the final document reads as if a native speaker wrote it.

Translation does not, however, help a person know how to pronounce the words in the source language.

1.4 Transliteration

Transliteration is the conversion of text written in a script (*lipi*) in the source language to the alphabet (script / *lipi*) of the target language, expressing how the words of the source language are pronounced. There is no change in grammar or meaning.

Transliteration does not help a person understand the meaning of the words, but it helps to pronounce them. Transliteration is useful for people who are well-versed with speaking a language, but are unfamiliar with that language’s alphabet and so cannot read that language in its original script. For SAP publications, transliteration involves romanization of words.

The challenge of transliteration comes when there is no equivalent character in the target language to express the sound in the source language. Another difficulty is that the “correct” pronunciation is hard to determine or convey because of the many dialects and other idiosyncrasies of the source language.

Transliteration may be considered a subset of translation, since untranslatable words may be transliterated and incorporated in the body of translations.

1.5 How These Terms Relate in Our Work

PROCESS	WHAT CHANGES	READER GAINS
Translation	Words and grammar	Meaning
Transliteration	Script only	Pronunciation
Romanization	Script → Roman alphabet	Approximate pronunciation in a familiar script
Anglicization	Spelling, often pronunciation	Word becomes part of English

A typical SAP page may contain all four at once: a translated narrative (translation), with embedded *italicized non-English terms* (transliteration / romanization) and a few *dharma, guru, yoga* (anglicization).

1.6 Where These Rules Apply

- Translation & Transliteration Guide – the rules that flow from these concepts (when to translate, when to transliterate, when to use the OED spelling).
- Editorial – Italics – the formatting consequence (italicize transliterations, leave anglicized words in roman).
- Diacritics & Transliteration – how we render long vowels and unfamiliar consonants in transliteration.

Translation

2.1 Translation & Transliteration

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Rules for translating from Gujarati, Sanskrit, or Hindi into English – and for deciding what to translate, what to transliterate, and what to leave anglicized.

Most SAP English work is translated from Gujarati source texts. Sanskrit material – typically scriptural verses and commentaries – is usually embedded in larger Gujarati→English projects; Hindi material is similarly embedded. A significant proportion of work is also written originally in English.

For the underlying definitions, see Foundational Concepts.

2.1.1 Pages in This Section

- Translation Rules – when to translate, when to transliterate, when to anglicize

2.1.2 At a Glance

WORD TYPE	FORM	ITALICS?	DIACRITICS?
In the OED (anglicized)	OED spelling	No	No
Personal/place name	SAP transliteration, no diacritics	No	No
Title of a work	Use the official English title if one exists; otherwise transliterate	Italics for books/periodicals	No (in titles)
Other Indic term	SAP transliteration	Yes (italics)	Per project (verses may use diacritics; see Diacritics)

For the formatting consequences, see Editorial – Italics, Plurals, and Quotation Marks.

2.2 Translation Rules

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

The rules below apply to all SAP English publications.

2.2.1 Core Principles

- Translations should be in **clear, idiomatic English**. Instead of a word-for-word translation, try to match the tone and flow of the original text. Translate so that readers are not confused.
- Use **English-language punctuation**.
- Consult the SAP Word List / glossary for preferences among common spellings. If a word is not in the list, transliterate it according to the conventions in this guide.

2.2.2 When to Anglicize (use OED Spelling)

- If a suitable **anglicized term exists** for a word, use it.
- Words found in the **Oxford English Dictionary** should be spelled as they appear there. They should have **no diacritics**, nor should they be **italicized** – for example: *dharma*, *dal*, *puri* are all set in roman, no diacritics.

VARIANT SPELLINGS IN THE OED

There are cases where there is not one settled spelling for the Indic word. Examples:

- *chapatti* / *chapati*
- *laddu* / *laddoo* / *ladoo*
- *lehnga* / *lehenga* / *lengha*
- *maharani* / *maharanee*

Pick one and apply it consistently. Where SAP has a house preference, the SAP Word List records it.

2.2.3 Titles of Works

For titles of books, magazines, poems, and other works:

1. Check whether the work has an **official English translation**. If so, use that title.
2. If not, **do not translate** the title – use a **transliteration**.

2.2.4 Place Names

Place names with accepted English spellings should be spelled in accordance with English norms. Examples:

- Mumbai
- Kolkata
- Kanpur

- Chennai

This rule also applies to **cities of publication in citations**.

2.2.5 Names of Prominent Figures

SAP follows accepted English spellings for names of prominent figures, historical or contemporary.

Non-English names of prominent political or cultural figures are spelled according to the SAP transliteration system, but **without diacritics**. Examples:

- Ramanujan
- Mahatma Gandhi
- Sachin Tendulkar

2.2.6 Quick Decision Tree

```

Is the word in the OED?
├─ Yes → Use the OED spelling. Roman, no italics, no diacritics.
└─ No
    └─ Is it a personal name, place name, organization, or title?
        ├── Yes → SAP transliteration, no diacritics, roman, initial caps as appropriate.
        │       See Editorial - Italics.
        └─ No → SAP transliteration, italicized on first use,
                diacritics per project (see Diacritics).
```

2.2.7 See Also

- Italics rules – the formatting consequence of these decisions.
- Quotation marks for translations – how to present a transliteration alongside its translation.
- Open discussions: Transliteration – unresolved transliteration choices that the team is still discussing.

Editorial

3.1 Editorial

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Conventions for prose across BAPS publications – how we sound on the page, how we capitalize, how we punctuate, what we italicize, and how we form plurals.

For when to translate vs transliterate vs anglicize, see Translation Rules. For the foundational definitions, see Foundational Concepts.

3.1.1 Pages in This Section

- Tone & Voice – the register and personality of our prose
- Capitalization – when to capitalize titles, terms, and proper nouns
- Title Case in Detail – the full title-case rules
- Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization – the four-rule system for BAPS-specific reverential designations
- Italics – italicizing transliterated terms; what to leave roman
- Plurals – native plurals vs anglicized plurals
- Numbers – when to spell out, when to use numerals
- Quotation Marks – presenting an Indic term alongside its English translation
- Punctuation – dashes, ellipses, *such as*, Oxford comma
- Footnotes – placement of the superscript number relative to surrounding punctuation
- Abbreviations & Acronyms – periods, plurals, *i.e.* / *e.g.* / *etc.*
- Vertical Lists – bullets, numbering, parallel construction
- Apostrophes & Possessives – possessives, plurals of letters, apostrophe of omission
- Citations & References – CMS Notes–Bibliography style for books, articles, websites, scriptures, and BAPS-specific sources

Common errors to avoid (Indian-English, Gujarati-translation calques, devotional-register issues) now live in their own Part — see 11 Common Editorial Pitfalls.

3.1.2 Quick Reference

QUESTION	SHORT ANSWER
Italicize <i>dharma</i> ?	No – it’s anglicized (in <u>OED</u>). Italicize only non- <u>OED</u> Indic terms.
Italicize <i>Bhagwan Swaminarayan</i> ?	No – personal name. Roman, initial caps.
Italicize an Indic term inside quotation marks?	No.
Diacritics in headings?	No.
Plural of <i>rotlo</i> ?	<i>rotla</i> (native) or <i>rotlos</i> (the <i>s</i> takes the format of the word).
Plural of <i>pandit</i> ?	<i>pandits</i> (anglicized – follow <u>OED</u>).
Oxford comma?	Yes, always.
Single or double quotes?	Double for direct speech and quotations; single for quotes within quotes.
Em dash or en dash?	en dash (–) for parenthetical breaks and for ranges.

3.1.3 British vs American English

As SAP is a publishing house based in India, the majority of print publications use **British English**, though work submitted by authors from America is often published using American English. This British–American distinction is usually limited to spelling, punctuation and format conventions, because the subtle nuances of the many other grammatical differences between BrE and AmE are not always apparent to our untrained authors and editors.

SCOPE

This section covers English editorial style. Gujarati and Hindi editorial conventions follow the practices of our respective language teams; cross-language rules (transliteration, diacritics, term selection) are documented in *Diacritics & Transliteration* and *Translation & Transliteration*.

3.2 Tone & Voice

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

DRAFT PAGE

This page is a placeholder. Expand it as the team agrees on conventions, or propose specific guidance via Feedback.

3.2.1 What We're Aiming For

Our editorial voice is **clear, respectful, and serviceable**. We write to convey meaning, not to impress. We use plain English where plain English suffices, and reach for specialized vocabulary only when it earns its place.

3.2.2 Suggested Principles (to Be Discussed)

- **Prefer concrete to abstract.** 'Bhagwan Swaminarayan walked from Loj to Mangrol' is stronger than 'Bhagwan Swaminarayan undertook a journey of considerable distance'.
- **Respect the reader's time.** A short sentence beats a long one when both convey the same idea.
- **Translate, don't transliterate, when meaning is at stake.** Use *aksharbrahma* with a brief gloss on first mention; rely on the reader to remember it after that.
- **Avoid honorific inflation.** Where the source text uses a single honorific (e.g. *Shri*), don't compound it in translation.

3.2.3 Usage and Idiom

A small set of idiomatic choices that recur in our prose.

3.2.3.1 *at* vs. *in* with Place Names

Use ***at*** for towns or smaller specific locations in narrative prose:

- ✓ in the house ***at*** Jhinjhavadar
- ✓ bathe in the sea ***at*** Mangrol
- ✗ in the sea in Mangrol (*awkward and imprecise*)

in is correct for larger regions or country-level scope: *in Gujarat, in India*.

3.2.3.2 *detachment from*, not *detachment towards*

The English collocation is *detachment from*^{**}:

When we realize the perishable nature of our own body, our relations, and all objects of sense gratification, we easily develop **detachment from** them.

Detachment towards is not idiomatic English.

3.2.4 Open Questions for the Team

- How do we handle direct discourse from Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Aksharbrahma Gunatitanand Swami, and the gurus? Reverent capitalization? Italics? Quotation marks?
- What's our default audience – devotee or general reader? Do different publications shift this?
- How do we balance scholarly and devotional registers in the same publication?

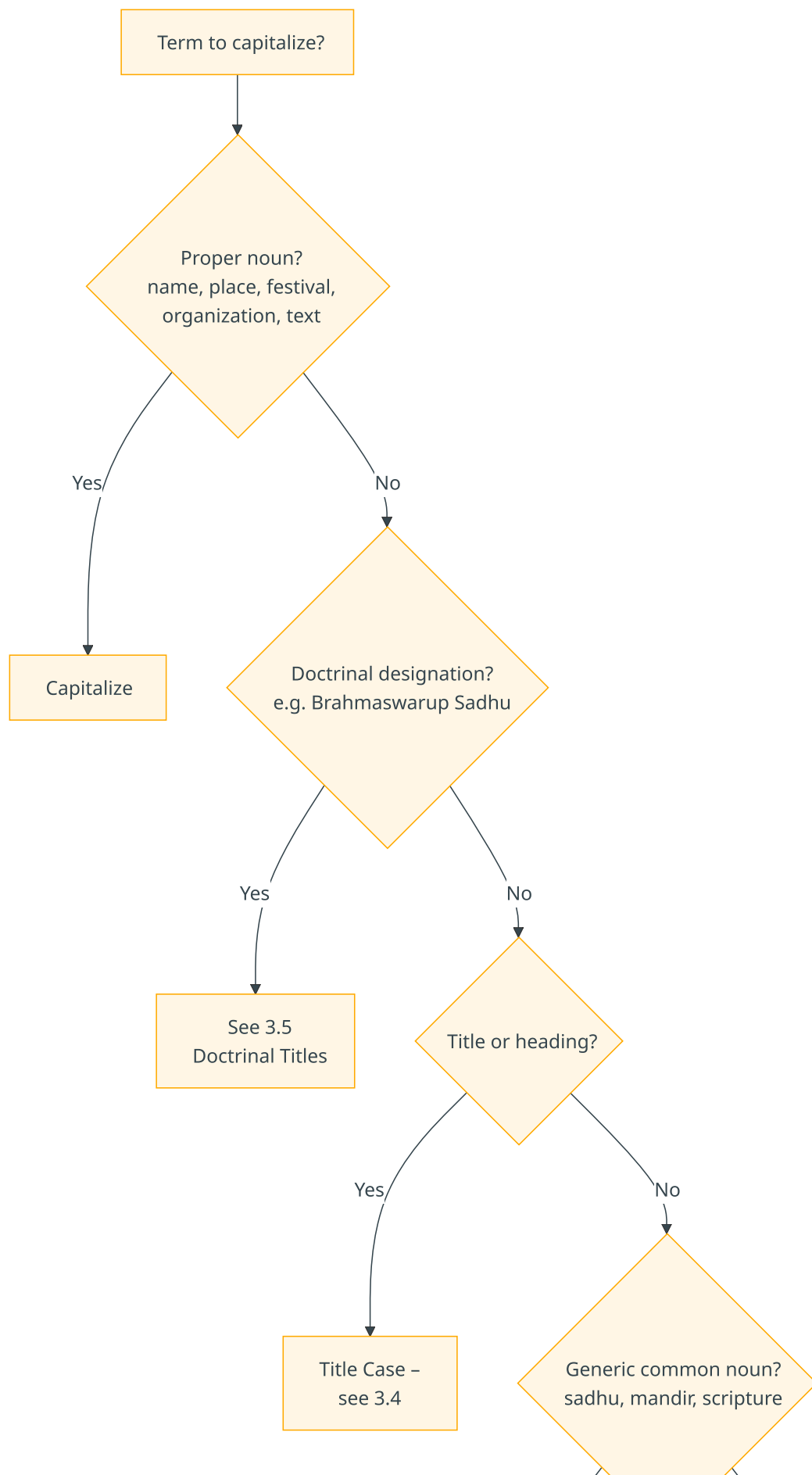
Please send your thoughts via Feedback.

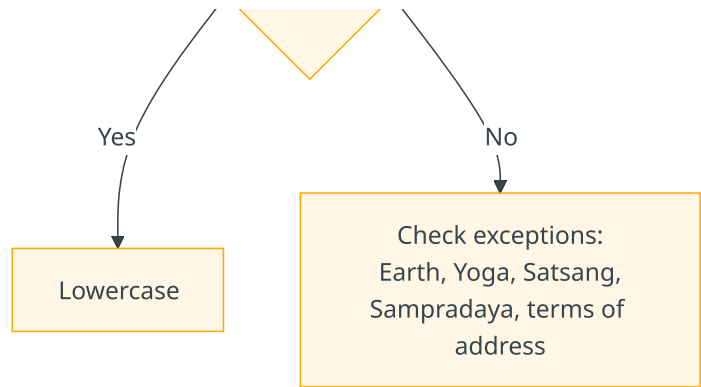
3.3 Capitalization

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Capitalization rules for SAP English publications.

Quick Decision





Follow this for the common case. The rules below cover the full set of edge cases.

SHOW ME — MULTIPLE CAPITALIZATION DECISIONS IN ONE PARAGRAPH

3.3.1 Core Rules

3.3.1.1 Indic Languages Don't Capitalize – Apply English Rules

Indic languages do not use capitalization. So follow **English capitalization rules** for transliterated text and titles to determine whether an Indic word or phrase needs to be capitalized.

3.3.1.2 Common Nouns

Common nouns should not be capitalized without specific reason.

- *darshan, arti, mandir, sadhu, guru, shastra* – all lowercase when used as ordinary common nouns.

3.3.1.3 Titles of Works

In titles, **capitalize all major terms**, but not:

- articles (a, an, the)
- prefixes
- coordinating conjunctions (and, but, or)
- prepositions

Use **italics** to indicate a book, newspaper, or periodical.

Bhagwan Swaminarayan: An Introduction to His Life and Work

3.3.1.4 Diacritics in Titles and Headings

Do **NOT** include diacritical marks in titles and headings.

This applies regardless of whether diacritics appear in the body text.

3.3.2 Practical Guidance

3.3.2.1 Always Capitalized

- **Personal names and titles when used as names:** Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Aksharbrahma Gunatitanand Swami, Pramukh Swami Maharaj, Mahant Swami Maharaj.
- **Place names:** Loj, Vartal, Gadhada, Sarangpur.
- **Names of texts:** Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Swamini Vato.
- **Names of organizations:** BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha.
- **Festivals and holy days:** Janmashtami, Diwali, Annakut.
- **Tithis (named days of the lunar fortnight):** Padvo, Bij, Ekadashi, Punam, Amas. Roman, no italics, no diacritics – see Tithis (Part 4) for the complete rule.

3.3.2.2 Lowercase

- **Generic terms:** *sadhu, temple, scripture, discourse.*
- **Generic religious actions:** *darshan, arti, katha.*
- **Generic descriptive adjectives:** *spiritual, philosophical, devotional, religious, traditional, ethical* — these don't derive from proper nouns and stay lowercase. (Proper adjectives like *Hindu, Vedic, Swaminarayan, Gandhian* are always capitalized — see 3.3.2.6.)

3.3.2.3 Earth / earth

The capitalization depends on whether the reference is to the **planet by name** or to **soil, ground, the world, or the elemental matter**.

- **Earth** (capitalized) — proper-noun reference to the planet, alongside *Mars, Venus, Jupiter: life exists only on Earth; Earth revolves around the Sun. The Earth* and *Earth* are both acceptable for the planetary reference; the article-less form reads as more modern.
- **earth** (lowercase) — common-noun reference to soil, ground, land, the material element, or the world in a non-astronomical sense: *the seeds fell to the earth; fire, water, air, and earth; peace on earth.*

In theological and philosophical writing, lowercase is usually correct, since the reference is to the **earthly realm** or **material creation** rather than the planet by name: *attachment to earthly pleasures; the earth element; beings on earth.* Capitalize only when the planet itself is named: *all beings living on Earth.*

A useful test: 'Am I naming the planet?' Yes → *Earth*; no → *earth*.

3.3.2.4 Word Choice – Cycle of Births and Deaths

The preferred form is the singular-plural pair: **cycle of births and deaths**.

-  Most preferred: *cycle of births and deaths*
- ✓ Acceptable: *cycles of birth and death*
- Less preferred: *cycle of birth and death*

3.3.2.5 Adjective + Noun Phrases (*Brahmaswarup Sadhu, Akshar-Purushottam Darshan*)

How to capitalize compound phrases with a doctrinal adjective and a noun is governed by a separate four-rule system – see Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization.

3.3.2.6 Proper Adjectives Derived from Names, Places, Religions, and Scriptures

Adjectives derived from proper nouns are **capitalized**:

- **From places:** Indian philosophy, Gujarati literature, British English, Sanskrit grammar, European history.
- **From religions and traditions:** Hindu philosophy, Christian theology, Islamic jurisprudence, Swaminarayan theology, Vedantic interpretation.
- **From personal names:** Gandhian principles, Socratic dialogue, Platonic thought, Darwinian evolution.
- **From scriptures:** Veda → *Vedic* – Vedic philosophy, Vedic culture; Purana → *Puranic* – Puranic cosmology, Puranic narratives; Upanishad → *Upanishadic* – Upanishadic thought, Upanishadic teachings.

A useful test: if the adjective answers “*related to which specific person, place, religion, tradition, or text?*” it is a proper adjective and should be capitalized.

In a hyphenated compound, the proper-adjective element keeps its capital: *Hindu-majority population*, *Vedic-era literature*, *Sanskrit-based terminology*, *Gandhian-style reform*.

Common adjectives – *spiritual*, *devotional*, *philosophical*, *traditional*, *ethical* – remain lowercase.

DOCTRINAL ADJECTIVES ARE DIFFERENT

Adjectives like *Brahmaswarup*, *Gunatit*, *Param Ekantik* aren’t proper adjectives in the 3.3.2.6 sense – they’re doctrinal qualifiers used in BAPS-specific reverential designations. They follow the rules in 3.5 Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization, not this section.

3.3.2.7 Yogic vs. Yoga

- **yogic** – usually **lowercase** in modern English: *yogic discipline*, *yogic breathing*. The word has been lexicalized as a general adjective.
- **Yoga** – **capitalized** when it refers to the formal philosophical system: *Yoga philosophy*, *the Yoga Sutras*.
- **Named schools and forms of Yoga** – capitalize both elements as a formal designation: *Ashtanga Yoga*, *Hatha Yoga*, *Bhakti Yoga*, *Karma Yoga*, *Raja Yoga*.
- Some religious publishers capitalize *Yogic* for theological consistency. Either is defensible; consistency within a single publication matters most.

3.3.2.8 Sampradaya

- **Capitalize** as part of a formal name of a tradition: *Swaminarayan Sampradaya*, *Ramanuja Sampradaya*, *Vallabh Sampradaya*.
- **Lowercase** as a generic noun meaning “tradition” or “sect”: *the sadhus of the old sampradaya*, *a young sampradaya*.

3.3.2.9 Historical Titles and Offices

Capitalize a formal title when it is tied to a specific person:

Sundarji Suthar was the secretary to the **King of Kutch**.

Lowercase in generic reference:

He hoped to become **king** of Kutch one day.

Same logic for *the Maharaja of Bhavnagar, the Diwan of Junagadh*, etc.

3.3.2.10 The Definite Article with Unique Theological Designations

English requires the definite article *the* before a unique title or singular theological identity:

- *the Supreme God*
- *the Supreme Lord*
- *the Supreme Being*
- *the Almighty*

Capitalize *Supreme* / *Almighty* when functioning as part of the formal designation. Use lowercase when *supreme* is genuinely descriptive:

-  *Sahajanand Swami himself is the manifestation of the Supreme God.*
-  *An atheist does not believe in the existence of an eternal, supreme God.*
-  *Damodarbai believed Shriji Maharaj was the Supreme God – Purna Purushottam Narayan.*

This same rule resolves *Sarvopari* / *sarvopari*: cap when it forms part of a formal designation (*Sarvopari Bhagwan Swaminarayan*); italic lowercase when it's a quality descriptor.

3.3.2.11 Satsang as a Doctrinal Term

- **Satsang** – capitalized, roman, when it refers to the BAPS Swaminarayan tradition or institution as a doctrinal designation:

The glory of **Satsang** is infinite.

- **satsang** – lowercase, italic, in generic descriptive usage (a gathering, the practice of keeping holy company): *a satsang gathering, attended satsang.*

3.3.2.12 Title Case for Headings on This Site

We use **title case** for headings on this site, our digital publications, and book and chapter titles in print: capitalize the first and last words and all major terms; lowercase articles, coordinating conjunctions, prepositions of any length, and the infinitive *to*. The full title-case rules — including hyphenated words, the first word after a colon, phrasal verbs, and other edge cases — live in 3.4 Title Case in Detail.

3.3.2.13 Terms of Address (Direct Address and Family Relationships)

Capitalize a title or term of address when it **stands in for a name** – when you could substitute the person's actual name in the same slot:

- Direct address: *That's an order, Sergeant. / I'll get right on it, Chief. / I object, Your Honour.*
- Family used as a name: *If only Father were here. / I'll tell Mom!*

Lowercase when the title or relationship term is preceded by a possessive or article – it's now a common noun describing a role:

- *the sergeant gave the order*
- *Wait until your father gets home.*
- *I saw your mom yesterday.*

Common terms of respect – *sir, ma'am, miss* – stay lowercase even in direct address. (Exception: in salutations of letters and emails: *Dear Sir.*) Terms of endearment are also lowercase: *I'll get it, dear.*

3.3.2.14 Ages and Time Periods

Capitalize when the period has an established proper-noun-like name:

- the Bronze Age, the Iron Age
- the Middle Ages, the Renaissance, the Reformation
- the Jazz Age, the Roaring Twenties
- the Vedic Period, the Maurya Era
- the Hindu *yugas* — *Satyuga, Tretayuga, Dvaparayuga, Kaliyuga* — capitalized as proper-noun cosmic ages

Lowercase when the description is generic or merely descriptive:

- ancient Greece, classical Rome
- the colonial period, the antebellum period
- the post-war years, the medieval period (when used loosely)

3.3.2.15 Adjectives before Capitalized Nouns – General Rule

A descriptive adjective is **not** capitalized just because the noun it modifies is capitalized:

- ✓ a **delicious** Italian meal (*Italian* is a proper adjective; *delicious* is descriptive)
- ✓ the **tall** Eiffel Tower
- ✓ a **colourful** Diwali celebration

Exception: capitalize the adjective when it is part of an established proper noun, formal title, or recognized epithet:

- the **Atlantic** Ocean
- the **United** States
- the **Rocky** Mountains
- the **Supreme** Court
- the **Holy** Bible
- the **Big Apple** (epithet for New York)
- **Alexander** the **Great**

For BAPS-specific doctrinal designations (*Sarvopari Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Param Ekantik Sadhu, Brahmaswarup Sadhu, Gunatit Guru*), see Doctrinal Titles.

3.3.2.16 Definitions Use Sentence Case (Not Title Case)

The term being defined uses title case (or whatever its standard form is); the definition itself uses **sentence case** – first word and proper nouns only. This applies to glossary entries, term-and-meaning tables, and any definition-style construction.

TERM (TITLE CASE)	DEFINITION (SENTENCE CASE)
Param Bhagvat	Ideal devotee of God, referring to the Satpurush.
Param Bhagvat Sant	Ideal sadhu of God, referring to the Satpurush.
Param Ekantik Sant	Ideal <i>ekantik</i> sadhu of God, referring to the Satpurush.

✗ Don't write the definition in title case (*'Ideal Devotee Of God, Referring To The Satpurush.'*) and don't lowercase proper nouns within it (*'ideal sadhu of god, referring to the satpurush'*).

3.3.3 Open Questions

The capitalization of several specific terms is still under team discussion. The full list lives in Open Discussions. Highlights:

- **Sanstha names** – Sanstha / sanstha; BAPS Sanstha vs the Sanstha. See Sanstha & Mandirs.
- **Mandir names** – *Sarangpur Mandir* / *Sarangpur mandir* / *the BAPS mandir in Sarangpur*. See Sanstha & Mandirs.
- **Honorifics** – *Bhagwan* / *bhagwan*; *Shri* / *shri*. See Gurus & Honorifics.
- **Philosophical terms** – *Advaita* / *advaita*; *Darshan* / *darshan*. See Transliteration.

3.3.4 See Also

- 3.4 Title Case in Detail – the full title-case rules, separated from this page for navigability.
- 3.5 Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization – the four-rule system for BAPS-specific reverential designations.
- 3.6 Italics – what to italicize (capitalization and italicization are independent decisions).
- Translation rules – capitalizing names of prominent figures.
- Diacritics & Transliteration – the rule that diacritics never appear in titles or headings.

3.4 Title Case in Detail

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

The basic rule for titles of works lives at 3.3.1.3. The sections below cover the specific cases that recur in book titles, chapter labels, and the headings on this site.

3.4.1 What to Capitalize, What to Lowercase

Capitalize:

- nouns, pronouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs;
- subordinating conjunctions (*as, because, that, if, unless, until, whenever*);
- the **first** and **last** word of the title, regardless of part of speech.

Lowercase:

- articles (*a, an, the*);
- coordinating conjunctions (*and, but, or, nor, for, yet, so*);
- prepositions of any length (*at, by, for, from, in, of, on, to, with, between, through, across, about*);
- the infinitive *to* (*How to Read*, not *How To Read*).

The Vachanamrut: A Reader's Guide to the Discourses of Bhagwan Swaminarayan

This follows CMS, which treats word *class* as the deciding factor — not word length. (AP capitalizes prepositions of four or more letters; SAP does not.)

SHOW ME — THAT TITLE BROKEN DOWN WORD BY WORD

3.4.2 Hyphenated Words in Titles

- **Capitalize the first element** always.
- **Capitalize subsequent elements** unless they are articles, prepositions, or coordinating conjunctions.
- **Capitalize the second element of a spelled-out compound number:** *Forty-Ninth Street Blues*.
- **Don't capitalize the second element if the first is a prefix** that can't stand alone (*anti-, pre-, de-, non-*):
Anti-inflammatory Dieting, Pre-modern Era, Non-violent Resistance.

FORM	EXAMPLE
Both elements substantive	<i>High-Quality Web Services</i>
Hyphenated compound number	<i>Forty-Ninth Street Blues</i>
Conjunction or article in middle	<i>Bed-and-Breakfast Options</i>
Article or preposition in middle	<i>Up-to-Date Catalogue</i>
Prefix that can't stand alone	<i>Anti-inflammatory Dieting</i>
Two-element ordinal compound	<i>Twenty-First-Century Outlook</i>

3.4.3 First Word after a Colon

Capitalize the first word after a colon when what follows is itself a complete clause (and the surrounding form is title case):

Feminine Poetry: Ten Women Writers from Around the World

In **sentence case**, capitalize after a colon only if the clause is independent and stands alone:

I know who you are: You are my friend.

If the post-colon material is a fragment that can't stand alone, lowercase it:

I know who you are: nobody.

3.4.4 Phrasal Verbs and Open Compounds in Titles

Two title-only quirks for multi-word patterns. Both apply only when setting a title or subhead in title case, not in body prose.

Phrasal verbs — capitalize the preposition when it forms part of a phrasal verb (the preposition is functioning as part of the verb, not introducing a prepositional phrase):

- *How to Back Up a Computer* (*back up* = make a copy)
- *Turn Down the Heat to Save You Money* (*turn down* = reduce)
- *Look Up the Reference* (*look up* = consult)

The same words stay lowercase when used in their ordinary prepositional sense:

- *Notes on the Verb*
- *Reflections from the Road*

Open compounds — when a modifier and a noun together form a recognized open compound (effectively a noun phrase), capitalize both elements:

- *Salad Dressing Recipes*
- *The Best Science Fiction and Fantasy of the Year*
- *Master Class Notes*

3.4.5 Sentence Case vs. Title Case — When to Use Which

- **Title case** — capitalize all principal words per the rules above — for headings on this site, digital publications, book titles, chapter titles, magazine and newspaper titles. This is the default everywhere except definitions.
- **Sentence case** — first word and proper nouns only — reserved for **definitions** in glossaries and term-and-meaning tables. See 3.3.2.16.

A glossary entry illustrates the distinction: the term itself uses title case (*Param Ekantik Sant*), while its definition uses sentence case (*Ideal sadhu of God, referring to the Satpurush.*).

3.4.6 See Also

- 3.3 Capitalization — the broader capitalization rules; the *Titles of Works* basic rule lives at 3.3.1.3.
- 3.5 Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization — title-case treatment of BAPS-specific reverential designations.

3.5 Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How to capitalize adjective + noun phrases in BAPS English publications, especially the doctrinally loaded combinations like **Brahmaswarup Sadhu**, **Akshar-Purushottam Darshan**, and **Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj**.

This page resolves the recurring question: **when does the adjective get capitalized?** The four rules below cover every case.

3.5.1 The Four Rules

3.5.1.1 Rule 1 – Proper Nouns and Formal Doctrinal Titles → Capitalize Everything

When the phrase refers to a **specific, doctrinally defined entity** or an **officially recognized title**, the entire fixed phrase behaves as a proper noun. Capitalize every principal word – including adjectives.

Examples – formal titles and named entities:

- **Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj**
- **Pramukh Swami Maharaj Shatabdi Mahotsav**
- **Akshar-Purushottam Darshan**
- **Akshar-Purushottam Siddhant**
- **Gunatit Guru Parampara**
- **Sarvopari Bhagwan Swaminarayan**
- **Aksharbrahma** (when referring to the entity)

Examples – formal doctrinal designations:

- **Param Ekantik Sadhu**
- **Param Ekantik Sant**
- **Ekantik Dharma**
- **the Satpurush** (with the definite article, used as a doctrinal designation)

The adjective is part of a fixed title, not a descriptor – so it carries the capital with the rest of the title.

3.5.1.2 Rule 2 – Generic Descriptions of Qualities or States → All Lowercase

When the phrase refers to a **quality**, a **state of being**, or a **doctrinal concept used descriptively or academically**, both the adjective and the noun are lowercase.

Examples:

- a *brahmarup* devotee
- a *gunatit* state
- a *brahmaswarup* understanding

- the *satpurush*-bhakti of devotees — a hyphenated compound naming the devotional practice (devotion directed toward *a* satpurush) treated as a concept; both elements stay italic and lowercase because the phrase describes the practice generically, not a specific designation
- a *satpurush* (= “a spiritually elevated person”, common-noun usage)
- *ekantik* devotion / faith / lifestyle (descriptive use of *ekantik*, not the doctrinal designation)

These are attributes, not names. They follow the standard SAP rule for non-anglicized Indic terms (italic, lowercase) and the noun stays lowercase too because it’s not standing for a specific person or title.

The use of the indefinite article *a* / *an* is a strong signal: *a satpurush* is common-noun usage, while *the Satpurush* (Rule 1) is a formal doctrinal designation.

3.5.1.3 Rule 3 – Adjective + Reverential Noun for the Satpurush → Capitalize Both, Roman

When referring to the manifest Satpurush (the living Gunatit Guru) using an **adjective + reverential noun** – even without a specific name – **capitalize both the adjective and the noun, set roman**. The pairing functions as a doctrinal designation, not a quality descriptor.

Examples:

- **Brahmaswarup Sadhu**
- **Gunatit Guru**
- **Pragat Guru**
- **Divya Sadhu**
- **Pragat Satpurush**

The noun (*Sadhu*, *Guru*, *Satpurush*, *Sant*) stands for a specific person in BAPS theology, and the adjective is part of how that person is doctrinally identified – so the whole pairing is treated as a designation. This is a BAPS-specific devotional convention.

To distinguish Rule 3 from Rule 2: the noun is the test. If the noun is a **reverential noun for the manifest Satpurush** (*Sadhu*, *Guru*, *Satpurush*, *Sant*), apply Rule 3 → cap both. If the noun is an **abstract or generic concept** (state, devotion, understanding, lifestyle), apply Rule 2 → lowercase both.

3.5.1.4 Rule 4 – Named, Identifiable Persons → Capitalize Everything

When the Satpurush is mentioned **by name**, capitalize every component including the adjectives, exactly as in Rule 1.

Examples:

- **Brahmaswarup Shastriji Maharaj**
- **Brahmaswarup Yogiji Maharaj**
- **Brahmaswarup Pramukh Swami Maharaj**
- **Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj**

These are proper titles of specific individuals.

3.5.1.5 *Swami* as a Substitute for a Specific Name

When ***Swami*** is used to refer back to a **specific, previously identified individual** (e.g. Shukanand Swami in a passage already introducing him), it functions as a shortened proper name and is **capitalized, roman**:

Bhagwan Swaminarayan asked **Swami** to initiate Dungar by giving *vartman*. Dungar gazed up at **Swami** constantly.

Lowercase **swami** in generic plural or descriptive usage:

- many *swamis* gathered
- a *swami* arrived from Vartal

3.5.1.6 Descriptive Phrases for the Sadhu – Lowercase

Phrases like *the God-realized sadhu*, *the true sadhu*, *a holy sadhu*, *an enlightened sadhu* are **descriptive**, not formal doctrinal titles. Set them in **roman, lowercase**:

Swamishri spoke extensively about the concept of the God-realized sadhu as the gateway to liberation. Bhagatji was indeed the enlightened sadhu that Yagnapurushdasji had described.

Exception — when the phrase refers specifically to the manifest Satpurush. When *the True Sadhu*, *the God-Realized Sadhu*, *the Holy Sadhu* and similar phrases are used as a **doctrinal designation for the manifest Gunatit Guru** (rather than describing any spiritually elevated person), treat them as Rule 3 — capitalize both the adjective and *Sadhu*, set roman:

Bhagwan Swaminarayan continues to grace the world through the **God-Realized Sadhu**. Liberation is attained through the company of the **True Sadhu**.

The use of *the* (definite article) plus a doctrinal-context cue is a strong signal that the phrase is naming the Satpurush rather than describing a category. For hyphenated adjectives like *God-Realized*, capitalize both elements (per §3.4.2 Hyphenated Words in Titles, applied here to the doctrinal designation).

SHOW ME — ALL FOUR RULES IN ONE PARAGRAPH

3.5.2 Quick Decision Guide

Ask these questions in order, and stop at the first **yes**:

1. **Is it an official doctrinal title or a named person?** (Rules 1 & 4) → Capitalize everything, roman.
2. **Is the noun a reverential noun for the manifest Satpurush – *Sadhu*, *Guru*, *Satpurush*, *Sant* – even without a specific name?** (Rule 3) → Capitalize both adjective and noun, roman.
3. **Is the noun an abstract or generic concept – *state*, *devotion*, *understanding*, *lifestyle*?** (Rule 2) → Lowercase both adjective and noun; italic adjective.

3.5.3 Multi-Level Summary

PHRASE	ADJECTIVE	NOUN	FORM	RULE
Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj	Cap	Cap	Roman	4
Akshar-Purushottam Darshan	Cap	Cap	Roman	1
Brahmaswarup Pramukh Swami Maharaj	Cap	Cap	Roman	4
Param Ekantik Sadhu	Cap	Cap	Roman	1
Ekantik Dharma	Cap	Cap	Roman	1
the Satpurush	–	Cap	Roman	1
Swami (referring to a specific named sadhu)	–	Cap	Roman	–
Brahmaswarup Sadhu	Cap	Cap	Roman	3
Gunatit Guru	Cap	Cap	Roman	3
Pragat Satpurush	Cap	Cap	Roman	3
Divya Sadhu	Cap	Cap	Roman	3
the God-realized sadhu (descriptive — any God-realized person)	–	lowercase	Roman	(descriptive)
the true sadhu (descriptive)	–	lowercase	Roman	(descriptive)
the God-Realized Sadhu (designation — the manifest Satpurush)	Cap	Cap	Roman	3
the True Sadhu (designation — the manifest Satpurush)	Cap	Cap	Roman	3
a <i>brahmarup</i> devotee	italic lowercase	lowercase	Italic + roman	2
a <i>gunatit</i> state	italic lowercase	lowercase	Italic + roman	2
a <i>satpurush</i> (common-noun usage)	–	italic lowercase	Italic	2
<i>ekantik</i> devotion (descriptive)	italic lowercase	lowercase	Italic + roman	2
the <i>satpurush</i> -bhakti of devotees	italic lowercase	lowercase	Italic	2

3.5.4 How This Fits the Rest of the Guide

- The general SAP rules (Italics, Capitalization) still apply. Rules 1–4 above resolve the cases where those general rules don’t disambiguate adjective treatment.
- Rule 3 is the most distinctive – it’s the BAPS-specific devotional convention that treats *Sadhu*, *Guru*, *Satpurush*, *Sant* as standing for a specific person whenever they refer to the living Gunatit Guru, and capitalizes the qualifying adjective along with the noun (*Brahmaswarup Sadhu*, *Gunatit Guru*) because the adjective is part of how the Satpurush is doctrinally identified. CMS allows this kind of cap as a documented style choice for religious publications, provided it’s applied consistently.
- For tithis (*Ekadashi*, *Punam*, *Padvo*...) and fortnight markers (*sud*, *vad*), see Tithis – they follow their own rule.

3.5.5 See Also

- Capitalization – the general capitalization rules.
- Italics – italicization of Indic terms.
- Tithis – calendar-day capitalization.

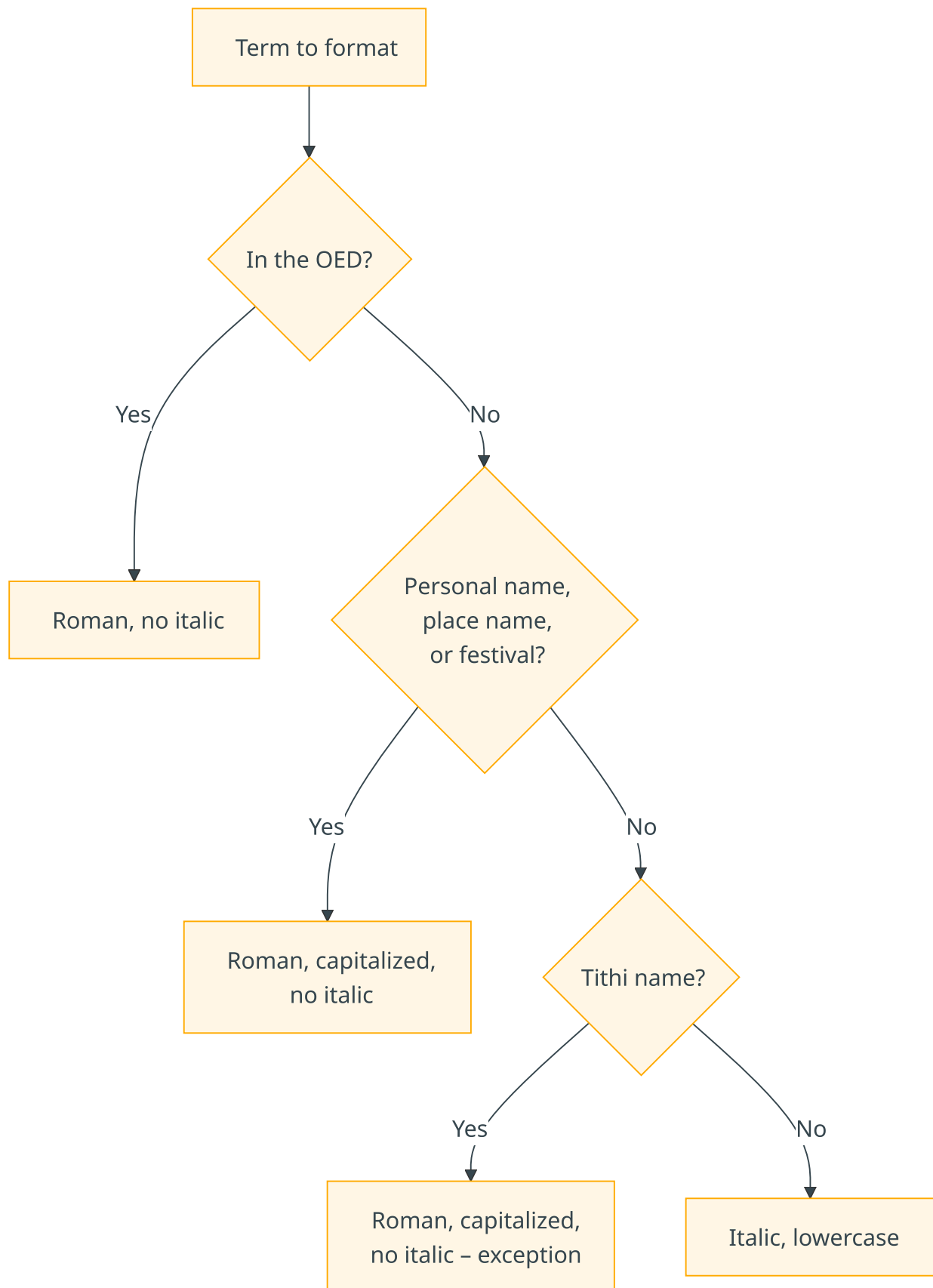
3.6 Italics

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How we set italics for non-English terms in SAP English publications.

For when to translate vs transliterate vs anglicize, see Translation Rules.

Quick Decision



Follow this for the common case. The rules below cover edge cases (multiword phrases, titles of works, English emphasis, verses).

SHOW ME — MULTIPLE ITALICS DECISIONS IN ONE PARAGRAPH

3.6.1 The Rules

3.6.1.1 Indic Words and Phrases (Not Anglicized)

Indic words and phrases that are **not anglicized** – i.e. not found in the OED – are **italicized** in:

- the main text
- photo captions and other legends
- footnotes

These italicized words can be collated to form a glossary at the end of the book.

The aspirant performed *dandvats* before the *murti* of Bhagwan Swaminarayan.

3.6.1.2 Names and Capitalized Proper Nouns – Not Italicized

The following are set in **roman alphabet with initial caps** – **do not italicize** them:

- Personal names
- Place names
- Peoples and tribes
- Institutions and organizations
- Holy days
- Festivals
- Titles of persons (when used with the name)
- **Tithis** (named days of the lunar fortnight) – see Tithis for the full rule

Pramukh Swami Maharaj visited Sarangpur Mandir during Janmashtami.

EXCEPTION – TITHIS ARE ROMAN EVEN THOUGH THEY ARE NOT IN THE OED

Tithi names (*Padvo*, *Bij*, *Ekadashi*, *Punam*...) would normally be italicized under the rule in 3.6.1.1, since they are not anglicized. They are an explicit exception: they function as **named days** (like *Tuesday* or *Diwali*), so they are set roman with caps. The fortnight designators ***sud*** and ***vad***, however, remain *italic, lowercase*. See Tithis (Part 4).

3.6.1.3 Anglicized Terms – Not Italicized

Indic terms that have become **anglicized** are in **roman, lowercase**.

The discourse drew from the Vedas and turned to the nature of dharma.

EXCEPTION – ITALICIZED ANGLICIZED TERMS

Italics may sometimes be used for unfamiliar words **or if the OED definition does not fully correlate to the intended meaning**. The (partial) list of anglicized words in the OED identifies words which SAP prefers to italicize. Such words are included in that publication's glossary.

3.6.1.4 Titles, Short Stories, Poems, Art

Do not italicize Indic words in:

- Titles of works of art
- Short stories
- Poems

HINDU SHASTRA TITLES — ROMAN, NOT ITALICIZED

Hindu shastra titles (Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Swamini Vato, Bhagavad Gita, Mahabharat, Ramayan, Upanishads, etc.) are **roman, capitalized, not italicized** — a BAPS-specific departure from CMS, which would italicize them as titles of works. The full rule, with citation formats and the recognized list of shastras, is at 3.15.7 Hindu Shastra Citations.

3.6.1.5 Multiword Sanskrit and Indic Phrases – Italicize the Whole Phrase

If any essential part of a multiword phrase is non-naturalized, italicize the **entire** phrase as a single foreign lexical unit. Splitting italicization across the phrase implies the parts are independent words rather than a unified concept.

- ✓ *murti puja*
- ✓ *ekantik dharma*
- ✓ *mansi puja*
- ✓ *nitya karma*
- ✓ *vanaprasth ashram*
- ✓ *guru parampara*
- ✗ *murti puja* / *murti puja*
- ✗ *ekantik dharma* / *ekantik dharma*

The phrase functions as a single doctrinal concept, named practice, or technical expression – typography reflects that semantic unity.

This rule applies to descriptive multiword phrases. Phrases that are formal doctrinal designations (e.g. *Akshar-Purushottam Darshan*, *Gunatit Guru Parampara*) follow the Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization rules and are roman.

3.6.2 Punctuation Adjacent to Italicized Phrases

The default rule: punctuation appears in the same font as the **surrounding text**, not the italicized word or phrase. So a comma, period, question mark, or other mark following an italicized word in roman prose stays roman.

- *kem chho?* – the question mark stays roman.

- *Bhagwan bhaji leva.* – the period stays roman.
- He cited the novels *Anna Karenina*, *War and Peace*, and *Crime and Punishment* – the commas stay roman. (Hindu shastra titles — *Vachanamrut*, *Shikshapatri*, *Swamini Vato* — would themselves be roman per 3.15.7; the punctuation rule shown here applies whenever the surrounding word is italicized.)

Exception – Punctuation that Belongs to the Italicized Title

When a question mark, exclamation point, or other terminal punctuation is **part of an italicized title or work**, italicize the punctuation along with it:

- Have you seen the play *Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf?* – the question mark is part of the title and stays italic.
- The novel *Are You There God? It's Me, Margaret* has a question mark mid-title – both that mark and the comma after *God?* are part of the italicised title.
- The biographical study *Bhagwan Swaminarayan: An Introduction to His Life and Work* takes the colon as part of the italicised title – the colon italicises along with the rest.

If an italicized title's terminal punctuation conflicts with the surrounding sentence's needs (e.g. would produce a doubled question mark), recast the sentence:

- ❌ Have you seen *Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf??*
- ✅ Are you familiar with the play *Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf*?

Quotation marks adjacent to italicized words stay roman – they belong to the surrounding sentence, not the word inside.

3.6.3 Italics for English Emphasis

Italics may be used to emphasize a word or short phrase in English prose – but **sparingly**. Overuse drains the device of any effect.

The point is not *what* he said, but *how* he said it.

Reserve emphasis-italics for genuine contrast or stress that the sentence rhythm cannot otherwise convey. Avoid them as a substitute for forceful diction.

3.6.4 Shlokas, Padas, and Other Quoted Verses

When quoting a transliterated Sanskrit, Gujarati, or Hindi verse – a *shloka*, *pada*, *bhajan* line, or scripture quotation – alongside its English translation:

- The **transliterated verse** is set in *italics*.
- The **English translation** is set in roman.
- Both follow English-language punctuation.
- Diacritics in the verse text are **permitted** (and preferred where pronunciation matters). The **BAPS in-house default** is the Macron-Only Convention – long *a* marked with a macron, no other diacritics. A different system (full IAST, etc.) is a project-level decision; see [SAP Diacritics Policy](#). The **prose text** around the verse stays plain-Roman per §5.2. For each transliterated term, the macron-only spelling is recorded in the glossary's `diacriticSpelling` column.

māgha-māsi sitā-pakṣe pratipadī...

“On the first day of the waxing fortnight of the month of Maha...”

If the verse is unfamiliar to the readership, italicize the first appearance of the transliteration; in subsequent appearances within the same publication, the gloss can be dropped. (Same logic as a single Indic term – see *Indic words and phrases* above.)

3.6.5 Decision Summary

WORD	FORM	ITALICS?
Anglicized (in OED)	dharma, dal, puri	No
Personal/place name	Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Sarangpur	No
Festival, holy day	Janmashtami, Diwali	No
Tithi (named lunar day)	Padvo, Ekadashi, Punam	No (exception – see Tithis)
Hindu shastra title	Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Bhagavad Gita	No (BAPS-specific – see 3.15.7)
Fortnight designator	<i>sud, vad</i>	Yes (italic, lowercase)
Other Indic term in prose	<i>dandvat, kothari, patshala</i>	Yes
Title of a poem/short story	‘Akshar Anubhuti’	No

This table answers “italicize this term?” – not “how do I form its plural?”. Pluralization (native plural vs -s on the italic word vs OED form) is a separate decision; see Plurals §3.7.

3.6.6 See Also

- Plurals – how the plural endings work for italicized vs anglicized terms.
- Quotation marks – how to present a transliteration alongside its translation.
- Diacritics & Transliteration – what spellings to use for the italicized terms.

3.7 Plurals

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How to form the plural of an Indic word in SAP English publications.

3.7.1 The Rules

3.7.1.1 Plurals of Transliterated Indic Words

Plurals of Indic words written in roman follow their **native plurals**:

- *rotlo* → *rotla*

Or form the plural of a transliterated Indic word by adding an **s** to the italic word — the **s** takes the same format as the word it's attached to (italic word → italic **s**; roman word → roman **s**):

- *rotlo* → *rotlos*

For **anglicized** words, follow the spelling in the OED:

- chapatis / chapattis

3.7.1.2 Avoid Anglicized Plurals on Fully Transliterated Words

Avoid anglicized plurals on **fully transliterated plural** Indic words. Use the native plural form, not an English -s:

-  *rotla*
-  *rotlas* / *rotlos*

Anglicized plurals **may** be used on words that are found in the OED (and thus are not fully transliterated):

- pandits
- gurus

SHOW ME — PLURAL DECISIONS IN A PARAGRAPH

3.7.2 Decision Summary

SOURCE WORD	FORM IN <u>OED</u> ?	PLURAL
chapati	Yes	chapatis (per <u>OED</u>)
pandit	Yes	pandits
<i>rotlo</i>	No	<i>rotla</i> (native plural) – or <i>rotlos</i>
<i>Kathiyavadi</i>	No	<i>Kathiyavadis</i>

3.7.3 Open Question – Singular Gujarati Words Used as Their Own Plural

How should we use singular Gujarati words that are their own plural? E.g., *dandvat*, *pradakshina*, *pranam*... – even though in English we (SAP) do add an *s* in plural usage.

This is an unresolved question. See Open Discussions: Indic Words for the running discussion.

3.7.4 See Also

- Italics – when to italicize the singular and the plural ending.
- Translation rules – when to use the OED form vs a transliteration.

3.8 Numbers

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

When to spell out numbers in words and when to use numerals.

3.8.1 The Rule

- **Spell out** whole numbers from **one through ten**.
- **Use numerals** from **11 onwards**, and always for measurements, statistics, ages, dates, percentages, currency, times of day, and consistency within technical contexts.

This departs from CMS (which spells out one through one hundred) and aligns more closely with AP-style usage. The shorter spell-out range keeps narrative prose readable while making longer counts easier to scan.

SHOW ME — NUMBERS IN A PARAGRAPH

3.8.2 Spell out (words)

USE	EXAMPLE
Whole numbers 1–10 in narrative prose	He delivered seven discourses; nine devotees attended.
Beginning of a sentence (any number)	Forty-three years have passed since the murti was installed. <i>(Recast where possible – see 3.8.4.1.)</i>
Approximate quantities below 11	About six volunteers stayed overnight.
Simple fractions in text	two-thirds, one-half
Centuries	the nineteenth century

3.8.3 Use Numerals

USE	EXAMPLE
Whole numbers 11 and above (narrative)	213 footnotes; 47 attendees; 32 devotees gathered.
Measurements	5 km, 200 g, 12 ft
Ages	a boy of 8; aged 12
Dates	28 November 2023
Percentages	75 per cent (BrE) / 75% in tabular contexts
Statistics	1,586 glossary entries; 213 footnotes
Mixed counts within technical contexts	A 2000-word article; a 50-page chapter
Article and chapter numbers	Vachanamrut Gadhada I 1
Currency with a unit	₹500, \$25, £10
Times of day with a.m. / p.m.	6 a.m., 9.30 p.m.
Round large numbers	1 million, 2 billion (or 1,000,000 in tables)

3.8.4 Edge Cases

3.8.4.1 Don't Start a Sentence with a Numeral

Spell it out, or recast the sentence:

- ✗ 213 footnotes appear in the Vachanamrut.
- ✓ Two hundred and thirteen footnotes appear in the Vachanamrut.
- ✓ The Vachanamrut contains 213 footnotes.

3.8.4.2 Mixing Words and Numerals in One Passage

Choose one form per category and stay consistent within a passage. If a passage discusses several quantities of the same kind, use **numerals throughout** – even for quantities below 11:

Of the 213 footnotes, 47 cite the Shikshapatri, 31 cite the Vachanamrut, and 8 cite the Swamini Vato.

3.8.4.3 Centuries and Decades

Spell out: *the nineteenth century*, *the 1990s* (digits + s, no apostrophe).

3.8.4.4 Fractions and Decimals

- Simple fractions in text: spell out – *two-thirds*, *one-half*. Hyphenate when used as adjectives.
- Decimals: numerals – 3.14.
- Mixed numbers and ranges: numerals – 5½, 2.5–3 m.

3.8.4.5 V.S. (Vikram Samvat) Years

Always numerals: *V.S. 2080*, *V.S. 1781*.

3.8.5 Compound Modifiers and Unit Spacing

The hyphen is the only dash that appears in compound modifiers with numbers. For en dashes (used for ranges and complex compounds) and em dashes (parenthetical breaks), see Punctuation §3.10.2 Dashes.

3.8.5.1 Hyphenate Compound Numerals (21–99) When Written Out

Cardinal and ordinal compound numerals from twenty-one through ninety-nine are hyphenated when written out:

- **twenty-nine** members
- the **forty-third** anniversary
- her **ninety-fifth** birthday

3.8.5.2 Hyphenate Compound Adjectives with Number + Noun

When a number plus a noun forms a compound adjective before another noun, hyphenate them:

PATTERN	EXAMPLE
Number + noun (spelled out)	a two-car family
Number + measurement (spelled out)	a five-kilometre trek
Number + currency	a \$4-million project
Class or quality	a first-class coach; a third-rate play
Ordinal + noun	an 18th-century novel; a 21st-century outlook

When the number applies in standalone (non-modifier) usage, no hyphen: *the entrance was two metres wide*; *the project cost \$4 million*.

3.8.5.3 No Hyphen Before Symbols or Unit Abbreviations

A hyphen never appears between a numeral and a symbol or a unit abbreviation (metric or imperial), even in adjectival use:

- ✓ a 100 °C thermometer ✗ a 100-°C thermometer
- ✓ a 30% increase ✗ a 30-% increase
- ✓ a 5 km trail ✗ a 5-km trail
- ✓ 35 mm film ✗ 35-mm film
- ✓ a 100 W bulb ✗ a 100-W bulb
- ✓ a 10 ft tree ✗ a 10-ft tree
- ✓ a 5 lb bag ✗ a 5-lb bag

3.8.5.4 Use Singular Form in Compound Modifiers

When a **spelled-out** unit appears in a compound adjective, use the **singular** form even for multiple units:

- a **10-foot** tree (not *10-feet*)
- a **5-pound** bag
- a **12-hour** shift
- a **two-metre-wide** entrance
- an **80-foot-wide** screen

Standalone usage takes the plural: *He climbed 10 feet. The bag weighs 5 pounds. The shift lasted 12 hours.*

Abbreviated units take no hyphen. When the unit is abbreviated (*ft, in, cm, mm, kg, lb, km, m, s*, etc.), do not hyphenate the numeral to the unit; the abbreviation is the same for singular and plural and is space-separated:

- a **10 ft** tree
- a **5 lb** bag
- a **35 mm** film
- a **100 cm** depth
- a **5 km** trail

This is the same rule as 3.8.5.3 — extended here to all unit abbreviations, both metric and imperial.

3.8.5.5 No Hyphen with a Possessive Noun

A possessive noun preceded by a number takes no hyphen:

- *one week's pay*
- *40 hours' work*
- *three weeks' vacation*
- *10 months' leave*

3.8.5.6 Space Between Number and Unit

Insert a space between the numeral and a unit symbol or abbreviation:

- 5 km, 200 g, 32 °C, 100 ml, 12 ft

Exception: degrees, minutes, and seconds for plane angles take no space:

- 30° 22' 8"
- a 45° angle

3.8.5.7 When the Written-Out Number Is Itself a Compound

A compound modifier with a spelled-out compound number (*two hundred and fifty, one thousand five hundred*) would technically need hyphens linking every element — *a two-hundred-and-fifty-millilitre flask* — but the result is unwieldy. Use the **abbreviated numeral form** instead:

- ❌ a two-hundred-and-fifty-millilitre flask (*grammatically correct but cumbersome*)
- ✅ a 250 ml flask

-  a one-thousand-five-hundred-metre run (*same — too many hyphens*)
-  a 1,500 m run

3.8.6 See Also

- Punctuation – comma in numerals (1,586), abbreviation rules, and other typographic details.
- Capitalization – capitalization rules for ordinals in titles.

3.9 Quotation Marks

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How to present an Indic term alongside its English translation.

For the general SAP rule (single quotes as the primary mark for highlighting; double for speech only), see Punctuation §3.10.1.

3.9.1 The Four Cases

3.9.1.1 Simple Apposition – No Quotation Marks

When the Indic term and the translation are juxtaposed using **commas, the word *or*, dashes, parentheses, or brackets**, do **not** use quotation marks around the translation. The translation is in roman script.

- He immediately offered *dandvats* – prostrations.
- A bowl of *mamra*, or puffed rice, topped with peanuts.

3.9.1.2 Translation Clarified – Single Quotes around the Translation

With phrases such as *which means*, *translated as*, or *literally*, the translation is highlighting the gloss – set it in **single quotes** and roman:

The Gujarati phrase is *Bhagwan bhaji leva*, meaning ‘worship God’.

3.9.1.3 Quoted Speech – Double Quotes

When someone is actually speaking – dialogue, calling out, blessing – use double quotes for the speech, with single quotes for any nested gloss:

- He warned me: “*Jaldi!* Quickly!”
- We said, “*Kaka, kem chho?* – Uncle, how are you?”
- “*Bhagwan bhaji leva* – Worship God.”
- “We call it *matru bhasha*,” he explained, “the mother tongue.”
- “*Agal, agal,*” he called out. “Go forward, go forward.” “*Dabi baju, dabi baju.* Go left, go left.”
- They shouted, “*Hayso!*” meaning, ‘let us pull together!’
- Pramukh Swami Maharaj blessed, “*Patthar satsang karavshe* – the stones will spread the glory of satsang.”

In the last two examples, the *meaning / gloss* portion (set off by *meaning*, or implicit) takes single quotes – it’s a highlight of the translation, not someone speaking the English version.

3.9.1.4 Mottoes and Slogans Presented as Phrases – Single Quotes

When a motto or slogan is being presented as a phrase (rather than spoken in dialogue), enclose it in **single quotes**. The Indic phrase is in italics; the translation is in roman.

- The BAPS motto ‘*Samp tya jamp* – Peace where there is unity’ captures the spirit of unity.
- The unifying call ‘*Hayso!*’ – ‘let us pull together!’ – punctuated the assembly.

If the motto is being **spoken** by someone in narrative (“They shouted, *Hayso!*”), apply the speech rule in 3.9.1.3 and use double quotes around the spoken text.

3.9.1.5 Explanations – No Quotation Marks

Explanations are presented **without** quotation marks:

- *rotlo*, an unleavened bread made from a variety of grains...
- An Indian drum called *dholak*...

3.9.2 Punctuation inside Italicized Words

Do not italicize the punctuation marks in italicized words/phrases.

Set the punctuation in roman, even when the word or phrase around it is italic.

3.9.3 Quick Reference

CONSTRUCTION	MARKS	TRANSLATION FORM
Apposition with comma / or / dash / parens	None	Roman
<i>Which means / translated as / literally</i>	Single around the translation	Roman
Quoted speech (someone speaking)	Double around the speech; single around any nested gloss	Per case
Motto presented as a phrase	Single	Italic Indic + roman translation
Motto spoken aloud in narrative	Double (speech rule)	Italic Indic + roman translation
Plain explanation of a term	None	Roman

3.9.4 Terms Used in a Special Sense

When a common English word is used in a particular, technical, or ironic sense for which the writer wants to flag the reader, use **single quotes on first use only**. In subsequent uses within the same publication, set the term in roman without quotation marks.

The committee adopted what it called a ‘soft launch’ approach. The soft launch began on Magshar *sud* Padvo.

Reserve this device for words where the reader genuinely needs to be put on notice that an unusual sense is intended. Don’t use it as a hedge.

3.9.5 See Also

- Italics – when the Indic word itself is italicized; also italics for English emphasis.

- Translation rules – when to translate, when to transliterate.
- Punctuation – single-vs-double rule, dashes, footnote superscript placement.

3.10 Punctuation

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

General typographic conventions for SAP English publications. Footnotes, abbreviations, lists, and apostrophes have their own chapters — see the See Also section below.

3.10.1 Quotation Marks

SAP uses **typographers' (curly) quotes** throughout – single and double – and reserves the two marks for distinct purposes.

- **Single quotes – primary mark.** Use `' '` for highlighting a word or phrase: a term in a special or technical sense, a motto presented as a phrase, the gloss of an Indic term, the title of a short work, a quoted excerpt of authoritative text.
- **Double quotes – speech only.** Use `" "` for direct speech and dialogue: someone quoted as saying or shouting something.
- **Nested.** Inside double-quoted speech, use single quotes; inside single-quoted highlights, use double – invert the marks at each level.
- Always use **typographers' (curly) quotes**: `' '` and `" "`. Straight quotes (`' '`) are typewriter relics; reserve them for code samples and form-field examples.

When typing in source files, plain straight `'` and `"` are auto-converted to the curly forms when the site renders, so authors don't need to enter the Unicode characters by hand. Where you genuinely need to show a *literal* straight quote – e.g. when documenting a code sample – wrap it in backticks so the auto-conversion skips it. The marks shown in code-style above (`' '`, `" "`) use the same trick – backticks tell the renderer to leave them exactly as typed.

For quotation marks specifically around translations of Indic terms, see 3.9 Quotation Marks.

SHOW ME — SINGLE VS DOUBLE QUOTES IN A SINGLE PASSAGE

3.10.2 Dashes

SAP uses two dash characters: the **hyphen** and the **en dash**. The em dash is **not used** in SAP English publications – its role (parenthetical breaks) is filled by a **spaced en dash**.

MARK	WHEN	SPACING	EXAMPLES
Hyphen (-)	Simple compounds	None	<i>non-violence, forty-three, well-known, selfless-love</i>
En dash (–)	Number and date ranges	None (unspaced)	<i>pp. 12–18, 2000–2025</i>
En dash (–)	Place pairs	None (unspaced)	<i>Mumbai–Ahmedabad</i>
En dash (–)	Complex compounds	None (unspaced)	<i>Hindu–Christian dialogue, Vedanta–Yoga synthesis</i>
En dash (–)	Parentetical breaks	One space each side	<i>Bhagwan Swaminarayan – then known as Sahajanand Swami – addressed the assembly.</i>

In InDesign, use the proper Unicode character for the en dash (U+2013), not a double-hyphen -- or a triple-hyphen ---. The em dash character (U+2014) is not used in SAP body prose.

For compound modifiers with numbers (*twenty-nine members, a 5-pound bag, an 18th-century novel*) and the rules on hyphenation between numerals and units, see 3.8.5 Compound Modifiers and Unit Spacing.

SHOW ME — ALL THREE DASH KINDS IN ONE PARAGRAPH

3.10.2.1 Interrupted Dialogue

Use a **spaced en dash** to mark speech sharply cut off — by another speaker, an action, or a sudden break:

- ‘I was just wondering –’ / ‘Don’t ask,’ he snapped.
- ‘I can’t believe it’ – he paced the room – ‘not after all this.’

For speech that **trails off** or falters rather than being cut off, use an **ellipsis**, not a dash:

- ‘I thought perhaps ... but never mind.’

This matches the BrE convention and the spaced-en-dash rule of 3.10.2; CMS uses an unspaced em dash here, which SAP does not.

3.10.2.2 Ranges with *from* and *between*

Don’t combine *from* or *between* with a range dash — use the word pair or the dash, not both:

- ✓ *from 1990 to 2000* / ✓ *1990–2000* / ✗ *from 1990–2000*
- ✓ *between 1914 and 1918* / ✓ *1914–1918* / ✗ *between 1914–1918*

3.10.3 Series and the Oxford Comma

Use the Oxford (serial) comma in lists of three or more:

The Vachanamrut, the Shikshapatri, and the Swamini Vato are foundational texts.

Not:

The Vachanamrut, the Shikshapatri and the Swamini Vato are foundational texts.

3.10.4 Ellipses

A genuine ellipsis is a single character (⋮), not three full stops with spaces. When indicating omitted text within a quotation, use a single ellipsis with a space on each side: *the discourse ... turned to the nature of bhakti*.

3.10.5 Spacing

- **One space** after a period, comma, colon, semicolon – never two.
- **No space** before a footnote superscript: *...the discourse*.¹
- **One space on each side** of an en dash used for a parenthetical break: *...the discourse – and the silence that followed*. (En dashes used for ranges or complex compounds remain unspaced – see 3.10.2.)

3.10.6 Commas with *such as* and *like*

3.10.6.1 Restrictive vs. Nonrestrictive

Whether to use a comma before *such as* (or *like*) depends on whether the examples that follow are essential to the meaning of the sentence.

Nonrestrictive – use commas. The examples illustrate a general statement; removing them leaves the sentence still true.

Citrus fruits, **such as** oranges and grapefruits, are high in vitamin C. (*Without the examples: 'Citrus fruits are high in vitamin C.' Still true.*)

Some sea creatures, **such as** hermit crabs, shed their shells.

Restrictive – no commas. The examples narrow the statement and are essential to its meaning; removing them changes or distorts the truth.

Trees **such as** oaks and elms don't grow at this altitude. (*Without the examples: 'Trees don't grow at this altitude.' Now incorrectly absolute – the original sentence was specific to those species.*)

Foods **such as** pizza and ice cream aren't very good for you.

The same logic applies to *like* used to introduce examples.

3.10.6.2 *such as* vs. *like*

The two phrases are not interchangeable in formal writing.

- ***such as*** – introduces specific examples that **belong to** the category being described.
- ***like*** – introduces things that are **similar to** the category but not necessarily included in it.

I want to live in a big city, **like** Boston or Chicago. (*meaning: a city resembling Boston or Chicago – not necessarily one of those two.*)

I want to live in a big city, **such as** Boston or Chicago. (*meaning: a city, possibly Boston or Chicago themselves.*)

In formal SAP writing – including translations and devotional prose – prefer ***such as*** when listing actual examples drawn from the category. Use *like* only when comparison rather than inclusion is intended.

3.10.6.3 No Colon after *such as*

Don't follow *such as* with a colon – the phrase itself signals that examples are coming:

- ❌ Several rituals are common, **such as: puja, arti, and havan.**
- ✅ Several rituals are common, **such as puja, arti, and havan.**

A colon is appropriate after a complete clause that doesn't already include *such as*: *Several rituals are common: puja, arti, and havan.*

3.10.6.4 How Many Examples

such as is best used to introduce **one to three** examples (occasionally four if all are single words). For longer lists, recast as a vertical list (see 3.13 Vertical Lists) or as an "X include the following: ..." sentence.

3.10.7 Open Questions

- Period inside or outside quotation marks (American vs British)?

3.10.8 See Also

- 3.11 Footnotes – footnote superscript placement and edge cases.
- 3.12 Abbreviations & Acronyms – periods in *Mr / Dr / V.S.*; commas with *i.e. / e.g. / etc.*
- 3.13 Vertical Lists – bullets, numbering, parallel construction.
- 3.14 Apostrophes & Possessives – possessives, plurals of letters, apostrophe of omission.

3.11 Footnotes

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Where to place the footnote superscript relative to surrounding punctuation, and how to handle the edge cases (quoted material, dashes).

3.11.1 Placement

Place the superscript number **after the punctuation** when the note refers to the whole sentence or phrase. Place it **before the punctuation** (immediately after the word) when the note refers to a specific word or term.

REFERENCE OF THE NOTE	PLACEMENT	EXAMPLE
Whole sentence or quotation	After the closing punctuation	...the term used was ‘bahyadrashti’. ¹
Specific word	Immediately after the word, before the punctuation	...the term used was ‘bahyadrashti’ ¹ .

There is **no space** before a footnote superscript. See 3.10.5 Spacing.

SHOW ME — FIVE FOOTNOTE PLACEMENTS IN ONE PARAGRAPH

3.11.2 Footnote Numbers with Colons, Semicolons, and Other Punctuation

The general rule above applies uniformly to **every** punctuation mark — period, comma, semicolon, colon, question mark, exclamation point. When the note refers to the whole sentence or phrase, the superscript follows the punctuation:

- The evidence is inconclusive,¹ the researcher admitted.
- The study claimed that ‘results were reproducible’;² later attempts failed.
- He raised three concerns:³ funding, scope, and timing.

When the note refers to a specific word, the superscript follows that word and precedes the punctuation:

- He cited Mead⁴, Smith⁵, and Wilson⁶ as sources.

Both *CMS* (§14.27) and *Hart’s Rules* (§13.4) give the same guidance — the cue follows the punctuation in all cases. The one standard exception is the **dash** (em or en): the cue precedes it. Since *SAP* uses a **spaced en dash** for parenthetical breaks (see 3.10.2 Dashes) and not the em dash, the exception applies to the spaced en dash:

- The findings were controversial⁷ – and widely disputed.

Place the cue immediately after the word it refers to, before the space and the dash — not after the dash.

(Some older British style guides recommended placing the cue *before* colons and semicolons on the rationale that they’re “soft” punctuation. This convention is no longer the consensus and is not used here.)

3.11.3 Footnote Numbers with Quoted Material

When the footnote refers specifically to **quoted material** within a sentence, the superscript goes immediately after the closing quotation mark:

- According to Wilson, the policy was ‘fundamentally flawed’² in its approach to regulation.

When the footnote refers to a specific word *inside* the quoted text, place it immediately after that word:

- The manuscript referred to ‘*alien*¹ visitors’ throughout the text.

When the sentence ends with quoted material and the note refers to the whole sentence or quotation, the superscript follows the final punctuation:

- Smith argued that ‘economic factors were the primary cause of the uprising’.⁴

Apply these rules consistently within a publication.

3.11.4 See Also

- 3.10 Punctuation — surrounding punctuation rules referenced here.
- 3.10.2 Dashes — the spaced-en-dash convention that determines the dash exception.

3.12 Abbreviations and Acronyms

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

When abbreviations take periods, when they don't, how plurals work, and the conventions for *i.e.* / *e.g.* / *etc.*

3.12.1 Periods — Truncations vs. Contractions

The general principle: a period marks something **omitted at the end** of a word; no period when only **interior letters** are dropped.

TYPE	PERIOD?	EXAMPLES
Truncation (end omitted)	✓ Yes	<i>Mon., Tues., Wed., Prof., vol., cont., etc.</i>
Contraction (interior dropped)	✗ No	<i>Mr, Mrs, Dr, Revd, St (Saint), Ltd</i>
All-cap acronym / initialism (2+ letters)	✗ No	<u>BAPS</u> , <u>CMS</u> , <u>EPUB</u> , <u>PDF</u> , <u>USA</u> , <u>BBC</u> , <u>NATO</u> , <u>PhD</u> , <u>CEO</u>
Personal name initials	✓ Yes (no spaces)	<i>T.S. Eliot, R.K. Narayan</i> — periods between initials, no space between them.
Classical Latin abbreviations	✓ Yes	<i>V.S. (Vikram Samvat), e.g., i.e., etc., a.m., p.m.</i>

V.S. takes a non-breaking space before the year: *V.S. 2080*. (In Markdown source: `V . S .   2080`.)

SHOW ME — PERIOD VS NO-PERIOD IN ONE PARAGRAPH

3.12.2 Acronyms vs. Initialisms

- **Acronyms** are pronounced as words: NATO, NASA, AIDS, COVID. No full stops between letters.
- **Initialisms** are spelled out letter by letter: BAPS (B-A-P-S), BBC, MEP, USA, CMS, PDF. No full stops between letters.

3.12.3 Capitalization by Length

- **Five letters or fewer** — uppercased throughout: BAPS, NASA, NATO, AIDS, COVID, EPUB.
- **Six letters or more** — usually initial capital plus lowercase: *Unesco*, *Unicef*, *Interpol*, *Benelux*.
- Exceptions follow the entity's own convention — some longer acronyms (e.g. UNESCO) are styled all-caps by the organization itself; follow the established form.

3.12.4 Articles before Acronyms and Initialisms

- **Initialisms** generally take *the*: *the BBC*, *the EU*, *the UK*, *the WHO*.
- **Acronyms** generally do not: *NATO meets in Brussels*, *NASA launched*.

- Company, university, and institution names follow the entity’s own convention: *ICI, IBM, UCL, BAPS publishes* (no *the*, even though BAPS is an initialism).

3.12.5 First Mention — Spell Out, Then Abbreviate

On first appearance in a document, write out the full term followed by the abbreviation in parentheses:

The Emissions Trading Scheme (ETS) should enable us to meet our targets.

Subsequent mentions use the abbreviation alone. In long documents, repeat the spell-out at the first occurrence in each major section.

If an abbreviation appears only once or twice in a piece, dispense with it — use the full form throughout. Well-known abbreviations (BAPS, EU, UN, USA) need not be spelled out on first use.

3.12.6 Plurals of Abbreviations

Add a lowercase *s* — **no apostrophe**:

- *MEPs, NGOs, PCs, CDs*
- *1920s, 747s*

Apostrophe-*s* is reserved for the possessive: *MEPs’ salaries, the BBC’s coverage*.

For abbreviations ending in *S*, the plural can take a final *s* (*SOSs*) or be left to stand for both singular and plural where unambiguous (*PES* = “public employment service(s)”). Use the full plural term when ambiguity threatens.

3.12.7 Commas with *i.e.*, *e.g.*, and *etc.*

i.e. and *e.g.* take a comma **before** them in running text but **no comma after**. This is the BrE convention (Oxford, Hart’s, *The Economist*); SAP follows it. The trailing comma is the standard CMS-US form and is not used here.

-  The soul experiences three states, ***i.e. waking, dreaming, and deep sleep.***
-  Several rituals are common, ***e.g. puja, arti, and havan.***
-  The soul experiences three states, *i.e., waking, dreaming, and deep sleep.* (no comma after — *that’s the US form*)
-  The soul experiences three states *i.e. waking, dreaming, and deep sleep.* (no comma before)

etc. takes a comma **before** it when it follows a list of three or more items, and a comma **after** it only when the sentence continues:

-  He renounced wealth, possessions, status, ***etc.*** (*end of sentence — no comma after*)
-  The shop sold notebooks, pens, paper, ***etc.,*** at wholesale prices. (*sentence continues — comma after*)
-  He renounced wealth and ***and etc.*** (*redundant — drop and*)

Use *etc.* only at the end of a list, never with *and* preceding it. In formal writing where the implied additional items might be unclear, *and so on* or *and similar items* often reads better than *etc.*

3.12.8 See Also

- 3.14 Apostrophes & Possessives — apostrophes in plurals of single letters and degrees.
- 3.10 Punctuation — comma rules referenced here.

3.13 Vertical Lists

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Conventions for bulleted, numbered, and lettered lists in SAP English publications.

3.13.1 Bullets, Numbers, or Letters?

- **Bullets** — for unordered lists where items have no inherent sequence or hierarchy.
- **Numbers** — for ordered lists: steps in a process, ranked items, sequences where order matters.
- **Letters** — when items must be referenceable elsewhere (“see item c”) but no specific order is implied.

3.13.2 Parallel Construction

All items in a list must share the same logical and grammatical structure:

- all single words of the same part of speech (all nouns, all adjectives, all verb phrases);
- all phrases of the same construction;
- all subordinate clauses; or
- all main clauses (full sentences).

When the structure breaks, the meaning becomes ambiguous and the list looks ragged.

SHOW ME — BROKEN VS PARALLEL

3.13.3 Punctuation and Capitalization

The conventions depend on whether the items are short fragments that continue from the lead-in, or full sentences in their own right.

Short phrases that continue from the lead-in (lead-in + any item reads as one sentence) — lowercase first word, comma after each, period only at the end:

Sources of funding for community programmes include

- grant funds,
- earmarked funds,
- federal funds, and
- general funds.

If items contain internal commas, use semicolons in place of commas to keep the structure clear:

Recent developments in language teaching include

- more opportunities for students to speak in the target language;
- greater emphasis on effective communication and less on error correction;
- the use of interweaving, spiraling, and recycling techniques; and
- the connection of language learning with instruction in other subject areas.

Full sentences — capitalize each item’s first word and end with terminal punctuation; **no** *and* / *or* between the last two:

Employees who do not pass the certification exam will be retested:

- Candidates who scored below 550 must retake the full battery.
- Candidates who scored 550 or higher may be permitted a partial administration.
- No more than three sessions may be scheduled in one calendar year.

If even one item is a full sentence, treat all items as sentences (caps + periods).

Standalone bullet lists (catalogue-style, not connecting back to a lead-in clause) — the **SAP** default for short reference lists: capitalize the first word, no end punctuation. Used widely on this site:

Pages in this section

- Tone & Voice
- Capitalization
- Italics
- Plurals

3.13.4 Introducing a List

- **Colon** — when the lead-in is a complete sentence (a main clause that could end with a period at that point).

The Vachanamrut quotes from three primary sources:

- **No punctuation** — when the lead-in is an incomplete construction that needs the items to complete it.

The discourse drew from

- the Vedas,
- the Bhagavad Gita, and
- the Vachanamrut.

A colon should not appear after an incomplete lead-in (“*such as*,” “*include*,” “*are*,” — when the words before the colon couldn’t logically end a sentence).

For comma rules around *such as* introducing examples within prose (not a vertical list), see 3.10.6 Commas with *such as* and *like*.

3.14 Apostrophes and Possessives

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Forming the possessive of singular and plural nouns, plurals of letters and abbreviations, and the apostrophe-of-omission in years.

3.14.1 Possessive — Singular Nouns

Form the possessive of a singular noun by adding **'s** — even when the noun ends in *s*, *x*, *z*, or another sibilant:

- Dickens**'s** novels
- Hopkins**'s** poetry
- Bess**'s** dress
- Charles**'s** journey
- the *kothari***'s** assistant
- Bhagwan Swaminarayan**'s** discourses

This follows Chicago and Oxford convention. (AP style would use *Dickens'*, *Hopkins'* — SAP retains the **'s**.)

SHOW ME — APOSTROPHES IN A PARAGRAPH

3.14.2 Possessive — Plural Nouns

- **Plural ending in *s*** — apostrophe only:
 - the boys' books
 - the devotees' offerings
 - the Joneses' house
 - the sadhus' assembly
- **Plural not ending in *s*** — apostrophe + *s*:
 - children's room
 - women's club
 - men's hostel
 - people's choice

3.14.3 Exceptions — Plural-Form Names and Uninflected Nouns

Place names and proper names that are plural in form (ending in *s*) take only an apostrophe in the possessive:

- the United States' policy
- Beverly Hills' tax hike
- the Beatles' first album

- Cisco Systems' CEO

Uninflected nouns — those whose singular and plural forms are identical and end in *s* (*politics, economics, mathematics*) — also take only an apostrophe:

- politics' downside
- economics' central insight

3.14.4 Plurals of Abbreviations and Single Letters

- **Multi-letter abbreviations** — *no* apostrophe (*CDs, NGOs, MEPs, PhDs, 1920s*). See 3.12.6 Plurals of Abbreviations.
- **Single letters** — *use* an apostrophe for clarity, since the bare *s* could be misread:
 - mind your **p's** and **q's**
 - cross your **t's** and dot your **i's**
 - she earned all **A's**

3.14.5 Possessive vs. Attributive in Names and Titles

A noun before another noun can be either **possessive** (apostrophe) or **attributive** (no apostrophe — functioning as an adjective). Both can be grammatically correct; established usage decides which form to use:

FORM	NOTES
Mother's Day, Father's Day	Singular possessive. Established usage.
Veterans Day	Attributive (no apostrophe). U.S. official name.
Mothers' Day	Plural possessive. Sometimes used; less common.
Buyer's / Buyers' / Buyers Guide	All in circulation. Pick one and stay consistent.

For organization names, follow the entity's own form on its official site or publications: *Federal Judges Association, Bankers School* (no apostrophe by their own choice).

3.14.6 Apostrophes in Degrees and Years

- **Degrees** — *bachelor's degree, master's degree, doctor's degree* take an apostrophe (singular possessive), lowercase. The full form *Bachelor of Arts, Master of Science, Doctor of Philosophy* takes initial caps and no apostrophe. Abbreviations follow the no-periods rule from 3.12.1 Periods — Truncations vs. Contractions: *BA, BSc, MA, MSc, PhD, MBA, MD, EdD*. Use **BrE-default forms** — *MSc* (not *MS* / *M.S.*), *MA* (not *M.A.*); *PhD* is fine in either variety.
- **Year omitted from a date** — use a closing single quote (‘, right single quote / U+2019), not an opening single quote:
 - the class of ‘75 ✓
 - the ‘60s ✓
 - in ‘47, India gained independence ✓

In Word and most editors with smart-quote autocorrect, the apostrophe at the start of '75 is auto-formatted as an opening quote ('75). Type the apostrophe twice and delete the first one to force a closing apostrophe.

3.14.7 What an Apostrophe Doesn't Do

The apostrophe marks possession or contraction — never an ordinary plural:

- ❌ apple's for sale ✅ apples for sale
- ❌ tomato's, banana's ✅ tomatoes, bananas
- ❌ in the 1990's ✅ in the 1990s

This applies to family names too: *the Joneses* (plural), *the Joneses' house* (possessive plural).

3.15 Citations & References

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-17.

How to cite books, articles, websites, scriptures, and other sources in SAP English publications. SAP follows the **Chicago Manual of Style (CMS)**, **Notes–Bibliography (NB) system** — the convention used in history, religion, and other humanities disciplines — with **BAPS-specific departures for Hindu shastra citations** (see 3.15.7).

For the placement of footnote superscripts in running text (after a period, before a comma, etc.), see 3.11 Footnotes. This page covers the **content and structure** of each citation; 3.11 covers **where** the superscript goes.

SHOW ME — CITATIONS IN A PARAGRAPH

3.15.1 When to Cite

Cite any source you draw on, not just direct quotations.

TYPE	DEFINITION	CITE?
Quotation	Source's exact words, in quotation marks.	✓ Yes
Paraphrase	Source's specific ideas restated in your own words.	✓ Yes
Summary	The gist of a source's argument in your own words.	✓ Yes
Common knowledge	Widely known facts (e.g., dates of Bhagwan Swaminarayan's lifetime; the existence of the Vachanamrut).	✗ No

When in doubt, cite.

3.15.2 The Three Parts of a CMS Citation

A CMS citation has three coordinated components, all of which must agree:

1. **In-text superscript number** at the point of reference.
2. **Footnote** at the bottom of the page (or **endnote** at the end of the chapter / book), keyed to the superscript.
3. **Entry in the Bibliography** at the end of the publication.

3.15.2.1 In-Text Superscripts

- Numbers run consecutively from **1** throughout a chapter (or, in shorter pieces, throughout the whole text).
- Each superscript follows the clause or sentence it references.
- For placement relative to surrounding punctuation (period, comma, semicolon, colon, dash, quotation mark), see 3.11 Footnotes.

3.15.2.2 Footnote Conventions

- **First citation of a source:** full citation (author, title, publication details, page).

- **Subsequent citations:** shortened form — author's last name + 1–4 keywords from the title + page (e.g., *Harris, Broadway Theatre, 30.*). See 3.15.8.
- **Format:** indented first line; un-indented continuation; full numeral (not superscript) followed by a period.

3.15.2.3 Bibliography Conventions

- One entry per source.
- Alphabetized by the author's last name.
- **Hanging indent** — first line flush left; subsequent lines indented.
- Headed *Bibliography* or *Works Cited* on its own page at the end of the publication.

3.15.3 Books

3.15.3.1 Book, Single Author

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, Title of Book (City: Publisher, Year), page.*

1. Andrew Harris, *Broadway Theatre* (London: Routledge, 1994), 30.

Bibliography format: *Lastname, Firstname. Title of Book. City: Publisher, Year.*

Harris, Andrew. *Broadway Theatre*. London: Routledge, 1994.

3.15.3.2 Book, Two or Three Authors

Footnote format: *Firstname1 Lastname1 and Firstname2 Lastname2, Title (City: Publisher, Year), page.*

1. Kitty Locker and Stephen Kaczmarek, *Business Communication: Building Critical Skills* (New York: McGraw-Hill, 2010), 104.

Bibliography format: Only the first author is inverted.

Locker, Kitty, and Stephen Kaczmarek. *Business Communication: Building Critical Skills*. New York: McGraw-Hill, 2010.

3.15.3.3 Book, Four or More Authors

Footnote format: Use *Lastname et al.* in the footnote; list **all** authors in the bibliography.

1. John Smith et al., *Title of Book* (City: Publisher, Year), 50.

Bibliography format: All authors listed in full.

Smith, John, Mary Jones, Robert Brown, and Sarah Davis. *Title of Book*. City: Publisher, Year.

3.15.3.4 Edited Book / Anthology

Use *ed.* (singular) or *eds.* (plural) after the editor name(s).

Footnote format:

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1. American Theatre Magazine Staff, ed., *American Theatre Reader: Essays and Conversations from American Theatre Magazine* (New York: Theatre Communications Group, 2009).

Bibliography format:

American Theatre Magazine Staff, ed. *American Theatre Reader: Essays and Conversations from American Theatre Magazine*. New York: Theatre Communications Group, 2009.

3.15.3.5 Chapter or Essay in an Edited Book

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname of chapter author, "Title of Chapter," in Title of Book, ed. Firstname Lastname of editor (City: Publisher, Year), page.*

1. Eva Le Gallienne, "On Repertory and Audiences," in *American Theatre Reader: Essays and Conversations from American Theatre Magazine*, ed. American Theatre Magazine Staff (New York: Theatre Communications Group, 2009), 29.

Bibliography format: Include the chapter's page span (not just the cited page).

Le Gallienne, Eva. "On Repertory and Audiences." In *American Theatre Reader: Essays and Conversations from American Theatre Magazine*, edited by American Theatre Magazine Staff, 29–31. New York: Theatre Communications Group, 2009.

3.15.3.6 Translated Book

Include the translator after the title.

Footnote format:

1. Author Name, *Title of Book*, trans. Firstname Lastname (City: Publisher, Year), page.

For BAPS translations from Gujarati, see 3.15.7.12.

3.15.4 Periodicals

3.15.4.1 Scholarly Journal Article

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, "Title of Article," Journal Name volume, no. issue (Year): page, DOI or URL.*

For electronic articles, include a **DOI (preferred)** or stable URL. Include an access date only if the material is time-sensitive (a frequently-revised web resource).

1. Srinivas K. Reddy, Vanitha Swaminathan, and Carol M. Motley, "Exploring the Determinants of Broadway Show Success," *Journal of Marketing Research* 35, no. 3 (1998): 374, <https://doi.org/10.2307/3152034>.

Bibliography format: Include the article's full page span.

Reddy, Srinivas K., Vanitha Swaminathan, and Carol M. Motley. "Exploring the Determinants of Broadway Show Success." *Journal of Marketing Research* 35, no. 3 (1998): 370–83. <https://doi.org/10.2307/3152034>.

3.15.4.2 Magazine Article

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, "Title of Article," Magazine Name, Month day, Year [or Month Year], page [if available], URL [if online].*

1. Author Name, "Article Title," *Swaminarayan Bliss*, July 2020, 32–37.

Bibliography format:

Lastname, Firstname. "Article Title." *Swaminarayan Bliss*. July 2020, 32–37.

3.15.4.3 Newspaper Article

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, "Title of Article," Newspaper Name, Month day, Year, URL [if online].*

1. Kaja Whitehouse, "Pedigreed Wall Streeter Accused of Fraud," *USA Today*, March 28, 2016, <https://www.usatoday.com/story/money/2016/03/28/pedigreed-wall-streeter-accused-fraud/82343104/>.

Bibliography format:

Whitehouse, Kaja. "Pedigreed Wall Streeter Accused of Fraud." *USA Today*. March 28, 2016. <https://www.usatoday.com/story/money/2016/03/28/pedigreed-wall-streeter-accused-fraud/82343104/>.

3.15.5 Online Sources

3.15.5.1 Web Page or Online Article

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname [if known], "Title of Page," Website Publisher, Month day, Year [publication, modification, or access date], URL.*

1. Stan Schroeder, "Facebook Ditches Support for BlackBerry," Mashable, accessed March 22, 2016, <https://mashable.com/2016/03/22/blackberry-facebook-support-end/>.

Bibliography format:

Schroeder, Stan. "Facebook Ditches Support for BlackBerry." Mashable. Accessed March 22, 2016. <https://mashable.com/2016/03/22/blackberry-facebook-support-end/>.

Use the most specific date available: publication date if known, otherwise modification date, otherwise access date.

3.15.5.2 Whole Website

Footnote format:

1. Lewis University Writing Center, accessed September 5, 2024, <https://www.lewisu.edu/writingcenter>.

When citing a whole website rather than a specific page, the website's name takes the role of the title.

3.15.5.3 Blog Post

Treat as a Web Page (above). Italicize the blog's name if the blog is a named publication.

3.15.5.4 Social Media Post

Footnote format: *Author or Account Name, post type or first ~160 characters of the post, Platform, Month day, Year, URL.*

CMS treats social-media posts as informal sources; cite them in the footnote, **not** in the bibliography, unless they are central to the argument.

3.15.6 Specialized References

3.15.6.1 Encyclopedia or Dictionary Entry

Footnote format: *Encyclopedia Name, edition, s.v. "entry term."* For online sources, add access date and URL.

1. *Encyclopedia Britannica*, 16th ed., s.v. "style."
2. *Oxford English Dictionary*, 3rd ed., s.v. "style," accessed September 5, 2024, <https://www.oed.com>.

s.v. is Latin for *sub verbo* ("under the word") — pointing to the entry alphabetized under that headword.

Bibliography: Encyclopedia and dictionary entries are **not normally** included in the bibliography.

3.15.6.2 Government Document

Footnote format: *Issuing Country, Government Division, Subsidiary Divisions [if any], Title of Document, by Firstname Lastname [if available], Report Number (City: Publisher, Year), page [if applicable], URL.*

1. California, Bureau of Investigation, *Russian Organized Crime*, by Dept. of Justice, Division of Law Enforcement (Sacramento, CA: California, 1996), <https://www.fas.org/irp/world/para/docs/rusorg1.htm>.

3.15.6.3 Film or Video

Footnote format: *Title of Film, directed by Firstname Lastname (Year of Release; City: Studio, Year of Physical Copy), format, runtime.*

1. *Dunkirk*, directed by Christopher Nolan (2017; Burbank, CA: Warner Bros., 2017), DVD, 109 min.

3.15.6.4 Lecture, Discourse, or Unpublished Talk

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, "Title of Talk" (lecture, Event Name, Location, Month day, Year).*

1. Pramukh Swami Maharaj, "Glory of Bhakti" (discourse, BAPS Mandir, Sarangpur, August 5, 1995).

For recorded discourses that have been formally published, treat as an audio or video recording (next section).

3.15.6.5 Audio or Video Recording

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, Title (City: Publisher, Year), format, runtime, URL [if online].*

3.15.6.6 Personal Communication

Personal communications (interviews, letters, emails) are cited in **footnotes only**, not in the bibliography.

1. Sadhu Swayamprakashdas, email message to author, May 13, 2026.

3.15.6.7 Thesis or Dissertation

Footnote format: *Firstname Lastname, “Title of Thesis” (PhD diss. / master’s thesis, University Name, Year), page.*

1. Jane Doe, “Devotional Movements in Nineteenth-Century Gujarat” (PhD diss., University of Oxford, 2018), 102.

3.15.7 Hindu Shastra Citations

SAP uses a citation convention for Hindu shastras that **differs from standard CMS NB style** in two specific ways:

- **Shastra titles are roman, capitalized, not italicized** (CMS would italicize them as titles of works).
- **No punctuation between the title and the reference numbers** — *Bhagavad Gita 2.47*, not *Bhagavad Gita, 2.47* or *Bhagavad Gita 2.47*.

The convention balances **academic clarity, scriptural authenticity, devotional sensitivity, and readability for a general or youth audience**. It applies in prose, captions, footnotes, and bibliography entries throughout SAP publications.

3.15.7.1 Recognized Shastras (Established English Forms)

Use the established English transliteration of each title — without diacritical marks unless the publication follows a strict academic system (see 5.2 SAP Diacritics Policy). Capitalize as proper nouns; do not italicize.

BAPS shastras:

- Vachanamrut
- Swamini Vato
- Shikshapatri
- Satsang Diksha
- Bhaktachintamani
- Harililamrut
- Haricharitamrut Sagar

Broader Hindu corpus:

- Bhagavad Gita
- Mahabharat
- Ramayan
- Shrimad Bhagvat
- Upanishads (Katha Upanishad, Isha Upanishad, Mundaka Upanishad, ...)

Generic categories take lowercase — these are common nouns, not titles:

- the Hindu scriptures
- the shastras

- sacred texts
- the epics

3.15.7.2 Citation Format

The general structure for in-text and parenthetical citations is:

Scripture Name + space + Reference

with no punctuation between title and reference.

Examples:

- Vachanamrut Gadhada I 1
- Vachanamrut Kariyani 5
- Bhagavad Gita 2.47
- Shikshapatri 116
- Swamini Vato 5.23
- Katha Upanishad 1.2.18

3.15.7.3 Vachanamrut

Preferred form:

Vachanamrut + Section + Discourse Number

- **Roman numerals** are retained for the three Gadhada sub-divisions (Gadh. I, Gadh. II, Gadh. III).
- **No punctuation** between division and discourse number.

Examples:

- Vachanamrut Gadhada I 54
- Vachanamrut Gadhada II 13
- Vachanamrut Gadhada III 27
- Vachanamrut Loya 7
- Vachanamrut Kariyani 5

Section abbreviations. In citation-heavy or academic contexts, use the abbreviated forms below; define on first use and use consistently thereafter. Two abbreviation systems are in use — a **long form** and a **short form** — pick one per publication.

SECTION	LONG FORM	SHORT FORM
Vachanamrut	Vach.	V
Gadhada I	Gadh. I	G I
Sarangpur	Sar.	S
Kariyani	Kar.	K
Loya	Lo.	L
Panchala	Pan.	P
Gadhada II	Gadh. II	G II
Vartal	Var.	V
Ahmedabad	Amd.	A
Gadhada III	Gadh. III	G III
Ashlali	Ash.	As
Jetalpur	Jet.	J
Bhugol-Khagol	Bhu-Kha	BK

Examples in long-abbreviated form: Vach. Gadh. I 54, Vach. Kar. 5, Vach. Loya 7.

Examples in short-abbreviated form: V G I 54, V K 5, V L 7.

Footnote format (academic):

1. Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Vachanamrut (Ahmedabad: Swaminarayan Aksharpith, 1981), Gadhada I 1.

Bibliography format:

Bhagwan Swaminarayan. Vachanamrut. Ahmedabad: Swaminarayan Aksharpith, 1981.

For the open-discussion history of this convention, see 10.4 Shastras.

3.15.7.4 Swamini Vato

Preferred form:

Swamini Vato + Chapter (*prakaran*) + . + Vaat

Examples:

- Swamini Vato 1.1
- Swamini Vato 5.132

Footnote format:

1. Aksharbrahma Gunatitanand Swami, Swamini Vato (Ahmedabad: Swaminarayan Aksharpith, 1980), 5.132.

3.15.7.5 Shikshapatri

Preferred form:

Shikshapatri + Verse Number

The verse number alone — no “verse” prefix in the in-text form.

Examples:

- Shikshapatri 1
- Shikshapatri 116

Footnote format:

1. Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Shikshapatri (Ahmedabad: Swaminarayan Aksharpith, 1985), 116.

3.15.7.6 Bhagavad Gita

Preferred form:

Bhagavad Gita + Chapter.Verse

Chapter number first, then verse number, separated by a period.

Examples:

- Bhagavad Gita 2.47
- Bhagavad Gita 4.7
- Bhagavad Gita 18.66

Avoid: *Bhagavad Gita Chapter 4 Verse 7* — verbose and inconsistent with the system used for other shastras.

Abbreviation (academic or citation-heavy contexts only): BG 4.7. Define on first use.

3.15.7.7 Upanishads

Use the recognized textual divisions of each Upanishad. Subdivision schemes vary — follow the standard for each.

Examples:

- Katha Upanishad 1.2.18
- Isha Upanishad 1
- Mundaka Upanishad 3.2.4

3.15.7.8 Other Hindu Shastras

Apply the same pattern — established English title followed by the recognized textual division:

- **Mahabharat** — Mahabharat Shanti Parva 12.45 (parva + chapter); in-text references often drop the parva when context is clear.
- **Ramayan** — Ramayan 2.10.5 (kanda.sarga.verse).
- **Shrimad Bhagvat** — Shrimad Bhagvat 1.1.1 (canto.chapter.verse).

3.15.7.9 Use of Abbreviations

Abbreviated forms (Vach. Gadh. I 1, BG 4.7) **aid scanning** in academic or citation-heavy work — scholarly articles, footnote-dense reference books, comparative studies. They are **discouraged** in:

- devotional writing,
- youth-oriented publications,
- magazines, biographies, and pastoral material.

Full forms are preferred for **clarity and reverence**. When abbreviations are used, **define them once** on first appearance, and apply consistently throughout the publication.

3.15.7.10 Quoting Shastras

Short quotations are incorporated directly into the prose with quotation marks. The citation follows immediately, parenthetically or inline:

As the Bhagavad Gita states, “One who gives up all material desires and lives free from a sense of greed, proprietorship, and egoism, attains perfect peace” (Bhagavad Gita 2.71).

Long quotations (more than three lines, or any verse-form passage) are formatted as block quotations:

- separated from the main text,
- **no quotation marks** around the block,
- citation placed immediately after the quotation, prefixed with a spaced en dash.

Whenever dharma declines and adharma rises, I manifest myself to protect the righteous and destroy the wicked, and to establish dharma again. – Bhagavad Gita 4.7–4.8

For the typographic treatment of transliterated verse text within a block (italics, Sanskrit text, macron-only diacritics), see 3.6.4 Shlokas, Padas, and Other Quoted Verses.

3.15.7.11 Placement of Shastra Citations

Inline citations — the reference is integrated into the prose:

Bhagwan Swaminarayan explains in Vachanamrut Gadhada I 54 that true association shapes one’s inner inclinations.

Bhagwan Swaminarayan explains in Vachanamrut Kariyani 5 that desires motivated by worldly enjoyment bind the *jiva*.

Parenthetical citations — the reference is at the end of the supporting clause, in parentheses:

True spiritual progress depends upon association with the Satpurush (Vachanamrut Gadhada I 54).

The Bhagavad Gita teaches disciplined action without attachment to results (Bhagavad Gita 2.47).

Quotation attribution — verse or scripture quoted as a block, with the reference following on its own line, prefixed by a spaced en dash:

“One who gives up all material desires and lives free from a sense of greed, proprietorship, and egoism, attains perfect peace.” – Bhagavad Gita 2.71

3.15.7.12 Translation Note

When citing a published English translation of a Gujarati or Sanskrit shastra, indicate the translator in the **footnote** form (the in-text shastra citation stays the same):

In-text: Vachanamrut Gadhada I 1 *Footnote:* 22. Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Vachanamrut, trans. Sadhu Swayamprakashdas (Ahmedabad: Swaminarayan Aksharpith, 2014), Gadhada I 1.

3.15.7.13 Recorded Discourses

For **published** recordings of Pramukh Swami Maharaj's or Mahant Swami Maharaj's discourses (the *katha* series, commemorative volumes, etc.), treat as Audio/Video Recording (3.15.6.5).

For **unpublished** or internal Sanstha recordings (private discourses, archive material), treat as Personal Communication (3.15.6.6).

3.15.8 *Ibid.* and Shortened-Form Citations

3.15.8.1 *Ibid.* (Immediate Repeat)

When the next footnote cites the **same source** as the immediately preceding one, use *Ibid.* (italicized, with period) + page:

1. Andrew Harris, *Broadway Theatre* (London: Routledge, 1994), 30.
2. *Ibid.*, 32.
3. *Ibid.*

Use *Ibid.* alone (no page) when the page is also the same.

3.15.8.2 Shortened Form (Non-Immediate Repeat)

When citing a source again after intervening notes from other sources, use the **shortened form**: author's last name + 1–4 keywords from the title + page:

1. Andrew Harris, *Broadway Theatre* (London: Routledge, 1994), 30.
2. ...some other source...
3. Harris, *Broadway Theatre*, 45.

3.15.8.3 *Op. cit.* and *Loc. cit.*

Don't use these. CMS deprecated *op. cit.* and *loc. cit.* — use the shortened form (3.15.8.2) instead.

3.15.9 Common Pitfalls

- **✗ Missing publication city.** Always include the city of publication for books.
- **✗ Inconsistent author-name order.** Footnotes always use *Firstname Lastname*; bibliography always uses *Lastname, Firstname* (first author only).

- **✗ Italics on the title of an article or chapter.** Article and chapter titles take **quotation marks**, not italics. Italics are reserved for **whole works** — book titles, journal names, film titles. **Exception:** Hindu shastra titles (Bhagavad Gita, Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, etc.) are **roman**, not italicized — a BAPS-specific departure from CMS. See 3.15.7.
- **✗ Missing DOI for an online article.** Always prefer the DOI over the raw URL when both are available.
- **✗ Putting personal communications in the bibliography.** Personal communications are cited in footnotes only (3.15.6.6).
- **✗ Using *op. cit.* or *loc. cit.*** Deprecated; use the shortened form (3.15.8.2).
- **✗ Mixing styles within a single publication.** CMS NB consistently throughout, or not at all. If a co-author drafts in APA, convert.

For broader editorial pitfalls (Indian-English usages, Gujarati calques, devotional register), see Part 11 Common Editorial Pitfalls.

3.15.10 See Also

- 3.11 Footnotes — placement of the footnote superscript relative to surrounding punctuation.
- 3.12 Abbreviations & Acronyms — the periods rule (e.g., *Vach.*, *Gadh.*) that applies to scripture citations.
- 10.4 Shastras — open discussion on Vachanamrut citation conventions and section abbreviations.
- The Chicago Manual of Style, 17th ed., chs. 14–15 — the authoritative reference.
- Purdue OWL — Chicago Manual of Style — accessible online primer.

4 Tithis

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How to write the names of the days of the lunar fortnight in BAPS English publications.

4.1 The Rule

Tithis are capitalized, set in roman, not italicized, and carry no diacritics – in every position they appear.

This applies whether the tithi name appears alone, in a date, or as part of a compound festival name.

USE	FORM
Standalone	He observes a fast on every Ekadashi .
In a date	The murti was installed on Magshar <i>sud</i> Ekadashi , V.S. 2080.
In a compound name	Sharad Punam, Devshayani Ekadashi , Chaitra <i>sud</i> Padvo .
Paired with the fortnight marker	The fortnight designators <i>sud</i> (waxing) and <i>vad</i> (waning) are italic, lowercase : Bhadarvo <i>vad</i> Bij .

4.2 The 16 Tithis

The Indian lunar month has 30 tithis – 15 in the waxing fortnight (*sud* / *shukla paksha*) and 15 in the waning fortnight (*vad* / *krishna paksha*). The 15th of the waning fortnight is *Amas* (new moon); the 15th of the waxing fortnight is *Punam* (full moon). The other 14 names repeat across both fortnights.

#	GUJARATI FORM	SANSKRIT FORM	NOTES
1	Padvo	Pratipada	First day of the fortnight
2	Bij	Dwitiya	
3	Trij	Tritiya	
4	Choth	Chaturthi	
5	Pancham	Panchami	
6	Chhath	Shashthi	
7	Satam	Saptami	
8	Atham	Ashtami	
9	Nom	Navami	
10	Dasham	Dashami	
11	Ekadashi	Ekadashi	Fasting day; recurs twice each lunar month
12	Baras	Dwadashi	
13	Teras	Trayodashi	
14	Chaudash	Chaturdashi	
15 (waxing)	Punam	Purnima	Full moon
15 (waning)	Amas	Amavasya	New moon

Use the form (Gujarati or Sanskrit) appropriate to the publication’s source language. In Gujarati-source BAPS work the forms in the middle column are standard; in Sanskrit-quoting passages the right-hand column may appear.

4.3 Examples in Context

Each example shows the rule applied in a different sentence shape:

- BAPS Mahant Swami Maharaj will perform the *abhishek* on **Sharad Punam**.
- Devotees fast on every **Ekadashi**, taking one meal of fruit and milk after sunset.
- The shilanyas was performed on Magshar *sud* **Padvo**, V.S. 2080 (28 November 2023).
- **Devshayani Ekadashi** marks the start of *Chaturmas*; **Devuthi Ekadashi** marks its end.
- The festival fell on Bhadarvo *vad* **Atham** – Janmashtami.
- Between **Punam** and **Amas** lies the dark fortnight of *Shravan*.
- The *patotsav* is held annually on Maha *sud* **Bij**.

4.4 Why This Is the Rule

Three Chicago Manual of Style (CMS) clauses converge on the same answer; Hart’s Rules (the BrE counterpart) reaches it identically.

4.4.1 CMS 8.79 – Days of the Week and Months

‘The days of the week and the months of the year are capitalized.’

Padvo, *Bij*, *Trij*... are the **direct functional analogue** of *Tuesday*, *Wednesday*, *Thursday* – they are the named days of the lunar fortnight. *Tuesday* doesn’t drop its capital when used generically (*every Tuesday*); neither should *Ekadashi*.

4.4.2 CMS 8.92 – Religious Holidays, Fasts, and Seasons

‘The names of religious holidays, fasts, and seasons are usually capitalized.’

CMS lists *Diwali*, *Ramadan*, *Yom Kippur*, *Lent* among its examples. *Tithis* belong to that set: *Ekadashi* and *Punam* are explicitly fast days and observance days within the Vaishnava liturgical calendar.

4.4.3 CMS 7.55 / 11.3 – Foreign Words Integrated into English

‘Words and phrases now adopted into English need not be italicized, especially if a definition appears nearby or the term is widely known.’

In a BAPS or Swaminarayan publication aimed at the *satsangi* readership for which SAP publishes, *tithi* names are as familiar as *Diwali* or *Easter*. They cross the threshold from “italicized foreign term” to “roman established designation” – so no italics.

4.4.4 CMS – Documented Religious-Context Allowance

While CMS strict practice would lowercase *tithi* names (treating them as ordinal dates), it explicitly permits **capitalizing *tithi* names in religious or devotional contexts as a style choice to reflect reverence** – provided the choice is applied consistently. SAP publications take that documented option.

4.4.5 Hart’s Rules / New Oxford Style Manual (BrE)

Hart’s reaches the same conclusion via the same logic:

- Religious feast days, fasts, and named days are capitalized (Hart’s §5.1.6).
- Loanwords that have been “naturalized” into the publication’s English drop italics (Hart’s §7.1).

There is no BrE/AmE divergence on this point – both varieties capitalize.

4.4.6 Precedent in the OED

The *Oxford English Dictionary* enters Hindu festival and observance names as **proper nouns**: *Diwali* (capitalized), *Holi* (capitalized), *Navaratri* (capitalized). Treating *Ekadashi* and *Punam* the same way is consistent with how the OED handles their nearest analogues.

4.4.7 Precedent in Wikipedia, Britannica, and Penguin India House Style

All three sources, in their English-language editorial style, capitalize *tithi* names (*Ekadashi*, *Purnima*, *Amavasya*) and set them in roman without italics. None lowercase or italicize.

4.5 What This Rule Does *not* Override

The general SAP rule – ‘Indic words not in the OED are italicized’ – still holds for the broader category of religious common nouns. Tithis are an explicit exception because they function as proper-noun calendar names. Compare:

WORD TYPE	FORM	EXAMPLE
Day of the week (English)	Roman, Cap	every Tuesday
Month (English)	Roman, Cap	in March
Religious holiday in OED	Roman, Cap	Diwali, Easter
Tithi (this rule)	Roman, Cap, no italics	Ekadashi, Punam, Padvo
Indic festival not in OED	Roman, Cap	Janmashtami, Annakut, Pushpadolotsav
Generic religious act	Italic, lowercase	<i>darshan, arti, katha</i>
Generic religious role	Italic, lowercase	<i>sadhu, kothari, mahant</i>

Tithis pattern with the **named days** (rows 1, 2, 3, 4) – not with the generic religious acts (row 6).

4.6 Edge Cases

4.6.1 *Tithi* Itself, as a Meta-Term

The word *tithi* – meaning “a lunar day” in the abstract – is a generic common noun, not the name of any specific day. It follows the standard rule for non-anglicized Indic terms: **italic, lowercase**.

Today’s *tithi* is Maha *sud* **Pancham**.

(*tithi* in italic lowercase; the month *Maha* and the tithi **Pancham** in roman caps; *sud* in italic lowercase – see below.)

4.6.2 Fortnight Designators – *sud* and *vad*

The fortnight designators *sud* (waxing fortnight, *shukla paksha*) and *vad* (waning fortnight, *krishna paksha*) are **italic and lowercase, every time** – when paired with a tithi in a date and when discussed in the abstract:

- Magshar *sud* **Padvo**
- Bhadarvo *vad* **Bij**
- The *vad* fortnight begins after **Punam**.
- During the *sud* of **Shravan**, devotees observe...

This treatment differs from the tithis themselves (which are roman, capitalized) because *sud* and *vad* function as **descriptors** of which half of the lunar month a tithi falls in, not as named days in their own right. They are SAP house style for fortnight designators across all publications.

The Sanskrit equivalents *shukla paksha* and *krishna paksha* follow the same form – italic, lowercase – when used in their generic sense.

4.6.3 Variant Spellings

A handful of tithi names have variant English spellings in current circulation. The forms above are the SAP-preferred spellings:

PREFERRED	SOMETIMES SEEN
Bij	Beej
Choth	Chouth, Chauth
Chhath	Chhat, Chath
Atham	Aatham, Aatam
Punam	Poonam
Amas	Amaas, Amavas

For unsettled variants, see the live discussion in Open Discussions: Transliteration.

4.6.4 Sanskrit Forms in English Text

Sanskrit forms (*Pratipada*, *Dwitiya*, *Purnima*, etc.) follow the same rule – **roman, capitalized, no italics, no diacritics** – when referring to the named day:

The verse is recited on **Purnima**.

The Sanskrit form is appropriate where the source text uses it, or where the readership is more familiar with Sanskrit calendar terms. Within a single publication, **be consistent** – don’t mix *Punam* and *Purnima* arbitrarily.

4.6.5 When a Tithi Appears inside an Italicized Phrase

If an entire phrase is italicized (e.g. a Sanskrit or Gujarati line being quoted), the tithi name participates in that italicization and is set italic too – same as any other word would be:

The verse begins, “*māgha-māsi sitā-pakṣe pratipadī...*”

This is no different from how the word *Tuesday* would be italicized inside an italicized English phrase.

4.6.6 The 12 Gujarati Months

Month names follow the same form as tithis: **roman, capitalized, no italics, no diacritics** – in every position. Treat them like English month names (*March*, *April*).

The 12 months in calendar order, beginning with **Kartak** (the month following Diwali):

#	GUJARATI FORM	SANSKRIT FORM	NOTES
1	Kartak	Karttika	Gujarati New Year (<i>sud</i> Padvo)
2	Magshar	Margashirsha	
3	Posh	Pausha	
4	Maha	Magha	
5	Fagan	Phalguna	Holi (<i>sud</i> Punam)
6	Chaitra	Chaitra	Vikram Samvat New Year; Rama Navmi (<i>sud</i> Nom)
7	Vaishakh	Vaishakha	
8	Jeth	Jyeshtha	
9	Ashadh	Ashadha	<i>Chaturmas</i> begins – Devshayani Ekadashi (<i>sud</i> Ekadashi)
10	Shravan	Shravana	Janmashtami (<i>vad</i> Atham)
11	Bhadarvo	Bhadrpada	
12	Aso	Ashvina	Navratri, Dussehra; Diwali (<i>vad</i> Amas)

Use the form (Gujarati or Sanskrit) appropriate to the publication’s source language. In Gujarati-source BAPS work the forms in the middle column are standard; in Sanskrit-quoting passages the right-hand column may appear. Within a single publication, **be consistent** – don’t mix *Magshar* and *Margashirsha* arbitrarily.

Used with a fortnight designator and a tithi to form a date:

- **Magshar** *sud* **Padvo**
- **Bhadarvo** *vad* **Atham**
- **Maha** *sud* **Pancham**
- **Kartak** *sud* **Punam** – Dev Diwali
- **Aso** *vad* **Amas** – Diwali

In compound names with a tithi, the month behaves as a proper-noun modifier and stays cap roman – e.g. *Magshar Punam* (the full moon of Magshar), *Vaishakh Punam*.

4.7 See Also

- Editorial – Capitalization – the broader SAP capitalization rules.
- Editorial – Italics – the rule from which tithis are an exception.
- Translation Rules – when to anglicize, transliterate, or use the OED form.
- Open Discussions: Transliteration – other unresolved transliteration choices.

Diacritics

5.1 Diacritics & Transliteration

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How we render Sanskrit, Gujarati, and Hindi terms in Roman script across BAPS publications.

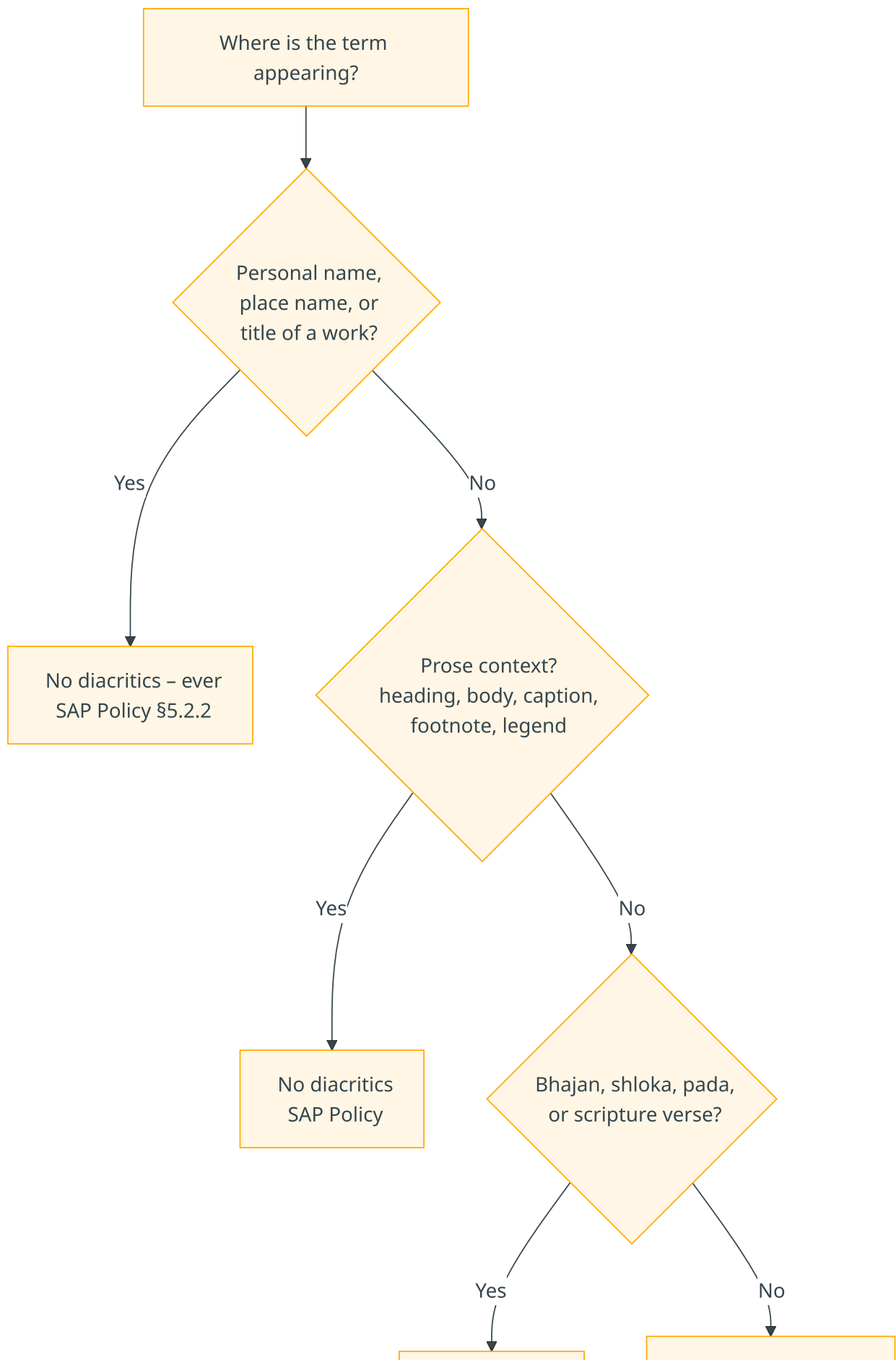
TWO POLICIES – READ THIS FIRST

Two policies are documented on this site, and they apply in **different scopes**.

1. **SAP Diacritics Policy** – the rule for **prose**: no diacritics in headings, body text, captions, footnotes, or names, in any general-reader publication. **Diacritics are not preferred in prose text.**
2. **Macron-Only Convention** – the BAPS in-house diacritic system, used **mainly for transliterations of bhajans and Sanskrit verses** (*shlokas, padas*, scripture-verse content).

The two are complementary, not in conflict: the SAP rule covers prose; the macron-only convention covers verse transliterations. Names never carry diacritics in either context.

Quick Decision



Macron-only
long a → ā

Editorial reference?
illustrating a term
→ Macron-only

Follow this for the common case. The detail lives on the two policy pages.

5.1.1 Pages in This Section

- [SAP Diacritics Policy](#) – no diacritics in prose; diacritics permitted in verse transliterations
- [Macron-Only Convention](#) – long *a* marked with a macron (ā) in transliterations of bhajans and Sanskrit verses
- [Glossary Reference](#) – how to use the master glossary file (reference repository)

5.1.2 Quick Decision

CONTEXT	FORM	SOURCE
Heading, chapter title	No diacritics	SAP Policy
Body text in a general-reader publication	No diacritics	SAP Policy
Photo caption, footnote, legend	No diacritics	SAP Policy
Personal name, place name, title of a work	No diacritics – ever, even in verses	SAP Policy §5.2.2
Bhajan / <i>shloka</i> / <i>pada</i> / scripture-verse transliteration	Macron-only (BAPS in-house default); other systems by project decision	Macron-Only Convention
Editorial reference on this site (when discussing a term)	Long <i>a</i> marked ā – when illustrating the form	Macron-Only Convention

5.1.3 Open Question

The [SAP](#) rule for prose is “no diacritics”. The macron-only convention is the in-house rule for transliterations of bhajans and Sanskrit verses. Whether the macron-only convention should ever appear in prose in a finished publication aimed at the general reader is an open question – see [Open Discussions: Transliteration](#) and send your view via [Feedback](#).

5.2 SAP Diacritics Policy

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

The diacritics policy for **publications for the general reader**.

For the in-house **macron-only convention** used in glossary work and editorial reference material, see Macron-Only Convention. The two policies are scoped differently – see Diacritics & Transliteration for the conflict and how to choose.

5.2.1 The Rule

In publications for general readers do not use diacritical marks in the headings, text, or legends. Diacritics are not preferred in prose text. They may be used in transliterations of bhajans, scripture verses, *shlokas*, and *padas*.

That is:

ELEMENT	DIACRITICS?
Headings	No
Body / prose text	No
Photo captions, footnotes, legends	No
Personal names, place names, organization names, titles of works	No – ever
Bhajan and scripture-verse transliterations (<i>shloka</i>, <i>pada</i>)	Yes – diacritics may be used

5.2.2 Names – Never with Diacritics

Diacritics should not be added to **personal names, place names, names of political parties and organizations, or titles of books and articles**. These words should be spelled in accordance with the SAP transliteration system, but **without diacritics**.

Examples:

- Bhagwan Swaminarayan (not *Bhagwān Swāminārāyaṇ*)
- Sarangpur (not *Sāraṅgpur*)
- BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha (not *BAPS Swāminārāyaṇ Sansthā*)
- Vachanamrut (the title of the work – not *Vachanāmṛt*)

5.2.3 Verses – Diacritics May Be Used

For transliterations of **bhajans, *shlokas*, *padas*, and other scripture-verse content**, diacritics may be used. This is where IAST or another diacritic system is appropriate, because the precision matters for prosody, recitation, and scholarly cross-reference.

The **BAPS in-house default for verse transliterations** is the Macron-Only Convention – long *a* marked with a macron (ā) and no other diacritics. Choice of a different system (full IAST, etc.) is a project-level decision and is documented in Open Discussions: Transliteration.

The transliterated form used in a verse is recorded in the glossary’s **diacriticSpelling** column. The **same word in prose** uses the plain-Roman headword from the glossary’s **term** column.

5.2.4 How This Interacts with the Rest of the Guide

- The rule above – “no diacritics in general text” – applies to **SAP** publications aimed at general readers.
- The Macron-Only Convention is an internal convention used in the **BAPS Glossary** and in editorial reference material where pronunciation needs to be marked unambiguously.
- These two are not in direct conflict because their **scopes are different** – but a publication that mixes the two needs a single rule. See Diacritics & Transliteration for the discussion.

5.2.5 See Also

- Macron-Only Convention – the in-house convention used in the glossary.
- Glossary Reference – the master file that records spellings.
- Open Discussions: Transliteration – the larger set of unresolved transliteration choices.

5.3 The Macron-Only Convention

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

SCOPE

The macron-only convention applies in **two contexts**:

1. **The BAPS master glossary** – the `diacriticSpelling` column records the macron-only form of each term as a reference.
2. **Bhajan and scripture-verse transliterations** within publications – where pronunciation cues matter for recitation and prosody.

It is **not** used in **prose text**. In body paragraphs, headings, photo captions, footnotes, and titles, terms are set in plain Roman with no diacritics. For the prose rule, see the [SAP Diacritics Policy](#). For the larger discussion, see [Diacritics & Transliteration](#).

5.3.1 The Rule

Long *a* vowels in transliterated Sanskrit, Gujarati, and Hindi terms are marked with a macron: **ā**. No other diacritical marks are used.

5.3.2 Why Macron-Only?

Full IAST (International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration) marks every vowel length and every retroflex, palatal, and sibilant distinction – *Akṣharabrahman*, *Vacanāmṛta*, *Swāminārāyaṇa*. This is precise but visually demanding for the general reader, and difficult to typeset consistently across our four-language workflow.

The single most common loss in plain-Roman BAPS transliteration is the long *a* – the difference between *sadhu* (which an English reader pronounces with a short *a*) and *sādhū* (the actual Sanskrit pronunciation). Marking only that one distinction:

- Captures the most common pronunciation error, restoring the long *a* that English readers otherwise miss.
- Keeps text readable for general audiences who are not Sanskrit students.
- Is easy to typeset (a single Unicode character: `U+0101`) and easy to search.
- Stays consistent with how BAPS publications have rendered names like *Swāminārāyaṇ* and *Aksharbrahma* in recent decades.

5.3.3 How to Apply It

Mark a macron on every long *a*. A long *a* is the vowel sound in *father*, not the short *a* in *cat*.

TERM	PLAIN ROMAN	MACRON-ONLY
Sadhu	sadhu	sādhu
Maharaj	maharaj	mahārāj
Bhagwan	bhagwan	bhagwān
Aksharbrahma	aksharbrahma	aksharbrahma (no long-a vowels)
Swaminarayan	swaminarayan	swāminārāyan
Vachanamrut	vachanamrut	vachanāmrut
Pramukh	pramukh	pramukh (no long-a vowels)
Akshardham	akshardham	akshardhām
Gunatitanand	gunatitanand	guṇātītānand → guṇātītānand → gunatītānand?

EDGE CASE UNDER REVIEW

The last entry illustrates a known ambiguity: when a name contains both long *a* and long *i*, the macron-only rule marks only the *a*. *Gunatitanand* becomes *Gunatītānand* in some sources, but our rule strictly marks only long *a*: **Guṇātītānand**. The team should agree on whether to mark long *i* in proper names or leave them plain – send your view via Feedback.

5.3.4 What We Do Not Mark

We do **not** use the following IAST diacritics, even when the source term contains them:

IAST MARK	EXAMPLES WE LEAVE PLAIN
ṣ, ś (sibilants)	<i>Akshar</i> not <i>Akṣhara</i> ; <i>Shikshapatri</i> not <i>Śikṣāpatrī</i>
ṭ, ḍ, ṇ (retroflexes)	<i>Pramukh</i> not <i>Pramukha</i> ; <i>Pratishtha</i> not <i>Pratiṣṭhā</i>
ṛ (vocalic r)	<i>Krishna</i> not <i>Kṛṣṇa</i>
ī, ū (long i, long u)	<i>Bhakti</i> not <i>Bhaktī</i> ; <i>Guru</i> not <i>Gurū</i>
ṁ, ḥ (anusvara, visarga)	<i>Aum</i> not <i>Auṁ</i> ; <i>Namah</i> not <i>Namaḥ</i>

5.3.5 Typing the Macron

TOOL	HOW
Windows	Alt + 0257 on the numeric keypad → ā
InDesign	Glyphs panel → search “0101” → double-click
HTML/Markdown	Type ā directly, or use the entity <code>&#257;</code>
Excel/Word	Insert → Symbol → Latin Extended-A → ā

For high-volume entry, set up an autocorrect rule (Word) or text-replacement (macOS) that converts a typed sequence (e.g. aaa) to ā.

5.3.6 Capital Macron-A

The capital form is Ā (U+0100). Use it at the start of sentences and in proper nouns: *Ādi*, *Ārti*, *Ākash*.

5.3.7 Source-Language Considerations

This convention is for **transliteration into English-language editorial contexts**. Our Gujarati and Hindi publications use the appropriate native script and follow language-team conventions for any embedded Roman text.

When transliterating from a Gujarati source, use the Gujarati pronunciation (often closer to *Bhagwān*); from a Sanskrit source, use the Sanskrit pronunciation (often closer to *Bhagavān*). Record the chosen form in the glossary and use it consistently.

5.3.8 Italicization in Macron-Only Contexts

Within a verse transliteration, the entire verse is italicized as a block (see Italics §3.6.4) – individual term italicization doesn’t come up.

Within an editorial / glossary-reference context (this site, the spreadsheet’s example column), an untranslated transliterated term is italicized on first appearance and explained briefly: *bhakti* (devotion). Subsequent appearances of the same term are set in roman without italics. Proper nouns (names, titles, place names) are not italicized.

NAMES – NO DIACRITICS, REGARDLESS OF CONTEXT

Personal names, place names, organization names, and titles of works are spelled **without diacritics** in both prose and verse – *Bhagwan Swaminarayan*, *Sarangpur*, *the Vachanamrut*. The macron-only convention does not apply to names. See §5.2.2.

WHEN IN DOUBT, CHECK THE GLOSSARY

The master glossary records the agreed spelling for ~1,500 BAPS terms. If a term you need isn’t there, add it – that’s how the glossary grows.

5.4 Glossary Reference

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

The master glossary is a **reference repository** that records, for each BAPS term:

- the **plain-Roman** spelling (used in prose, headings, captions),
- the **macron-only diacritic** spelling, where appropriate, for use in **bhajan and scripture-verse transliterations** only,
- the word class, definition, source language, and any usage notes.

Before introducing or correcting a term in any publication, check the glossary first.

DIACRITIC SPELLINGS ARE FOR VERSES, NOT PROSE

The **diacriticSpelling** column is what to use when transliterating a *bhajan*, *shloka*, *pada*, or other verse content where the macron helps the reader pronounce the term. **In prose text** – body paragraphs, headings, photo captions, footnotes, titles – use the plain-Roman headword. Diacritics are not preferred in prose. See SAP Diacritics Policy.

5.4.1 Where It Lives

The glossary covers Sanskrit, Gujarati, and Hindi terms used across BAPS publications. A link to the current version will be provided here once it is ready.

Columns:

COLUMN	CONTENTS	WHEN TO USE
term	The plain-Roman headword (e.g. <i>sadhu</i>)	Prose, headings, captions – the default in every general-reader publication
wordClass	Part of speech (noun, proper noun, verb, etc.)	Reference
diacriticSpelling	Macron-only spelling, where applicable (e.g. <i>sādhu</i>)	Bhajan and scripture-verse transliterations only
definition	Brief gloss for editorial reference	Reference
sourceLanguage	Sanskrit / Gujarati / Hindi	Reference
notes	Usage notes, alternative spellings, cross-references	Reference

5.4.2 How to Use It

For routine prose editorial work (the typical case):

1. Encounter a term in your text – say, *gunatitanand*.
2. Search the glossary for the headword.

3. Use the spelling from the **term** column (plain Roman, no diacritics) in body text, headings, captions, footnotes, and titles.
4. If the term has a usage note, follow it.

When transliterating a bhajan or scripture verse:

1. For each transliterated term within the verse, look up the headword in the glossary.
2. Use the **diacriticSpelling** column – the macron-only form – for the verse text.
3. The English translation alongside the verse stays in prose form (no diacritics).
4. See Italics §3.6.4 Shlokas, Padas, and Other Quoted Verses for the typographic treatment.

Names – never with diacritics, in either context:

Personal names, place names, organization names, and titles of works are spelled in plain Roman both in prose and in verse transliterations. See SAP Diacritics Policy §5.2.2.

For new terms not in the glossary:

1. Check that it isn't a variant spelling of an existing entry. *Sadguru*, *Sadgurū*, and *Satguru* should not all become separate rows.
2. Propose an addition via Feedback.
3. Apply the macron-only convention when writing the diacritic-spelling field for the new entry.

5.4.3 Related

- SAP Diacritics Policy – the rule for prose: no diacritics in body text, headings, captions, names.
- Macron-Only Convention – the rule the **diacriticSpelling** column applies, for use in verse transliterations.
- Italics §3.6.4 Shlokas, Padas, and Other Quoted Verses – typographic treatment of verses.

InDesign

6.1 InDesign

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Production conventions for our InDesign work – paragraph styles, character styles, object styles, master pages, and patterns used across our long-form publications.

6.1.1 Pages in This Section

- Paragraph Styles – naming conventions and style hierarchies
- Character Styles – inline emphasis, run-in heads, and other character-level treatments
- Object Styles – frame, image, and box styles
- Master Pages – header, footer, and page-number conventions

6.1.2 Environment

- **InDesign** – the latest stable release (currently InDesign 2025; keep this page in step with whatever version the team has standardised on). Windows 11 host.
- **Scripts panel** (Window → Utilities → Scripts) is the standard execution path for our JSX scripts.
- Latest versions of all team scripts are on the Downloads page; usage notes are in Scripts & Tools.

6.2 Paragraph Styles

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

DRAFT PAGE

Document the paragraph-style hierarchies used in our standard publication templates. Add screenshots from the Paragraph Styles panel where helpful.

6.2.1 Why We Standardize

Paragraph styles are the single most important production tool we have. Consistent, well-named styles:

- Make global changes (font, spacing, leading) take seconds instead of hours.
- Drive correct EPUB export – every style maps to a CSS class and contributes to the document’s structural semantics.
- Allow our scripts (ArticleBuilder, AddAltText) to reason about the document programmatically.

6.2.2 Suggested Naming Pattern

A common convention is `Section.Element.Variant`:

STYLE NAME	USE
Body.Default	Default body paragraph
Body.FirstLine	First paragraph of a section (no first-line indent)
Heading.H1	Section title
Heading.H2	Subsection title
Caption.Image	Photo caption
Footnote.Default	Footnote body

The dot-separated naming sorts cleanly in the Paragraph Styles panel and groups related styles visually.

6.2.3 To Document for Our Publications

- Style hierarchies for each long-form publication template
- Cross-publication reusable styles
- Style mapping for EPUB export (which paragraph styles map to which HTML tags)

Contributions welcome – see Feedback to suggest naming changes before they’re applied.

6.3 Character Styles

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

DRAFT PAGE

Document the character-style conventions used across our standard publication templates. Add screenshots from the Character Styles panel where helpful.

6.3.1 Why We Standardise

Character styles apply formatting to **runs of text within a paragraph** — italics for transliterations, small caps for V.S. dates, bold for emphasis, run-in heads at the start of a paragraph, drop caps, footnote references, and similar in-line treatments.

Standardised character styles:

- Make global formatting changes (italic font, small-cap design, emphasis colour) take seconds instead of hours.
- Drive correct EPUB export — every character style maps to an HTML inline element (`em`, `strong`, `span` with class) and contributes to semantic markup.
- Keep typographic treatment of recurring elements (Indic transliterations, scripture references, V.S. dates) consistent across publications.

6.3.2 Suggested Naming Pattern

A common convention is `Element.Variant`:

STYLE NAME	USE
<code>Italic.Indic</code>	Italicised Indic terms (<i>sadhu</i> , <i>darshan</i>)
<code>Italic.Title</code>	Italicised titles of non-shastra works — book, journal, and film titles (e.g., <i>War and Peace</i> , <i>Journal of Hindu Studies</i>). Hindu shastra titles (Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Bhagavad Gita, etc.) are roman , not italic per 3.15.7 — so this style does not apply to them.
<code>Italic.Emphasis</code>	English emphasis (use sparingly)
<code>Bold.Term</code>	Bolded term being defined
<code>SmallCaps.VS</code>	Small-cap V.S. before a Vikram Samvat year
<code>RunInHead.Default</code>	Run-in heading that opens a paragraph
<code>DropCap.Default</code>	Drop cap at the start of a section
<code>Footnote.Ref</code>	Footnote-reference superscript

The dot-separated naming sorts cleanly in the Character Styles panel and groups related styles visually.

6.3.3 **Italic.Indic** — the Workhorse Style

The most-used character style in BAPS publications is the one that italicises non-anglicised Indic terms in the body text. The rule that determines what gets italicised lives at 3.6 Italics; the character style is what applies it consistently.

Apply **Italic.Indic** to non-OED Indic terms (*dandvat*, *kothari*, *patshala*) and the fortnight designators *sud* / *vad*. Don't apply it to anglicized Indic terms (*dharma*, *guru*, *yoga*) or to proper nouns (names, places, festivals, tithis).

6.3.4 To Document for Our Publications

- The full character-style hierarchy for each long-form publication template.
- Cross-publication reusable styles.
- Style mapping for EPUB export (which character styles map to which HTML inline elements).

Contributions welcome — see Feedback to suggest naming changes before they're applied.

6.3.5 See Also

- Paragraph Styles – paragraph-level style hierarchy.
- 3.6 Italics – when to italicise (the rule that **Italic.Indic** mechanically applies).

6.4 Object Styles

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

DRAFT PAGE

Document the object-style conventions used across our standard publication templates. Add screenshots from the Object Styles panel where helpful.

6.4.1 Why We Standardise

Object styles apply formatting to **frames and other page items** — text frames, image frames, sidebars, callout boxes, decorative ornaments, footnote frames. Standardised object styles:

- Make global changes to spacing, stroke, fill, corner options, text-wrap, and frame-fitting take seconds instead of hours.
- Drive correct EPUB export — object styles control whether an item is *included*, *decorative*, or *anchored*, which directly affects the Articles panel and the screen-reader narration order.
- Keep recurring page elements (callout boxes, sidebars, image-with-caption blocks) visually consistent across publications.

6.4.2 Suggested Naming Pattern

A common convention is `Element.Variant`:

STYLE NAME	USE
<code>TextFrame.Body</code>	Default body text frame
<code>TextFrame.Caption</code>	Photo-caption frame
<code>TextFrame.Sidebar</code>	Sidebar / pull-quote frame
<code>Image.Default</code>	Image frame with default fitting and stroke
<code>Image.FullBleed</code>	Full-bleed image frame (no stroke, edge-to-edge fit)
<code>Image.Decorative</code>	Decorative ornament — marked decorative for EPUB , no alt text
<code>Callout.Default</code>	Callout box with stroke, fill, and corner options
<code>Footnote.Frame</code>	Footnote-text frame

The dot-separated naming sorts cleanly in the Object Styles panel and groups related styles visually.

6.4.3 Object Styles and EPUB Accessibility

The most consequential object-style choice for EPUBs is the **Object Export Options** setting — *Default*, *Custom*, or *Tagged Element*. When this is set on an object style (rather than per-instance), every frame using the style inherits the correct EPUB behaviour.

For images:

- Content images use `Image.Default` (or similar) with Object Export Options → Alt Text → *Custom* or *From Structure*. The `AddAltText.jsx` script (see Scripts & Tools) populates these.
- Decorative images use `Image.Decorative` with Object Export Options → Alt Text → *Empty alt attribute*. These are excluded from the screen-reader narration.

See 7.2 Alt Text Guidelines and 7.3 Reading Order for the underlying rules that the object styles encode.

6.4.4 To Document for Our Publications

- The full object-style hierarchy for each long-form publication template.
- Cross-publication reusable object styles (e.g. a shared callout-box style).
- Object-style → EPUB-export-tag mapping.

Contributions welcome — see Feedback to suggest naming changes before they're applied.

6.4.5 See Also

- Paragraph Styles – paragraph-level style hierarchy.
- Character Styles – inline character-level styles.
- 7.2 Alt Text Guidelines – the alt-text rules object styles encode.
- 7.3 Reading Order – Articles-panel sequencing for EPUB export.

6.5 Master Pages

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

DRAFT PAGE

Document the master-page setup for our standard publication templates.

6.5.1 What to Cover

- Margin and column settings for our standard publication templates
- Header content (publication title, section title, page number positioning)
- Footer content
- Conventions for section breaks (do they reset page numbers? change running heads?)
- Special master pages (chapter openers, full-bleed images, etc.)

Add screenshots and example settings as the page is fleshed out.

EPUB

7.1 EPUB Accessibility

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Standards for producing accessible EPUBs from our InDesign source files. Accessibility is editorial, not technical: alt text is writing, reading order is structure, and both belong in the production conversation from the start.

7.1.1 Pages in This Section

- Alt Text Guidelines – writing useful alternative text for images
- Reading Order – the Articles panel and structural sequencing

7.1.2 Why This Matters

Our EPUBs are read on assistive technologies. A screen reader user encountering a photograph with no alt text experiences a silence where the rest of us see a face, a place, an event. Reading order determines whether the screen reader narrates content in the sequence we intended or jumps around the page erratically. These are not edge cases – they are the experience of every reader using assistive tech.

Beyond accessibility, well-formed EPUBs:

- Pass automated validation (DAISY Ace, EPUBCheck) without warnings.
- Index and search correctly in reader applications.
- Display reliably across reading software.

7.1.3 Tooling

The `ArticleBuilder.jsx` script (current version v4.39) automates Articles-panel sequencing for EPUB export. The `AddAltText.jsx` script (current version v17) handles batch alt-text application with caption pre-population. See Scripts & Tools for details.

7.2 Alt Text Guidelines

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Alt text – the *alternative text* read aloud by screen readers in place of an image – is part of the editorial content of an accessible EPUB. Write it with the same care you bring to a caption.

7.2.1 The Three Questions

For every image, ask:

1. **What is this image of?** – the subject, in plain words.
2. **Why is it here?** – what does it contribute to the page?
3. **What would a reader miss without it?** – the answer is what your alt text needs to convey.

If the answer to question 3 is ‘nothing – it’s purely decorative’, the image should be marked decorative (empty alt) rather than given a description. Examples: ornamental dividers, repeated logos, background textures.

7.2.2 What Good Alt Text Looks Like

IMAGE	WEAK	STRONG
A photo of Pramukh Swami Maharaj garlanding a murti	‘Image’	‘Pramukh Swami Maharaj garlands the murti of Bhagwan Swaminarayan during the Patotsav celebration at Sarangpur Mandir.’
A diagram of the Akshardham complex layout	‘Akshardham’	‘Aerial view of Akshardham, New Delhi, showing the central monument flanked by gardens, the lotus-shaped lake to the north, and the surrounding boundary structures.’
A devotee performing arti	‘A man doing arti’	‘A devotee performs evening arti before the murti of Bhagwan Swaminarayan, holding a five-wick lamp and small bell.’

7.2.3 Length and Detail

- **One to two sentences** is the right length for most editorial images.
- **More detail** is appropriate when the image carries information not in the surrounding text – a diagram, a chart, or a photograph the article specifically discusses.
- **Less detail** when the caption already conveys the key information; alt text shouldn’t repeat the caption verbatim.

7.2.4 Conventions for Our Publications

- **Identify people by name** when they’re identifiable and named in the surrounding text. ‘A sadhu’ is weaker than ‘Aksharvatsaldas Swami’ if the article names him.
- **Identify locations** when meaningful: ‘Sarangpur Mandir’ rather than ‘a temple’.

- **Don't editorialise.** Alt text describes what is shown, not what we feel about it. Avoid words like *beautiful*, *magnificent*, *blessed*.
- **Don't begin with 'Image of' or 'Photo of'.** Screen readers already announce that an image is present. Start with the subject.
- **Use the macron-only convention** for transliterated terms in alt text, the same as in body text.

7.2.5 Decorative vs Informative

Mark an image **decorative** (empty alt attribute, often shown as 'Decorative' in InDesign's Object Export Options) when:

- It is repeated across pages with no varying meaning (logos, page ornaments).
- It is purely visual filler with no informational role.
- The information it carries is fully duplicated in nearby text.

Mark an image **informative** (with descriptive alt text) when:

- It illustrates a specific event, person, or place referenced in the text.
- It is a diagram, chart, or map.
- It would be referred to in conversation about the page.

7.2.6 In InDesign

Alt text is set per-image via **Object Export Options** → **Alt Text** (right-click the image → Object Export Options, or use `Cmd/Ctrl` + `Alt` + `F`). For batch application during production, use the `AddAltText.jsx` script – see Scripts & Tools.

The script's caption pre-population feature (added in v17) reads the InDesign caption associated with each image and pre-fills the alt-text field, leaving the editor to refine rather than draft from scratch. This is faster and more consistent than free-form drafting.

7.2.7 Validation

Before exporting an EPUB:

1. Run **Window** → **Articles** and verify every content image is in the Articles panel.
2. Confirm decorative images are tagged as such (Object Export Options → Alt Text → Custom → leave blank, or select 'From Structure' with appropriate tagging).
3. After EPUB export, run **DAISY Ace** for an accessibility report. Address any 'image without alternative text' warnings before delivery.

7.2.8 Related

- Reading Order – how images fit into the document's narrative sequence
- Scripts & Tools – `AddAltText.jsx` reference

7.3 Reading Order

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Reading order is the sequence in which a screen reader narrates the content of a page. In a print book, the reader's eye establishes order through layout convention; in an EPUB, we have to declare it explicitly.

7.3.1 The Articles Panel

InDesign's **Articles panel** (Window → Articles) is where reading order is defined for EPUB export. Every content element on every page should be a member of an article, in the order it should be read.

7.3.2 Common Problems We Encounter

PROBLEM	SYMPTOM	FIX
Stale members	Articles panel lists more entries than there are content elements on the spread	Remove deleted/replaced items; deduplicate
Decorative items in articles	Page ornaments narrated as content	Remove from Articles panel; mark Object Export Options as decorative
Anchored images in wrong sequence	Image narrated before its caption	Reorder within the article
Multi-column flow	Right column narrated before left finishes	Confirm article order matches intended reading sequence

7.3.3 Cleaning the Articles Panel

The standard cleanup pattern:

1. Open Articles panel and the affected document.
2. For each spread, compare panel members to actual content. Remove stragglers (deleted images that left their entries behind).
3. Remove decorative ornaments that crept in from the InDesign auto-add.
4. Verify each content image is present exactly once.
5. Verify the within-article order matches reading flow.

This is tedious by hand. The `ArticleBuilder.jsx` script automates much of it – see Scripts & Tools.

7.3.4 Anchored Images

Anchored images (images anchored to a text frame) need special attention. Their position in the reading order is determined by the anchor location, not the visual position on the page. If an image visually appears at the bottom of a column but its anchor is mid-paragraph, it will be narrated mid-paragraph – usually disrupting the flow.

`ArticleBuilder.jsx` handles anchored images explicitly. From v4.39, it walks `page.allPageItems` (across all pages) to find anchored objects and inserts them into the article at sensible positions.

7.3.5 ExtendScript Notes

For team members writing or extending JSX scripts that touch reading order:

- Use `item.allPageItems`, not `item.pageItems`, to get typed objects (groups, images within groups, etc.).
- Use `page.allPageItems` to find anchored objects across all pages.
- Use `story.changes.count()` (InDesign 2025 API) to detect track-changes entries.

These quirks are documented in greater detail in the Scripts reference.

7.3.6 Verifying Reading Order

Before EPUB export:

1. **Window** → **Articles** – visually scan each article’s member list.
2. **File** → **Export** → **EPUB** with the option *Use → Articles panel* selected for content order.
3. Open the exported EPUB in a screen reader (NVDA on Windows, VoiceOver on macOS) and listen to a few pages.
4. Run DAISY Ace for an automated reading-order report.

A few minutes of listening to the actual narration catches problems that visual scanning misses every time.

7.3.7 Related

- Alt Text Guidelines – how to write the text screen readers will narrate for images
- Scripts & Tools – `ArticleBuilder.jsx` reference

Scripts

8.1 Scripts & Tools

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Reference for the JSX scripts and automation tools used by the BAPS DTP team.

8.1.1 Pages in This Section

- JSX Scripts Reference – usage notes for our InDesign scripts

8.1.2 Where to Find the Scripts

The latest version of every team script is on the Downloads page. Download the file you need and drop it into InDesign’s User Scripts folder so it appears in the Scripts panel.

To open the User Scripts folder from InDesign: **Window** → **Utilities** → **Scripts**, right-click *User* in the Scripts panel, *Reveal in Explorer / Finder*.

8.1.3 Running Scripts

Once a script is in the User Scripts folder, double-click it in the Scripts panel to run it.

8.1.4 Versioning

Every script revision gets a version number in both the filename and the internal version string. Never overwrite an earlier version. See versioning rules.

Current versions of the major scripts (May 2026):

SCRIPT	CURRENT VERSION
ArticleBuilder.jsx	v4.39
AddAltText.jsx	v17
ExportToWord_Generic.jsx	v11g

8.2 JSX Scripts Reference

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Quick reference for the InDesign JSX scripts used in BAPS DTP production. Each entry covers what the script does, how to run it, and notable behaviour.

8.2.1 ArticleBuilder.jsx

Current version: v4.39

Purpose: Automates Articles panel sequencing for EPUB export. Walks the document, identifies content elements, and produces a clean reading order.

Run: Double-click in the Scripts panel.

Key behaviours:

- Uses `item.allPageItems` (not `item.pageItems`) to surface typed objects from groups.
- Uses `page.allPageItems` across all pages to locate anchored objects.
- Pre-computes all DOM work before the dialogue (`pd.show()`) opens – this prevents InDesign crashes from long-running operations inside ScriptUI.
- Replaced the broken ScriptUI scrolling preview with an HTML-in-browser preview.

Notable edge cases:

- Anchored images are placed in the article based on the anchor's text position, not visual position on the page.
 - Decorative items must be tagged via Object Export Options before running, or the script will include them.
-

8.2.2 AddAltText.jsx

Current version: v17

Purpose: Batch alt-text application for images in an InDesign document.

Run: Double-click in the Scripts panel.

Key behaviours:

- v17 introduced caption pre-population: the script reads the InDesign caption associated with each image and pre-fills the alt-text field, so the editor refines rather than drafts from scratch.
- Operates on selected pages or the whole document.
- Skips items already tagged decorative.

Workflow:

1. Ensure each image has an associated caption in InDesign.
2. Run the script.
3. Review and refine each pre-populated alt text in the dialogue.

4. Apply.

8.2.3 ExportToWord_Generic.jsx

Current version: v11g

Purpose: Exports an InDesign story or document to RTF/Word format with paragraph numbering and track changes preserved.

Run: Double-click in the Scripts panel.

Key behaviours:

- Injects paragraph numbering into the export.
- Wraps operations in `app.doScript` with undo, so the document can be reverted to its pre-export state non-destructively.
- Sorts content by reading order.
- Exports tracked changes as green-underlined text.
- Excludes master page items from the export.

Required InDesign 2025 APIs:

- `story.changes.item(i)` for iterating track changes.
 - `ChangeTypes.INSERTED_TEXT` for filtering insertions.
-

8.2.4 ExtendScript Gotchas

A handful of issues that have caught us out and are worth knowing before writing or extending InDesign `JSX` scripts:

`item.pageItems` vs `item.allPageItems`

- **What's the difference.** `pageItems` returns only the *direct* children of a container as generic `PageItem` objects. `allPageItems` recursively walks all descendants and returns each as its **proper type** — `Image`, `TextFrame`, `Group`, `Rectangle`, etc.
- **Why it matters.** If a script needs to ask *what kind of thing is this?* (e.g. “is this an image?”), `pageItems` will give back generic page items that lose their type info. `allPageItems` preserves the type.
- **Rule of thumb.** Use `allPageItems` whenever the script needs to branch on object type, walk into groups, or count specific kinds of items. Use `pageItems` only when you just need direct children and don't care about types.

Finding anchored images

- **What goes wrong.** Anchored images (images attached to a text-flow position) don't appear when you enumerate `spread.pageItems` — the spread-level collection doesn't surface anchored objects, only those positioned freely on the page.
- **Fix.** Walk `page.allPageItems` across **every page** in the document instead. Anchored objects appear there.

- **Why this matters for us.** `ArticleBuilder.jsx` relies on this — the script’s job is to build the EPUB reading order, and anchored images would be missed if we only checked spread-level enumeration.

Track changes — InDesign 2025 API

- **What changed.** The track-changes API was rewritten in InDesign 2025. The older `story.trackChangesPreferences` and related properties are deprecated and behave inconsistently in the new version.
- **What to use instead.**
 - `story.changes.count()` — number of change records on the story.
 - `story.changes.item(i)` — the *i*-th change record (0-indexed).
 - `ChangeTypes.INSERTED_TEXT` (and other `ChangeTypes.*` constants) — to filter by change type.
- **Why this matters for us.** `ExportToWord_Generic.jsx` exports tracked changes into the Word document — it had to be rewritten against the new API for InDesign 2025 compatibility.

ScriptUI scrolling is broken in long lists

- **What goes wrong.** ScriptUI (the JavaScript-based dialog framework InDesign uses) has a long-standing bug where `listbox` and `treeview` controls don’t scroll reliably once the list grows beyond a screen-full — the scrollbar stops responding, the highlight jumps, or items above the viewport become unreachable.
- **Workaround.** When the script needs to show a scrollable list of more than ~20 rows (e.g. previewing the article order before applying), generate an HTML page on disk and open it in the system browser instead. The browser’s scrolling Just Works.
- **Why this matters for us.** `ArticleBuilder.jsx` previously crashed or stalled on long Articles-panel previews; replacing the ScriptUI list with an HTML preview fixed it.

Pre-compute everything before `pd.show()`

- **What `pd` is.** A common script idiom — `pd` for “progress dialog” — a ScriptUI window opened to show progress/feedback while the script does work.
- **What goes wrong.** If long-running DOM operations (looping over hundreds of page items, modifying many styles, etc.) run **after** `pd.show()` is called, InDesign frequently crashes or hangs. The ScriptUI event loop and the scripting DOM compete for the main thread.
- **Pattern that works.** Do *all* the heavy work first — walk the document, gather what’s needed, build result arrays — then show the dialog with the pre-computed data. The dialog should only be displaying or applying simple decisions, not doing the analysis.

```
// Bad: dialog opens, then the slow walk runs while it's open.
pd.show();
for (var i = 0; i < doc.allPageItems.length; i++) { /* ... */ }

// Good: walk first, store, then show.
var items = [];
for (var i = 0; i < doc.allPageItems.length; i++) { items.push(/* ... */); }
pd.show(); // dialog only displays / applies the results.
```

8.2.5 Related

- Versioning Rules – every script edit produces a new versioned file
- Reading Order – what `ArticleBuilder.jsx` actually produces
- Alt Text Guidelines – what `AddAltText.jsx` actually applies

Workflows

9.1 Workflows

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Production conventions that span across publications and tools – versioning, naming, and handoff patterns.

9.1.1 Pages in This Section

- File Versioning Rules – the non-negotiable versioning rule
- File Naming – patterns for files, folders, and revisions

9.1.2 Why Workflows Matter

A consistent workflow is the difference between finding the file you need in five seconds and spending half an hour reconstructing what happened. The conventions in this section exist because we've all paid the cost of their absence.

9.2 File Versioning Rules

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Every file output – script, Word document, Excel file, PDF, or any other deliverable – must carry an incremented version number in **both** the filename and an internal version string. **Never overwrite a previous version.** Each new file is the next version.

9.2.1 The Rule

When you produce a new revision of any file:

1. Increment the version number in the filename (`v1.0` → `v1.1`).
2. Update any internal version string inside the file to match.
3. Save as a new file. Do not overwrite the previous version.
4. The previous version stays where it is.

9.2.2 Versioning Scheme

CHANGE TYPE	VERSION BUMP
Minor edit, fix, refinement	Patch: <code>v4.28</code> → <code>v4.29</code>
Substantive revision, new feature, new section	Minor: <code>v4.39</code> → <code>v5.0</code> , or <code>v1.2</code> → <code>v1.3</code>
Complete restructure, breaking change	Major: <code>v1.x</code> → <code>v2.0</code>

For most day-to-day work, increment the patch number. Reserve minor and major bumps for genuinely substantial changes.

9.2.3 Filename Pattern

Place the version near the end of the filename, before the extension:

```
glossary-all-2026-04-15_v1.2.xlsx
ArticleBuilder_v4.39.jsx
Brief_Vachanamrut_v3.docx
MSM_Vicharan_2016-23_v2.xlsx
```

For dated files, the date stays the date it was first created or the snapshot date; the version increments independently.

9.2.4 Internal Version Strings

Where the file format allows, store the version inside the file too:

FILE TYPE	WHERE TO PUT THE VERSION
JSX / Python script	A <code>// VERSION = "v4.39"</code> or <code># VERSION = "v1.2"</code> line near the top
Excel	A <code>Version</code> cell in a metadata sheet, or in cell A1 of the first sheet
Word	The footer, or a metadata table on the cover page
PDF	The footer of every page
HTML	A <code><meta name="version" content="v1.2"></code> tag

The internal version must match the filename version. Mismatches are confusing and worse than absent.

9.2.5 Why This Rule Exists

We have lost real work – and worse, lost the ability to *prove* what changed when – by overwriting files. The cost of an extra few KB on disk is trivial. The cost of not being able to roll back to last week’s version of a script that used to work is enormous.

Beyond rollback, versioning gives us:

- **Audit:** a clear trail of what changed, when, and by whom.
- **Diffing:** the ability to compare two versions to understand a change.
- **Collaboration:** colleagues can refer to “the v4.38 behaviour” unambiguously.
- **Confidence:** you can experiment knowing the previous version is intact.

9.2.6 What to Do with Old Versions

Keep them. Disk is cheap, lost work is expensive. If a folder is getting cluttered, archive older versions into an `_archive/` subfolder rather than deleting them.

9.2.7 Apply This Rule Automatically

This rule should be applied to every file output **without being asked**. If you’re producing a file and you didn’t bump the version, stop and bump it. If a tool or script generates output, the tool’s version-bumping behaviour should be built in.

For Claude-assisted work, the rule is encoded in the team’s working memory: every Claude session producing a file output is expected to apply versioning without being prompted.

9.2.8 Related

- File Naming – broader filename conventions

9.3 File Naming

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

How we name files, folders, and revisions across the DTP workflow.

9.3.1 General Principles

- **Use lowercase and hyphens** for new files where possible: `master-glossary-2026-04-15_v1.2.xlsx`. Underscores and mixed case are fine for files inheriting from existing conventions.
- **No spaces** in filenames for anything that will pass through scripts or be referenced in a URL.
- **Date-stamp** files where the snapshot date matters (glossaries, exports, batch outputs). Use ISO dates: `YYYY-MM-DD`.
- **Version-stamp** every file output. See versioning rules.

9.3.2 Patterns We Use

TYPE	PATTERN	EXAMPLE
Versioned glossary	<code>name-YYYY-MM-DD_vX.Y.xlsx</code>	<code>glossary-all-2026-04-15_v1.2.xlsx</code>
Script	<code>Name_vX.Y.jsx</code>	<code>ArticleBuilder_v4.39.jsx</code>
Brief / spec doc	<code>Brief_Topic_vX.docx</code>	<code>Brief_Vachanamrut_v3.docx</code>
Project export	<code>Project_Description_vX.ext</code>	<code>MSM_Vicharan_2016-23_v2.xlsx</code>

9.3.3 Folder Organization

Organize active work by publication, with shared resources (scripts, glossaries, templates) in their own top-level folders. A typical layout:

DTP-root/	
├ Current/	
│ ├── <Publication-A>/	
│ │ ├── <Edition-or-Year>/	# working files for one edition
│ │ └ <Publication-B>/	# working files for another publication
│ └ Scripts/	# canonical scripts location
└ <Toolchain>/	# other shared toolchains

Keep working files in their publication folder. Move reusable assets (scripts, shared glossaries, templates) to the appropriate shared location.

9.3.4 What Not to Do

- Don't put dates in folder names if the folder's contents are continuously updated. Date the *files*, not the *folder*.

- Don't use 'final', 'FINAL', 'really-final', 'USE-THIS-ONE', or similar markers. Use the version number – that's what it's for.
- Don't bury versioning inside the filename: `v1.2-glossary.xlsx` sorts unhelpfully. Put the version near the end: `glossary_v1.2.xlsx`.

9.3.5 Related

- Versioning Rules – the version-number rule itself

Discussions

10.1 Open Discussions

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

A live record of conventions the team has not yet settled. Each page below preserves the open questions, with room for the team to record decisions as they're made.

These are **not** rules. They are decisions waiting to be made.

HOW TO USE THESE PAGES

- **Reading them?** Treat each item as “currently any of these is acceptable, but the team is working towards one.” When in doubt, follow the rules elsewhere in this guide and the glossary.
- **Have an opinion?** Send your view via Feedback – include the specific item in your message.
- **Decision reached?** The maintainer updates the page so the rest of the team can see, and adds an entry to the changelog.

10.1.1 Pages in This Section

- Sanstha & Mandirs – naming the Sanstha and individual mandirs
- Gurus & Honorifics – Shriji Maharaj, the gurus, sadhus
- Shastras – titles and citation conventions for our scriptures
- Indic Words – plurals, currency, units
- Transliteration – the long list of transliteration choices still under discussion
- Base Style Manual – should we adopt Chicago / AP / Oxford as our base?

10.1.2 A Meta Note

What options should we allow and what preferences should we advocate regarding the points below? Add to the variations as you deem necessary. Add more points also.

That instruction stands. These pages are meant to grow.

10.2 Sanstha & Mandirs

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Open questions on naming the Sanstha as a whole, and naming individual mandirs.

10.2.1 Sanstha – Names and Short Forms

Variations in current use:

- BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Sanstha
- BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha
- BAPS Sanstha
- the Sanstha
- BAPS

Open questions:

- Which is the **full official name** for first mention?
- What's the **preferred short form** for subsequent mentions?
- When (if ever) is *the Sanstha* (capitalized) appropriate vs *the sanstha*?
- Should BAPS alone be used after the full name has been introduced, or should BAPS Sanstha be preferred for clarity?

10.2.2 Mandirs – Naming Individual Mandirs

Variations in current use for Sarangpur:

- BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Mandir, Sarangpur
- BAPS Sarangpur
- Sarangpur Mandir
- Sarangpur BAPS Mandir
- the BAPS mandir in Sarangpur

Variations in current use for London:

- London Mandir
- London BAPS Mandir
- Neasden Mandir
- Neasden BAPS Mandir
- the mandir in Neasden
- the Mandir in Neasden

Open questions:

- For first mention, do we use the full formal name (*BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Mandir, Sarangpur*) or a short form?
- Is the short form **noun-then-mandir** (*Sarangpur Mandir*) or **mandir-then-noun** (*the BAPS mandir in Sarangpur*)?
- *Mandir* with an initial capital, or lowercase? (Affects *the Mandir in Neasden* vs *the mandir in Neasden*.)
- For the London mandir specifically: is it **London** or **Neasden**? Are these interchangeable?

10.2.3 Have an Opinion?

Propose wording via Feedback – use a subject like *Sanstha: ...* or *Mandir:*

10.3 Gurus & Honorifics

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Open questions on naming and addressing Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Aksharbrahma Gunatitanand Swami, the gurus of the BAPS parampara, and the sadhus.

10.3.1 Bhagwan Swaminarayan

How to address him and what to use in which situations...

Variations in current use:

- Bhagwan Swaminarayan
- Swaminarayan Bhagwan
- Shriji Maharaj
- Sahajanand Swami
- Shri Hari / Shrihari
- manifest / incarnate
- Parabrahma
- Paramatma

Open questions:

- Which form is preferred for first mention vs subsequent mentions?
- *Shri Hari* (two words) or *Shrihari* (one)?
- *manifest* vs *incarnate* – are these synonymous in our usage?

10.3.2 Aksharbrahma Gunatitanand Swami

Variations in current use:

- Aksharbrahma Gunatitanand Swami (Maharaj)
- Akshar
- Akshardham
- Brahmadham
- Brahmamahol

Open questions:

- Is *Maharaj* part of the standard form, or optional?
- *Akshar* / *Aksharbrahma* – preferred form?
- When referring to the abode, *Akshardham* vs *Brahmadham* vs *Brahmamahol*?

10.3.3 Murti Forms

Variations in current use:

- Thakorji
- Lalji Maharaj
- Shri Harikrishna Maharaj
- Shri Gunatitanand Swami (Maharaj)
- Shri Akshar-Purushottam Maharaj

Open questions:

- Hyphenated *Akshar-Purushottam* or *AksharPurushottam* or *Akshar Purushottam*?

10.3.4 The Brahmaswarup Gurus

Standard form in current use:

- Brahmaswarup Bhagatji Maharaj
- Brahmaswarup Shastriji Maharaj
- Brahmaswarup Yogiji Maharaj
- Brahmaswarup Pramukh Swami Maharaj

Open questions:

- *Brahmaswarup* always present on first mention? Always on every mention? Optional?
- For the current guru, is *Pragat Brahmaswarup* the prefix used during his lifetime?

10.3.5 Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj

Variations in current use for Mahant Swami Maharaj:

- Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj
- Guruhari / *guruhari* Mahant Swami Maharaj
- manifest / pragat form of Bhagwan Swaminarayan
- manifest / pragat form of Aksharbrahma
- Pragat Brahmaswarup Param Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj
- Param Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj
- Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj
- Swamishri
- Param Pujya Swamishri
- Swami Bapa
- Swamibapa

Open questions:

- *Guruhari* (capital, roman) or *guruhari* (italic) – which scope?
- *Swami Bapa* (two words) or *Swamibapa* (one word)?
- When to use *manifest*, when *pragat*?

10.3.6 Anglophone Honorifics

Variations in current use:

- His Holiness Pramukh Swami Maharaj
- His Divine Holiness Pramukh Swami Maharaj

Open question: which is preferred, and is it used in body text or only in formal contexts (citations, dedications)?

10.3.7 Sadhus

Variations in current use for senior sadhus:

- Sadguru Param Pujya Dr Swami (Swayamprakash / das / ji Swami)
- Param Pujya Dr Swami
- Pujya Dr Swami
- Pujya Narayanmuni / das / ji Swami
- Kothari Pujya Jnaneshwar / das / ji Swami / the *kothari* of Sarangpur Mandir
- Mahant Param Pujya Anandswarup / das / ji Swami / the mahant
- Sadhu Jnanprasaddas, Sadhu Yogiswarupdas / sadhus Jnanprasaddas and Yogiswarupdas

Variations in current use for collective references:

- Senior sadhus
- Senior swamis
- Sadgurus / *sadgurus*

Open questions:

- *-das* / *-ji* / *-das-ji* – which suffix on first mention vs subsequent?
- Position-titles (*kothari*, *mahant*) – italicized or roman; capitalized or lowercase?
- *Sadgurus* (capital, roman) vs *sadgurus* (italic) – when?

10.3.8 Have an Opinion?

Propose wording via Feedback – note the specific term in your subject.

10.4 Shastras

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-17.

Open questions on naming, citing, and formatting our scriptural texts.

SEVERAL QUESTIONS ON THIS PAGE HAVE BEEN RESOLVED

The italicization, citation format, and section-separator questions in 10.4.1 are now settled — see 3.15.7 Hindu Shastra Citations. The ‘Shri’ question at 10.4.2 remains open.

10.4.1 Title Forms

Resolved

- **Which titles are italicized?** → **Not italicized.** Hindu shastra titles (Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Swamini Vato, Bhagavad Gita, etc.) are **roman, capitalized**. See 3.15.7.
- **Citation format?** → **Vachanamrut Gadhada I 1** (full); **Vach. Gadh. I 1** (long-abbreviated); **V G I 1** (short-abbreviated). See 3.15.7.3.
- **Section separator?** → **None.** No punctuation between title and reference, no punctuation between Roman-numeral volume and discourse number.
- **Full vs abbreviated titles?** → Use the full form in devotional / youth-oriented writing; abbreviated forms aid scanning in academic / citation-heavy work. See 3.15.7.9.

Still Open

- How do we **hyphenate** long compound titles to aid pronunciation? (Shriharililamrut, Haricharitrाम्रुतसगर, etc.)

10.4.2 ‘Shri’ – Honorific or Part of the Title?

Also, is it ‘Shriharililamrut’ or ‘Shri Harililamrut’ or ‘Shrihari Lilamrut’ – is ‘Shri’ an honorific or part of the title? Same with Shriharililakalpataru, etc.

Open question: when *Shri* prefixes the name of a person inside a title (e.g. *Shri Hari* in *Shriharililamrut*), is it:

- **Part of the title** – written attached, no space, no italic split: *Shriharililamrut*?
- **An honorific outside the title** – written separately and not italicized when the rest is italicized: *Shri Harililamrut* (where *Harililamrut* would be the title proper)?
- Or a **third option** – *Shrihari Lilamrut*, treating *Shrihari* as a name and *Lilamrut* as the descriptor?

The same question applies to *Shriharililakalpataru* and similar compound titles.

10.4.3 Have an Opinion?

Propose a citation format via Feedback – use a subject like *Shastras*:

10.5 Indic Words

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Open questions on plurals, currency, and units of measure.

10.5.1 Plurals

Variations in current use:

- *rotlo / rotla / rotlos*
- *divo / diva / divos*
- *kalash / kalashes*
- *gavaksh / gavaksha / gavakshas*
- *sant / sants / santo*

Open question: for each item above, what is the preferred singular and plural in SAP English publications? See Plurals for the general rule (native plural for transliterations, OED plural for anglicized words, no anglicized -s on fully transliterated words).

The harder cases are words that have a **native plural that doubles as the singular** in English usage (e.g. *sant* used as both singular and plural).

10.5.2 Currency

Variations in current use:

- Rupees / rupees / (symbol ₹)
- *ral*
- *dokdo / dokda / dokdos*

Open questions:

- *Rupees* (capitalized), *rupees* (lowercase), or the symbol ₹ – when and where?
- For historical denominations (*ral*, *dokdo*): preferred singular and plural; abbreviation?

10.5.3 Units of Measure

Variations in current use:

- *gau*
- maund / maunds
- *vigho / vigha / vighos*

Open questions:

- For each unit, what is the preferred singular and plural?
- Is there a preferred **abbreviation** for any of these?

- When a unit is mentioned alongside a metric equivalent, what's the format? (E.g., *one vigha (about 0.4 ha)*?)

10.5.4 Have an Opinion?

Send your view via Feedback – use a subject like *Plurals: ...*, *Currency: ...*, or *Units:*

10.6 Transliteration

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

The largest open-questions list. These questions cover the rules of romanizing Gujarati and Devanagari script – what to do about diacritics, ligatures, the “stray *a*”, visarga and anusvara, hyphenation, and the many cases where a single Gujarati word has multiple plausible roman spellings.

10.6.1 Source Scripts and Target Script

- Gujarati script (*lippi*) and the corresponding roman transliteration.
- Devanagari script (*lippi*) for Sanskrit and Hindi, and the corresponding roman transliteration.

10.6.2 Diacritics – Yes, No, Which?

- **With or without** diacritics?
- Transliterations in **prose vs verse** – different rules?
- If with diacritics, **which system?** Macron, underpoint, overpoint, etc.
- If without diacritics, do we use long-vowel doublings such as **aa / oo / ee**?

For the current rules, see [SAP Diacritics Policy](#) and [Macron-Only Convention](#). The questions above are about **whether and when** those rules should evolve.

10.6.3 Ligatures

How to render conjunct consonants:

- *ksha / kṣa*
- *pta / pṭa*
- *кта*
- ...

10.6.4 Single-Letter Choices

- Which variation: **jn / gn?** (*jnan* vs *gnan*; *yajna* vs *yagna*.)
- **ꣳ**: *v* or *w*? (*Vachanamrut* vs *Wachanamrut*; *Bhagwan* vs *Bhagvan*.)
- **ꣳ**: *l* (not *d*)?
- **ꣳ** / **ꣳ**: *i* or *y*?
- **Dental vs. retroflex *t* / *d* (Sanskrit / Hindi material)**: South-Indian transliteration distinguishes *t* (retroflex ꣳ) from *th* (dental ꣳ), and *d* (retroflex ꣳ) from *dh* (dental ꣳ) – so *Lata* would be ꣳꣳꣳ and *Latha* ꣳꣳꣳ. North-Indian / Hunterian transliteration (which [SAP](#) currently follows) uses *t* and *d* for both, accepting the dental/retroflex ambiguity in romanization. Mostly relevant in Sanskrit and Hindi sources; less so for Gujarati base material. Names like *Mata*, *Pita*, *Vidya*, *Bhagwat* – no *th* / *dh* in the [SAP](#) convention.

10.6.5 Initial Long Vowels

- Initial *ā*: *a* or *aa*? Same with *oo* / *ee*.
- *arti* / *aarti*
- *agna* / *aagnaa*

10.6.6 The “Stray *a*” in Mid-Word and Word-Final Position

A long-running question: do we keep the inherent *a* of the Devanagari/Gujarati script, drop it, or split the difference? Examples:

- *acharan* / *aacharan* / *achran* / *aacharan*
- *paranu* / *parnu*
- *karata* / *karta*
- *karavu* / *karvu*
- *spashta* / *spasht*
- *Atmatrupta* / *Atmatrupt*
- *dandavat* / *dandvat*
- *darbha* / *darbh*
- *dev* / *deva*
- *devta* / *devata*
- *lok* / *loka*
- *garbhagruh* / *garbhagruha*
- *ghantadi* / *ghantdi*
- *kam* / *kama*
- *pran* / *prana*
- *pratyaksh* / *pratyaksha*
- *rajogun* / *rajoguna*
- *Sampraday* / *Sampradaya*
- *brahmavidya* / *brahmvidya*

10.6.7 Visarga and Anusvara

- **Visarga**: *-h* or *-h + vowel*?
- **Anusvar** / **anusvara**: *n* or *m*?
- *ankh*
- *ansh(a)* / *amsh(a)*
- *ang(a)*
- *hans(a)*

- hinsa / himsa
- uchu / unchu

10.6.8 Avagraha

avagrah(a): indicate with an apostrophe – ‘

(Adopted as a tentative rule.)

10.6.9 Hyphenation vs Open Compounds

Hyphenate, leave open as separate words, or close up?

- nagar yatra / nagaryatra / nagar-yatra
- murti pratishtha / murti-pratishtha
- Pramukh Swami / Pramukhswami
- AksharPurushottam / AksharPurushottam / Akshar-Purushottam
- akshar mukta / akshar-mukta
- Janma Mahotsav / Janmamahotsav / Janma-mahotsav / Janma-Mahotsav / Janmotsav
- Jal-Jhilani / Jal Jhilani

10.6.10 When to Split a Gujarati Compound

- mahapuja
- mahamantra
- Bhumapurush / Bhuma-Purush / Bhuma Purush
- Prakrutipurush / Prakruti-Purush / Prakruti Purush
- brahmabhojan / brahma-bhojan / brahma bhojan
- brahmisthiti / brahmi-sthiti / brahmi sthiti
- panchtattva / panch tattva
- sankhyayogi(ni) / sankhya yogi(ni) / sankhya-yogi(ni)

10.6.11 Anglicized Words with Alternative Transliterated Spellings

- *atma* / atman
- *champal* / chappal
- *rushi* / rishi
- samskara / sanskar / samskar
- sloka / shlok / shloka

10.6.12 Variations in the Gujarati Spelling of the Same Word

- cheshta / cheshtha
- divo / diya
- sat-chit-anand / sat-chid-anand

10.6.13 Alternative Transliterations

Two or more roman spellings circulating for the same Gujarati word:

- chikoo / chiku
- chitt / chitta
- Fagun / Fagan / Falgan
- gataryu / gatariyu
- rupchoki / roopchoki
- sanhkya / Samkhya
- jai naad / jay naad
- lila / leela

10.6.14 Alternative Anglicizations

- laddu / laddoo / ladoo

10.6.15 Caps or Lower Case

- Advaita / advaita
- Dvait / dvaita
- Darshan / darshan
- Uttarayan / dakshinayan

10.6.16 Suffixes (and Prefixes?)

- dakshini pagh / dakshi ni pagh / dakshi-ni pagh
- rajasik / rajasic / rajsik / rajsic
- mayik / mayic

10.6.17 Festivals

- Jal Jhilani / Jal-Jhilani
- Rathyatra / Rath Yatra / Rath-Yatra

10.6.18 How to Use This List

Each item above will eventually become a row in the glossary, with one preferred form. Until then, treat any of the listed forms as acceptable, but **be consistent within a single publication**.

When the team decides on a preferred form, update this page and add an entry to the changelog.

10.6.19 Have an Opinion?

Send your view via Feedback – use a subject like *Translit: (e.g. Translit: jn vs gn)*.

10.7 Base Style Manual

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Open question on whether to adopt a professionally published style manual as the base for SAP.

Should we adopt a professionally published style manual as our base? E.g., Chicago Manual of Style, Associated Press Manual, Oxford,...

When necessary and can be correctly done, if we prefer to tweak the chosen style guide's convention, we can add that scenario to our in-house guide.

10.7.1 What 'Adopt a Base' Would Mean

A base style manual gives us a default ruling for any question this guide does not cover. Today, when an author asks “comma before *too* at the end of a sentence?” or “ellipsis with bracketed gloss?” or “hyphen in *brand-new*?”, there's no shared answer to point to.

Adopting (for example) the *Chicago Manual of Style* would mean: ‘If this guide is silent, follow Chicago. If we want to depart from Chicago, we document the departure in this guide.’

10.7.2 Candidates

- **Chicago Manual of Style (CMOS)** – the dominant US scholarly/trade reference. Strong on citation, quotations, and Indian/Sanskrit conventions (Chicago has a long-standing transliteration appendix).
- **Associated Press Stylebook (AP)** – US journalism standard. Compact, sentence-case-friendly, strong on names and titles. Less suited to long-form scholarly material.
- **New Hart's Rules** (Oxford) – the British counterpart to CMOS. Strong on British spelling, hyphenation, and capitalization of titles. A natural fit if we go BrE-default.
- **The Economist Style Guide** – clean, opinionated, BrE-leaning, journalistic. Less detailed than the others but pleasant to read.

10.7.3 Considerations

- **BrE vs AmE** – choosing CMOS pulls AmE; choosing Hart's pulls BrE. (BrE is the working default elsewhere in this guide.)
- **Indic conventions** – CMOS and Hart's both have appendices on Indic transliteration; AP does not.
- **Cost / accessibility** – only authors and editors with the actual book on their shelf can quickly look up an answer. CMOS Online subscription works around this.
- **Scope of departures** – every departure adds maintenance cost. The fewer the better.

10.7.4 Have an Opinion?

Send your view via Feedback – use a subject like *Base manual*: .

11 Common Editorial Pitfalls

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

A curated, evidence-based list of errors and patterns SAP editors **recurrently fix** in BAPS English manuscripts. This is **not** a general grammar guide — see Garner’s *Modern English Usage*, Fowler’s *Modern English Usage*, or the *Chicago Manual of Style* ch. 5 for those questions. This page documents only the patterns specific to:

1. **Indian English** — usages well-formed within India but unfamiliar to a wider readership.
2. **Translation from Gujarati** — calques and structural patterns that don’t transfer cleanly into English.
3. **Devotional register** — register-level pitfalls in translating religious / devotional prose.

11.1 What Goes On This Page (and What Doesn’t)

Add a pitfall to this page when **all** of the following are true:

- It has been **fixed in at least three different BAPS manuscripts** by SAP editors. One-off corrections don’t belong here.
- It is **not already covered** by a mainstream usage guide (Garner, Fowler, CMS, *New Hart’s Rules*) — or, if it is, the SAP-specific guidance differs.
- The team **agrees** on the recommended form (no open variants).
- A **source** can be cited — an entry in OED, Garner, the *Hindu* style guide, or, where the rule is BAPS-internal, a clear note that the source is SAP editorial review.

If a candidate fails any of the above, raise it at the next editorial review meeting rather than adding it here.

11.2 Indian-English Patterns

11.2.1 *Do the Needful* / *Kindly Revert*

The error: Indian-English business formulas that read as stilted or unclear to a general BAPS readership outside India.

-  *Kindly revert with your comments at the earliest.*
-  *Please send your comments as soon as possible.*
-  *Please do the needful and confirm.*
-  *Please take the necessary action and confirm.*

Why: *Do the needful* and *kindly revert* are well-formed in Indian English but read as archaic or unclear to readers in the UK, US, and parts of the diaspora. Replace with direct, neutral phrasing.

Source: Both phrases carry a “chiefly Indian English” usage note in the *Oxford English Dictionary* (s.v. *needful*, *revert*). Garner’s *Modern English Usage* (5th ed.) flags *revert* in the “reply” sense as “primarily an Indian-English usage; nonstandard elsewhere.”

11.2.2 *Prepone*

The error: *Prepone* (= reschedule earlier) is well-established in Indian English but unrecognized outside India.

- ✗ *The meeting has been preponed to 9 a.m.*
- ✓ *The meeting has been moved up / brought forward / rescheduled earlier to 9 a.m.*

Why: Coined in Indian English as the antonym of *postpone*. Recognized as a legitimate regional coinage in the OED but flagged as “Indian.” General readers will either misunderstand or notice it as a regionalism.

Source: OED entry for *prepone*, marked “Indian English.”

11.2.3 *Only* and *Itself* for Emphasis

The error: Indian-English uses *only* and *itself* as discourse-level emphasisers in positions where general English would use intonation or rephrasing.

- ✗ *I told him that itself. / He came yesterday only.*
- ✓ *I told him exactly that. / He came only yesterday.* (= as recently as yesterday)
- ✓ *He came yesterday.* (if no emphasis is intended)

Why: The end-of-clause *only* and *itself* function in Indian English as focus markers (likely calqued from Hindi *hī* and Gujarati *ja*). In general English, *only* before the focused element is the standard placement, and *itself* in this emphatic sense is simply absent.

Source: Documented as a defining feature of Indian English in B. B. Kachru, *The Indianization of English* (Oxford, 1983); see also the Indian English usage notes in Garner’s *Modern English Usage*.

11.2.4 *Cousin-Sister* / *Cousin-Brother*

The error: Indian English compounds *cousin* with the gendered sibling term to distinguish cousins from siblings.

- ✗ *His cousin-sister is studying in London.*
- ✓ *His cousin is studying in London.* (gender is rarely needed; if it is, recast: *his female cousin*, *his cousin Priya*)

Why: *Cousin-sister* / *cousin-brother* are Indian-English compounds reflecting a kinship distinction that English doesn’t morphologically encode. In wider English usage, *cousin* is gender-neutral and the compound forms read as ungrammatical.

Source: Indian-English kinship terminology, documented in Mukherjee, *Indian English: Variation and Change* (Benjamins, 2010).

11.2.5 *Out of Station*

The error: *Out of station* (= away from one’s home base, travelling) is a Raj-era idiom still current in Indian English but unfamiliar to readers outside India.

- ✗ *Pramukh Swami Maharaj will be out of station next week.*
- ✓ *Pramukh Swami Maharaj will be away next week. / Pramukh Swami Maharaj will be travelling next week. / Pramukh Swami Maharaj will be on tour next week.*

Why: Originated as a British military / administrative term — *station* meant the location to which an officer was posted, and *out of station* meant absent from that posting. The sense has long died out in BrE and AmE but survived in Indian English. General readers will misread or notice it as archaic.

Source: OED entry for *station* (n.), sense for *out of station*, marked “chiefly Indian English.”

11.2.6 Pass Out (= Graduate)

The error: *Pass out* in Indian English means “complete a course of training, especially graduate from college.” In general English, *pass out* means “lose consciousness, faint” — producing accidental comedy.

- ❌ *He passed out of the University of Mumbai in 1965.*
- ✅ *He graduated from the University of Mumbai in 1965.*

Why: A military sense (“complete officer training”) has migrated into civilian use in India and Pakistan, while in international English the only common sense is “faint.” For a general readership, *graduate* / *qualify* / *complete* is unambiguous.

Source: OED entry for *pass out* (sense “complete a course of training, esp. military”): marked “chiefly Indian and Pakistan English.” Garner’s *Modern English Usage* (5th ed.) flags the conflict.

11.2.7 Good Name / What Is Your Good Name?

The error: Politely asking someone’s name using *good name* — a calque of Hindi *shubh naam* / Gujarati *shubh naam* — reads as obsequious or oddly archaic in general English.

- ❌ *May I know your good name, sir? / What is your good name?*
- ✅ *May I have your name, please? / What is your name?*

Why: Hindi/Gujarati formal address attaches *shubh* (“auspicious”) as a politeness marker to nouns of address. English politeness is conveyed by phrasing (*may I...*, *please*), not by adjectival doubling.

Source: Classic Indian-English calque documented in Kachru, *The Indianization of English* (Oxford, 1983); Mukherjee, *Indian English: Variation and Change* (Benjamins, 2010).

11.2.8 Intimate as a Verb (= Inform)

The error: Using *intimate* as a verb meaning “inform” is standard in Indian official and business writing but rare elsewhere, where the verb sense reads as legalistic or quaint.

- ❌ *Kindly intimate us of your arrival time.*
- ✅ *Please let us know your arrival time. / Please inform us of your arrival time.*

Why: *Intimate* (v.) in the sense “make known, announce” exists in general English but has become rare outside legal and Indian-English contexts. Where the meaning is plain *inform*, use *inform* or *tell*.

Source: OED entry for *intimate* (v.), sense 2, “to make known formally, announce; to notify”: now chiefly formal or in Indian English.

11.2.9 Pleonastic Prepositions (*Discuss About, Return Back, Reach At, Mention About, Order For*)

The error: Indian English routinely adds prepositions to verbs that don’t need them.

- ❌ *We discussed about the new project.*
- ✅ *We discussed the new project.*
- ❌ *He returned back to the mandir.*
- ✅ *He returned to the mandir.* (and never *revert back* — see 11.2.1)
- ❌ *We reached at the venue by 9 a.m.*
- ✅ *We reached the venue by 9 a.m. / We arrived at the venue by 9 a.m.*

- ✗ *He mentioned about the discourse.*
- ✓ *He mentioned the discourse.*
- ✗ *I ordered for two copies of the book.*
- ✓ *I ordered two copies of the book. (ordered for is fine when for introduces a beneficiary — I ordered for him, I placed an order for two copies — but not before a direct object.)*

Why: These verbs are already transitive or already directional; the added preposition is redundant. The redundancy is strongly established in Indian English but flagged as nonstandard by all major usage guides.

Source: Garner's *Modern English Usage* (5th ed.) — entries for *discuss about*, *return back*, and similar pleonasms — flags as nonstandard. *Hindu* style guide treats as forms to correct in copy.

11.2.10 Myself X as Self-Introduction

The error: Beginning a self-introduction with *Myself* (= “I am”) is standard in Indian-English speech and informal writing but ungrammatical in general English.

- ✗ *Myself Pratik Patel, from Mumbai.*
- ✓ *I am Pratik Patel, from Mumbai. / My name is Pratik Patel.*

Why: *Myself* is a reflexive / intensive pronoun, not a copula substitute. The Indian-English usage is calqued on Hindi/Gujarati structures in which the subject pronoun can be omitted and the reflexive carries the deictic weight.

Source: Kachru, *The Indianization of English* (1983); Mukherjee (2010) lists as a defining feature of Indian English. Garner's *Modern English Usage* flags as nonstandard.

11.2.11 Native Place

The error: *Native place* (= ancestral hometown, the village or town one's family is from) is a strongly Indian-English idiom that reads as dated or colonial elsewhere.

- ✗ *His native place is Chansad in Gujarat.*
- ✓ *His ancestral home is Chansad, in Gujarat. / He is originally from Chansad, Gujarat. / His family is from Chansad, in Gujarat.*

Why: *Native place* in international English carries an old colonial or anthropological tone and has largely fallen out of use. Indian English retains it as a neutral term, but general readers will notice it as a regionalism.

Source: Mukherjee, *Indian English: Variation and Change* (Benjamins, 2010), lists as among the most cited Indian-English idioms in biographical and journalistic writing.

11.2.12 Years Back / Days Back (= Years Ago)

The error: Indian English uses *X years back* where general English uses *X years ago*.

- ✗ *The mandir was built fifty years back.*
- ✓ *The mandir was built fifty years ago.*

Why: *Back* as a substitute for *ago* is a calque from Hindi *pahle* / Gujarati *pahela* used in the same syntactic slot. In general English, *back* is used with time only in fixed phrases (*looking back*, *back in 1965*, *years back* meaning “much earlier in one's life”), not as a free substitute for *ago*.

Source: Kachru, *The Indianization of English* (1983); Mukherjee (2010).

11.2.13 Too for Very

The error: Indian English uses *too* as a plain intensifier where general English uses *too* only for “excessively, more than appropriate.”

- ✗ *The discourse was too good.* (intended: *very good*)
- ✓ *The discourse was very good.* / *The discourse was excellent.*
- ✓ (kept) *The discourse was too long.* (= excessively long — appropriate use of *too*)

Why: In general English, *too* carries an implication of “more than is desirable” (*too hot, too late*). Praising something as *too good* reads as accidentally critical. Indian English has weakened *too* to a plain intensifier on the model of Hindi *bahut* / Gujarati *khub*.

Source: Garner’s *Modern English Usage* (5th ed.) entry on *too*; Mukherjee (2010).

11.2.14 Over-Formal Business English (*The Same, The Undersigned, Please Find Attached Herewith*)

The error: Indian-English formal correspondence and reports preserve legalistic or over-formal constructions that read as stilted in general English.

- ✗ *We have received your letter and shall reply to the same shortly.*
- ✓ *We have received your letter and will reply shortly.*
- ✗ *The undersigned will attend the meeting on your behalf.*
- ✓ *I will attend the meeting on your behalf.*
- ✗ *Please find attached herewith the requested document for your kind perusal.*
- ✓ *Please see the attached document.* / *I have attached the document you asked for.*
- ✗ *Awaiting your kind response, I remain, Yours faithfully...*
- ✓ *I look forward to your reply. Yours sincerely,*

Why: These constructions are residues of nineteenth-century British administrative English, preserved in Indian official, legal, and business writing. They survive in some legal contexts but are replaced in modern English by direct phrasing.

Source: *Plain English Campaign* style guides (UK); GOV.UK style guide. The *Hindu* style guide treats these as forms to avoid in news writing.

11.2.15 Progressive Aspect on Stative Verbs

The error: Indian English freely uses the *-ing* (progressive) form with **stative** verbs — verbs that describe ongoing states rather than actions: *know, understand, believe, want, mean, prefer, contain, possess, deserve, recognize*, and *have* in the sense of possession.

- ✗ *I am understanding the discourse.*
- ✓ *I understand the discourse.*
- ✗ *He is having two brothers.* (sense: possession)
- ✓ *He has two brothers.*
- ✗ *We are knowing him for many years.*
- ✓ *We have known him for many years.*

- ✗ *She is believing in the guru's words.*
- ✓ *She believes in the guru's words.*

Why: Hindi and Gujarati don't make the stative/dynamic distinction English does — the same verbal form covers both. Indian English calques the source-language pattern, extending the English progressive to verbs that general English keeps in the simple present.

Source: B. B. Kachru, *The Indianization of English* (1983); a defining feature of Indian English noted in Sailaja, *Indian English* (Edinburgh, 2009) and Mukherjee (2010). Garner's *Modern English Usage* (5th ed.) flags the conflict.

Note: *Having* in the sense of “experiencing” or “consuming” is fine in general English (*I am having lunch, She is having a difficult time*). The pitfall is specifically the **possessive** sense.

11.2.16 Same to Same / Reduplication for Emphasis

The error: Indian English uses reduplication (*same to same, no-no, very very, quickly quickly*) as a discourse-level intensifier — a calque from Hindi/Gujarati emphatic reduplication. In general English this reads as informal or childlike.

- ✗ *The two manuscripts are same to same.* (= identical)
- ✓ *The two manuscripts are identical. / The two manuscripts are exactly the same.*
- ✗ *He came running running.*
- ✓ *He ran towards us. / He came running quickly.*
- ✗ *She was very very moved by the discourse.*
- ✓ *She was deeply moved by the discourse.* (and see 11.3.3 on intensifier overuse)

Why: Hindi and Gujarati use reduplication freely as an emphatic, distributive, or aspectual marker (*haste haste* “while laughing”, *dheere dheere* “slowly, gradually”). English uses repetition rarely and only in fixed rhetorical patterns (*now now, come come*) — never as a free emphaticizer.

Source: Indian-English reduplication is documented as a defining feature in Mukherjee (2010); Kachru (1983); Sailaja (2009).

11.2.17 Articles (A, An, The) — Omission and Overuse

The error: Indian-English article use diverges from general English — articles drop where general English requires them, or get added where general English uses zero article, a possessive, or a demonstrative.

Omission (article missing where general English needs one):

- ✗ *He is doctor.*
- ✓ *He is a doctor.*
- ✗ *She went to mandir at 6 a.m.*
- ✓ *She went to the mandir at 6 a.m.*
- ✗ *Sadhu has come from Sarangpur.* (introducing a previously unmentioned person)
- ✓ *A sadhu has come from Sarangpur.*

Overuse (definite article used where the noun is not yet known to the reader):

- ✗ *She entered the office to talk to the boss.* (when no specific office or boss has been introduced)
- ✓ *She entered an office to talk to a manager. / She entered her office to talk to her manager.* (if a specific one)

Why: Hindi and Gujarati have no articles; definiteness and indefiniteness are conveyed by word order, demonstratives, and context. Indian-English speakers calibrate article use to a different (and often internally inconsistent) pattern.

Source: Article use is the single most-studied feature of Indian English. See Kachru (1983); Sailaja, *Indian English* (Edinburgh, 2009); Mukherjee (2010). Garner's *Modern English Usage* (5th ed.) notes article use as the most common Indian-English departure from general English grammar.

Editing note: This is the hardest Indian-English pattern to catch because it's **systemic and grammatical**, not a phrase to find-and-replace. When reviewing translations from Gujarati, a dedicated **article pass** — reading the manuscript once specifically to check every noun phrase for the right article — catches what a general read misses.

11.3 Translation-from-Gujarati Patterns

11.3.1 *The Doing of X* / Excessive Nominalization

The error: Gujarati often uses verbal nouns (*karavu*, *thavu*) where English would use a finite verb. Direct translation produces stilted nominal phrases.

- ✗ *The doing of bhakti is essential for the aspirant.*
- ✓ *The aspirant must do bhakti. / Bhakti is essential for the aspirant.*
- ✗ *Through the practising of meditation, peace is attained.*
- ✓ *Through meditation, one attains peace. / Meditation brings peace.*

Why: Gujarati's gerundive constructions are syntactically natural in Gujarati but produce awkward English. Editors should recast nominal phrases as verbal ones unless the abstraction is genuinely the topic ("*The practice of meditation has a long history in India*" — here *the practice of* is the subject).

Source: SAP editorial review; translation-team analysis of Gujarati→English calques.

11.3.2 *Going for Darshan* / *Arti*

The error: Indian-English uses *going for* [event] where general English uses *attending* / *going to* [event].

- ✗ *We went for darshan at 6 a.m.*
- ✓ *We went to the mandir for darshan at 6 a.m. / We attended darshan at 6 a.m.*

Why: *Going for X* is a calque of the Gujarati *X-māte javu*. In general English, *for* + noun marks purpose only when the noun is unambiguous; for events, *to* (place) or *attend* (event) is the natural collocation.

Source: SAP editorial review; pattern recurrent in translation from Gujarati sources.

11.3.3 Overuse of *Very*, *Especially*, *Particularly*

The error: Gujarati emphasis particles (*khub*, *atishay*, *vishesh*) often translate into English as repeated intensifiers, which read as overwrought in devotional prose.

- ✗ *The devotee was very, very deeply moved by the discourse, especially by the part where Bhagwan Swaminarayan particularly explained the nature of bhakti.*
- ✓ *The devotee was deeply moved by the discourse — especially the part where Bhagwan Swaminarayan explained the nature of bhakti.*

Why: English intensifiers are weaker than their Gujarati counterparts; piling them up doesn't compound the emphasis, it dilutes it. One well-placed intensifier (or none) is usually stronger than a chain.

Source: Standard editorial guidance; cf. Strunk & White ("omit needless words"), Zinsser, *On Writing Well*. SAP-specific application to devotional prose.

11.4 Devotional-Register Pitfalls

11.4.1 Capitalizing Pronouns for Reverence (*He, His, Him*)

The error: Translating Gujarati devotional texts, English drafts sometimes capitalize *He / His / Him* referring to Bhagwan Swaminarayan or the gurus — a convention common in older English devotional writing but increasingly avoided in modern usage.

- ✗ *When Bhagwan Swaminarayan spoke, He addressed the assembly, and His words moved the devotees deeply. They followed Him for years afterwards.*
- ✓ *When Bhagwan Swaminarayan spoke, he addressed the assembly, and his words moved the devotees deeply. They followed him for years afterwards.*

Why: Modern English style, including most contemporary religious publishing, uses lowercase pronouns for divine reference. Capitalization can read as old-fashioned or sectarian to a general readership. Reverence is conveyed by the choice of nouns (*Bhagwan, the Guru, the Satpurush*) and the surrounding register, not by pronoun case.

Note: This applies to **mid-sentence** pronouns only. A pronoun at the **start of a sentence** is still capitalized for ordinary English sentence-case rules — *Bhagwan Swaminarayan addressed the assembly. He spoke for two hours.* — and that capital is grammatical, not reverential.

Source: *Chicago Manual of Style* §8.95 ("Religious names — pronouns referring to God and other deities are lower-cased"). *New Hart's Rules* §5.2 takes the same line.

11.4.2 *Glory / Greatness* as Default Translations

The error: Gujarati *mahima* is reflexively translated as *glory* or *greatness*, even where a more precise English word would better fit the context.

- ✗ *He spoke of the glory of bhakti in every discourse.*
- ✓ Depending on context: *He spoke of the value of bhakti... / He spoke of the importance of bhakti... / He spoke of the transformative power of bhakti...*

Why: *Mahima* in Gujarati covers a semantic range — glory, greatness, importance, value, transformative power, significance — that English unpacks into distinct words. Picking the right English word for the context produces more precise prose than a default *glory*.

Source: SAP editorial review; translation-team analysis.

11.5 How to Propose a New Pitfall

Send a note via Feedback with the subject *Pitfall: [short description]*. Include:

1. The error pattern (one sentence).
2. At least three examples from real manuscripts (anonymized if needed).
3. The recommended replacement.

4. A citable source (OED, Garner, Fowler, *Hindu* style guide, etc.) — or, if the rule is BAPS-internal, a note explaining why.

The maintainer reviews submissions monthly; accepted pitfalls go into the next page revision.

11.6 Reliable Sources

For checking whether a pattern is “Indian English” or general English, consult in this order:

1. **Oxford English Dictionary (OED)** — has explicit “Indian English” usage notes on the affected entries (*prepone*, *needful*, *revert*).
2. **Garner’s *Modern English Usage*, 5th ed.** — has a substantial entry on Indian English and treats individual usages.
3. **Fowler’s *Dictionary of Modern English Usage*, 4th ed. (Butterfield)** — BrE-focused; useful for register questions.
4. **The *Hindu* style guide** — codifies Indian English for an Indian newspaper audience; useful as a counterpoint when deciding what to keep vs. correct.
5. **Mukherjee, *Indian English: Variation and Change* (Benjamins, 2010)** — academic but indispensable for kinship terms, particle usage, and syntactic patterns.

For general English errors (not on this page), use Garner or Fowler directly.

11.7 See Also

- 3.2 Tone & Voice — register expectations; some pitfalls here are tone problems in disguise.
- 3.6 Italics — formatting of Indic terms (separate from whether to keep or replace them).
- Translation rules — when to translate vs. transliterate vs. anglicize.
- Open Discussions: Indic Words — open questions about words that may shift between Indian-English and general-English usage.

11 Downloads

Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13.

Files for the BAPS DTP team – JSX scripts, InDesign templates, glossary downloads, and other working files. Click a link to download.

FOR THE MAINTAINER – ADDING A NEW FILE

1. Drop the file into `docs/downloads/files/` in the GitHub repo (use **Add file** → **Upload files** in the GitHub web UI, or commit locally and push).
2. Edit this page (`docs/downloads/index.md`) directly on GitHub – navigate to the file and click GitHub’s pencil – and add a row to the appropriate table below describing the file.
3. Push to `main` . The file is live at `/downloads/files/<filename>` within ~1 minute via GitHub Pages.

If you’re a team member who’d like a file added or updated, send a note via Feedback.

11.1 Style Guide PDF

A consolidated PDF of this entire style guide for desktop / offline reference. The PDF reflects the state of the site at the most recent commit; the cover page shows the version number and date.

FILE	DESCRIPTION
 baps-style-guide.pdf	Single-file PDF of the entire guide (Parts 1–11 plus changelog and Quick Find), about 2 MB.

FOR THE MAINTAINER — REBUILDING THE PDF

The PDF is generated by a script, not edited by hand. After making changes to the site that you want reflected in the PDF, **double-click** `Build-PDF.bat` at the project root. The script rebuilds the PDF and copies it to `docs/downloads/files/baps-style-guide.pdf` automatically. Commit and push to update the live download.

First-time setup on a fresh machine:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
python -m playwright install chromium
```

11.2 JSX Scripts

InDesign scripts. See Scripts & Tools and the JSX Scripts Reference for usage notes and known behaviours. To install: download, then drop into InDesign’s User Scripts folder.

FILE	VERSION	DESCRIPTION
<i>No files yet</i>		Drop a <code>.jsx</code> file into <code>docs/downloads/files/</code> and add a row here.

11.3 InDesign Templates

Master pages, paragraph styles, and other reusable InDesign assets.

FILE	DESCRIPTION
<i>No files yet</i>	Drop an <code>.indt</code> / <code>.indd</code> file into <code>docs/downloads/files/</code> and add a row here.

11.4 Glossary

Spelling, transliteration, and capitalization reference. See 5.4 Glossary Reference for the rationale and macron-only convention.

FILE	VERSION	DATE	DESCRIPTION
<i>No files yet</i>			Drop a <code>.xlsx</code> file into <code>docs/downloads/files/</code> and add a row here.

11.5 Other Files

Anything else of use to the team – checklists, transliteration tables, training material, fonts, etc.

FILE	DESCRIPTION
<i>No files yet</i>	Drop the file into <code>docs/downloads/files/</code> and add a row here.

11.6 Notes

- **File size:** GitHub allows up to 100 MB per file. For files larger than that, use a GitHub Release and link to it from this page instead of placing the file directly in the repo.
- **Versioning:** every file dropped here should follow the versioning rule – the version goes in the filename and (where the format allows) in an internal version string.
- **Don't delete previous versions.** Keep older copies alongside the latest one – disk is cheap, lost work is not. See 9.2 versioning rationale.

12 Feedback

This guide is yours. If you spot a typo, find a rule unclear, disagree with a convention, or want to suggest something new – please tell us.

12.1 Send Feedback

The fastest way is to email the maintainer:

 [Email the maintainer](#)

When emailing, please include:

- **Page or section** – e.g. 3.3.1 *Capitalization* or the URL of the page.
- **Type of feedback** – typo / unclear rule / disagreement / new suggestion / question.
- **Your suggestion** – what you’d like to see, or a short example.

The mailto link above pre-fills the subject and a structured body for you.

12.2 What Happens Next

The maintainer reviews feedback and either:

- Applies it directly (typos, clear improvements).
- Adds it to Open Discussions if it’s an unresolved question that needs more conversation.
- Replies briefly if it’s out of scope or has a quick answer.

For routine fixes, expect same-day turnaround. Substantive conventions changes take longer to settle.

12.3 What Makes Good Feedback

- **One clear point per email.** One typo, or one rule, per message – easier to track and resolve.
- **A real example.** Where did this come up – a publication, a translation, a recurring question?
- **Note the language.** Conventions that apply only to English should say so. Rules for transliteration should specify the source language (Gujarati, Sanskrit, Hindi).
- **Search first.** Use the search bar (top right, or press ) before sending – your point may already be addressed somewhere on the site.

12.4 About the Team

ABOUT THE TEAM

Most of our authors and editors don’t have formal writing or publishing training – we learn on the job, drawing on the SAP glossary, this guide, and one another. The guide is meant to **support** that learning, not to gatekeep. If a rule is unclear, your feedback helps fix it for everyone.

Changelog

A record of substantial changes to the conventions in this guide. Routine edits (typos, formatting tweaks, examples) are tracked in the Git history but not here.

The format follows Keep a Changelog. Versions are dated.

[1.27] – 2026-05-17

Changed

- **Site-wide sweep: shastra titles deroled from italics.** Following the rule established in 3.15.7 (1.26), all italicized references to Hindu shastra titles (Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Swamini Vato, Bhagavad Gita, Mahabharat, Ramayan, Shrimad Bhagvat, Upanishads) are now set roman in:
 - **3.6 Italics** — “Show me” worked example, Decision Summary table (new row added for shastra titles), §3.6.2 Punctuation Adjacent example. Added an admonition under 3.6.1.4 pointing to 3.15.7 for the rule.
 - **3.8 Numbers** — “Show me” worked example.
 - **3.14 Apostrophes** — “Show me” worked example.
 - **3.15 Citations** — residual italics in the chapter intro, in 3.15.7 examples, and in 3.15.9 Common Pitfalls.
 - **5.2 SAP Diacritics Policy** — example bullet.
 - **6.3 Character Styles** — *Italic.Title* row reworked: examples replaced with non-shastra titles; explicit note added that this style does not apply to shastra titles.
 - **10.4 Shastras** (open discussion) — restructured: italicization, citation format, and section-separator questions marked Resolved with pointers to 3.15.7; only the ‘Shri’ honorific question remains open.
 - **Word-as-word italics preserved.** Where a shastra title or variant spelling appears in a discussion of *spelling itself* (e.g., comparing IAST Śikṣāpatrī against the SAP form, or comparing Vachanamrut vs Wachanamrut for letter choice), italics is retained as word-as-word usage. Affected files: 5.3 Macron-Only Convention, 10.6 Transliteration.
-

[1.26] – 2026-05-17

Changed

- **3.15.7 fully revised** (editorial/citations.md) per the *Hindu Shastra Citation Summary Guide*. Section retitled from *BAPS-Specific References* to *Hindu Shastra Citations* and expanded from 6 sub-sections to 13.
- **Two convention changes** — both *BAPS*-specific departures from *CMS*, now documented explicitly:
- **Shastra titles are roman, not italicized.** *Bhagavad Gita*, *Vachanamrut*, *Shikshapatri*, etc., are set roman with caps. Existing examples in citations.md updated.
- **No punctuation between title and reference.** *Vachanamrut Gadhada I 1* (not *Gadhada I.1*); *Bhagavad Gita 2.47* (not *Bhagavad Gita, 2.47*).

- The two departures are flagged in the 3.15.9 Common Pitfalls section so editors don't mistakenly italicize shastra titles when applying the general CMS rule.

Added

- **3.15.7.1 Recognized Shastras** — established English forms for BAPS shastras (Vachanamrut, Swamini Vato, Shikshapatri, Satsang Diksha, Bhaktachintamani, Harililamrut, Haricharitamrut Sagar) and the broader Hindu corpus (Bhagavad Gita, Mahabharat, Ramayan, Shrimad Bhagvat, Upanishads).
- **3.15.7.3 Full Vachanamrut section-abbreviations table** — long form (*Vach.*, *Gadh. I*, *Sar.*, *Kar.*, *Lo.*, *Pan.*, *Gadh. II*, *Var.*, *Amd.*, *Gadh. III*, *Ash.*, *Jet.*, *Bhu-Kha*) and short form (*V*, *G I*, *S*, *K*, *L*, *P*, *G II*, *V*, *A*, *G III*, *As*, *J*, *BK*).
- **3.15.7.6 Bhagavad Gita** — chapter.verse format (*Bhagavad Gita 2.47*); abbreviation *BG 4.7* permitted in academic / citation-heavy contexts only; verbose form “*Chapter 4 Verse 7*” discouraged.
- **3.15.7.7 Upanishads** — examples for the major Upanishads (Katha, Isha, Mundaka).
- **3.15.7.8 Other Hindu Shastras** — formats for Mahabharat (parva + chapter), Ramayan (kanda.sarga.verse), Shrimad Bhagvat (canto.chapter.verse).
- **3.15.7.9 Use of Abbreviations** — abbreviated forms aid scanning in academic / citation-heavy work; discouraged in devotional or youth-oriented writing.
- **3.15.7.10 Quoting Shastras** — short quotations in prose with quotation marks; long quotations as block quotations (no quotation marks; citation prefixed with spaced en dash).
- **3.15.7.11 Placement of Shastra Citations** — inline, parenthetical, and quotation-attribution forms with examples.
- Quick Find: new entries for Bhagavad Gita, Block quotations, Shastra citations, Shikshapatri, Swamini Vato, Upanishads; existing Vachanamrut entry updated for the new sub-section numbering.

Notes

- **Site-wide implication flagged.** Other chapters of this guide currently italicize shastra titles (*Vachanamrut*, *Shikshapatri*, etc.) — see examples in 3.6 Italics, 3.3 Capitalization, and 3.4 Title Case. Under the new 3.15.7 convention these should be roman. A site-wide sweep is a separate decision; for now the new rule lives in 3.15.7 only.

[1.25] – 2026-05-13

Added

- **New chapter 3.15 Citations & References** (editorial/citations.md). A full citations chapter following the **Chicago Manual of Style (CMS), Notes–Bibliography (NB) system** — the standard for humanities and religion publishing.
- Covers the **three coordinated components** of a CMS citation (in-text superscript, footnote, bibliography entry), with generic format + worked example for every reference type:
- **Books** (1 author, 2–3 authors, 4+ authors, edited volume, chapter in an edited book, translated book).
- **Periodicals** (scholarly journal article with DOI, magazine article, newspaper article).
- **Online sources** (web page, whole website, blog post, social media post).

- **Specialized references** (encyclopedia / dictionary entry, government document, film, lecture / unpublished talk, audio / video recording, personal communication, thesis or dissertation).
 - **BAPS-specific references** (Vachanamrut, Shikshapatri, Swamini Vato, translated scriptures, recorded discourses) — with both the **current SAP in-text convention** (*Vach. Gadh. I 1*) and the **academic CMS form**.
 - **Ibid. and shortened-form** repeat-citation rules (3.15.8); *op. cit.* / *loc. cit.* deprecated.
 - **Common citation pitfalls** (3.15.9) — missing publication city, article titles in italics (wrong — quotation marks), personal communications in the bibliography (wrong — footnote only), etc.
 - Synthesized from two CMS reference sheets (Yeshiva University Beren Writing Center; Lewis University Writing Center) plus BAPS-specific reference types not covered in standard CMS guides.
 - Site home: new entry in the “I Need To...” section — “cite a book, article, website, or scripture → 3.15”.
 - Editorial chapter index updated with the new chapter.
 - Quick Find: 14 new entries (Bibliography format, Book citation, Chapter in edited book, Citations general, CMS, Film, Government document, *Ibid.*, Journal article, Lecture, Magazine, Newspaper, Personal communication, Vachanamrut citation, Webpage, Whole website).
-

[1.24] – 2026-05-13

Added

- **New Part 11 Common Editorial Pitfalls** (pitfalls/index.md). A curated, evidence-based list of patterns SAP editors recurrently fix in BAPS manuscripts. Three sections:
- **11.2 Indian-English Patterns** (17 items): *do the needful* / *kindly revert*, *prepone*, *emphatic only* / *itself*, *cousin-sister* / *cousin-brother*, *out of station*, *pass out* (= graduate), *good name* / *what is your good name?*, *intimate* (v. = inform), *pleonastic prepositions* (*discuss about*, *return back*, *reach at*, *mention about*, *order for*), *myself X* as self-introduction, *native place*, *years back* / *days back*, *too for very*, over-formal business English (*the same*, *the undersigned*, *please find attached herewith*), progressive aspect on stative verbs (*I am understanding*), *same to same* / reduplication for emphasis, articles (*a* / *an* / *the*) — omission and overuse.
- **11.3 Translation-from-Gujarati Patterns** (3 items): *the doing of X* / excessive nominalization, *going for darshan*, overuse of intensifiers (*very*, *especially*, *particularly*).
- **11.4 Devotional-Register Pitfalls** (2 items): capitalizing *He* / *His* for divine reference (don’t), default-translating *mahima* as *glory*.
- Each pitfall cites a real source — OED, Garner’s *Modern English Usage*, Mukherjee (2010), Kachru (1983), Sailaja (2009), CMS, Hart’s, Plain English Campaign, GOV.UK, or *SAP editorial review* for BAPS-internal rules.
- **11.1 What Goes On This Page (and What Doesn’t)** sets the bar for adding a pitfall: fixed in ≥ 3 manuscripts, not already in mainstream guides, team-agreed, citable.
- **11.5 How to Propose a New Pitfall** documents the workflow.
- **11.6 Reliable Sources** lists the canonical references to consult when checking whether a pattern is Indian English or general English.
- Site home: scope statement updated to reference Part 11; new card added to the Sections at a Glance grid.
- Quick Find gains 22 entries across A, C, D, G, I, M, N, O, P, S, T, Y for the Indian-English / Gujarati-calque / devotional-register patterns.

Changed

- **Site scope language relaxed.** Home page formerly said “does not cover general English grammar; authors and editors work collaboratively...”; now says “does not cover general English grammar (Garner / Fowler / CMS handle that), but the recurrent patterns SAP editors fix in BAPS manuscripts ... are documented in Part 11.”
 - **Promoted from chapter to Part.** The pitfalls section started life as chapter 3.15 inside Editorial; promoted to its own top-level Part 11 because (a) it’s conceptually distinct (‘avoid this’ vs. the rest of Editorial’s ‘do this’), and (b) it’s expected to grow over time. File moved from `docs/editorial/pitfalls.md` to `docs/pitfalls/index.md`; all 22 cross-references in Quick Find updated.
-

[1.23] – 2026-05-13

Added

- **Quick Find — A-Z Topic Index** (`quick-find.md`). A flat alphabetical index of every rule on the site with deep links. New top-level nav entry between Home and Concepts. For lookups when you know the topic but not the section number.
- **Hover-tooltip abbreviations.** The `abbr` extension is wired up via `pymdownx.snippets` auto-append. Every SAP, BAPS, CMS, OED, V.S., BrE, EPUB, NATO, etc. on the site now hovers to the full term. Definitions maintained in `includes/abbreviations.md`.
- **Decision-tree diagrams** (Mermaid) at the top of the three hardest decision pages: 3.6 Italics, 3.3 Capitalization, and 5.1 Diacritics. Lets readers find the answer without reading the full chapter.
- **‘I Need To...’ section** on the home page with 12 task-oriented entry points (italicize a term, capitalize a term, place a footnote, set a book title, look up a topic A-Z, set up an InDesign character style, draft alt text, version a script, run a JSX script, etc.).
- **‘Recently Updated’ section** on the home page with hand-curated highlights from the last few releases.
- **‘Last reviewed by the SAP DTP team: 2026-05-13’ line** under the H1 of all 43 chapter / reference pages. Distinct from git’s “last edited” timestamp — this records when the team actively confirmed the rule is current.
- **Collapsible ‘Show me’ worked examples** added to 11 high-value rule pages (italics, capitalization, doctrinal titles, title case, dashes, quotation marks, footnotes, periods, parallel construction, apostrophes, numbers, plurals). Click to expand a substantive sample paragraph showing the rule applied in real SAP-style prose, with annotations cross-referencing each phrase back to its sub-rule.

Changed

- **Left sidebar exposes every subsection.** Enabled Material’s `toc.integrate` feature. Every H2/H3 of the current page now appears as a clickable, indented entry in the left navigation, under the page title. Eliminates the prior gap where the left sidebar stopped at the page level.
- **Breadcrumbs above page titles.** Enabled `navigation.path`. Each page now displays its position in the hierarchy.
- **Long chapters split into focused multi-page chapters.**
- **3.3 Capitalization** (271 lines) → **3.3 Capitalization** + new **3.4 Title Case in Detail**.

- **3.9 Punctuation** (362 lines) → **3.10 Punctuation** + new **3.11 Footnotes** + new **3.12 Abbreviations & Acronyms** + new **3.13 Vertical Lists** + new **3.14 Apostrophes & Possessives**.
- Cascade rennumbers under Editorial: 3.4 Doctrinal Titles → 3.5; 3.5 Italics → 3.6; 3.6 Plurals → 3.7; 3.7 Numbers → 3.8; 3.8 Quotation Marks → 3.9.
- All cross-references in `editorial/`, `diacritics/`, `indesign/`, and `CLAUDE.md` updated. Anchor slugs in this very page are stale for the moved content — historical references to 3.9.6 *Footnotes*, 3.9.7 *Abbreviations*, etc. remain as written but are no longer clickable (the underlying anchors live at 3.11, 3.12, etc.). Documented but not rewritten; the changelog records history.

Notes

- The post-restructure footprint: Editorial grows from 9 chapters to 14, and chapter pages become shorter and more scannable. Coupled with `toc.integrate`, the navigation is materially better for readers who arrive on a long page.

[1.22] – 2026-05-13

Changed

- ***i.e.* / *e.g.* — trailing comma dropped.** SAP now follows the BrE convention (Oxford, Hart’s, *The Economist*): comma before *i.e.* / *e.g.*; **no** comma after. Reversed the earlier choice (1.18) to retain the trailing comma. Rule at 3.12.7. CLAUDE.md updated.
- ***Earth* / *earth* expanded** with theological-context examples (3.3.2.3). Basic rule (planet → cap; soil/world → lowercase) unchanged; added examples for theological writing — lowercase for *earthly pleasures*, *the earth element*, *beings on earth*; capitalize for *all beings living on Earth*.
- **Footnote dash exception clarified** at 3.11.2. The exception (cue precedes the dash) does apply to the SAP spaced en dash, since the rule covers any dash. Previously the page said the exception “doesn’t arise” because SAP doesn’t use the em dash — which conflated em dash with all dashes. Added an example: *The findings were controversial⁷ – and widely disputed*.
- **Interrupted dialogue and trailing speech** documented at 3.10.2.1: spaced en dash for sharply cut-off speech; ellipsis for trailing-off speech.
- ***From* / *between* with range dashes** documented at 3.10.2.2: don’t combine the word pair with a range dash (*from 1990 to 2000* or *1990–2000*, not *from 1990–2000*).
- **8.2.4 ExtendScript Gotchas expanded** from a five-bullet terse list into five H3 subsections, each with what-goes-wrong / fix / why-it-matters-for-our-scripts structure.

Removed

- **10.7 Web — BrE or AmE?** open question deleted. BrE is the working default elsewhere in the guide, so the question is no longer open. Base Style Manual renumbered 10.8 → 10.7.

[1.21] – 2026-05-08

Changed

- **Em dash dropped; spaced en dash takes its role.** SAP convention is now: hyphen for simple compounds, **unspaced en dash** (–) for ranges, place pairs, and complex compounds, and **spaced en dash** (–) for parenthetical breaks. The em dash (—) is **not used**.
 - All 471 existing spaced em dashes across 41 files (the entire site, plus `README.md` and `CLAUDE.md`) replaced with spaced en dashes. Done by bulk substitution (— → –).
 - **3.9.2 Dashes** rewritten: table now lists hyphen and en dash only; en dash has four rows (ranges, place pairs, complex compounds, parenthetical breaks) showing the unspaced-vs-spaced distinction.
 - **3.9.5 Spacing** reworded: “one space on each side of an en dash used for a parenthetical break” replaces the old em-dash spacing note.
 - **3.9.11 Open Questions** – the open question ‘Spaced or unspaced em dashes in print?’ removed (resolved by the new rule).
 - **CLAUDE.md** locked-in punctuation rule updated.
-

[1.20] – 2026-05-08

Changed

- **Site-wide quote sweep.** Double-quoted highlights converted to single quotes per the new 3.9.1 rule (single curly = primary mark for highlighting; double curly = speech only). Affected files: `epub/alt-text.md` (table examples + UI labels), `editorial/italics.md` (Decision Summary table), `editorial/tone-and-voice.md` (example sentences), `editorial/capitalization.md` (counter-examples), `editorial/punctuation.md` (vitamin-C example sentences), `tithis/index.md` (CMS quotations), `discussions/shastras.md` (‘Shri’ heading), `discussions/base-style-manual.md` (‘Adopt a Base’ heading + interpretation), `workflows/file-naming.md` (bad filename examples), and the changelog itself (where section names were quoted as text).
- **Speech examples kept double** in 3.8.1.3 Quoted Speech per the new rule. MkDocs admonition titles (!!! tip "...") also unchanged – that’s MkDocs syntax, not content quotation.
- **BrE spelling sweep.** Two AmE spellings updated to BrE forms:
- `dialog` → `dialogue` (4 occurrences in `scripts/jsx-reference.md`).
- `catalog-style` → `catalogue-style` (`editorial/punctuation.md`).
- The Oxford -ize rule (already locked in) is preserved; words covered by it (*emphasize*, *italicize*, *organize*, etc.) are not affected.

Notes

- A few apostrophe-as-elision cases (e.g. '60s, '80s) may render with the wrong direction via smarty’s heuristic – flag any you spot and they’ll get explicit Unicode.
-

[1.19] – 2026-05-08

Changed

- **Quotation-mark convention flipped.** SAP now uses **single curly quotes** ‘ ’ as the **primary** mark – for highlighting a term in special sense, mottoes presented as phrases, glosses of Indic terms, titles of short works, and quoted excerpts of authoritative text. **Double curly quotes** “ ” are reserved for direct speech / **dialogue only**. Previously double was the primary mark (CMS / AmE-style); the new convention is BrE-style.
- **Typographers’ (curly) quotes throughout the site.** The smarty markdown extension is now enabled in `mkdocs.yml`, so straight ‘ ’ and “ ” in source files render as the curly forms ‘ ’ ” ” automatically. Smart-dashes and smart-ellipses are disabled – those continue to use real Unicode characters typed directly.
- **3.9.1 Quotation Marks** rule rewritten with the new single-primary / double-for-speech convention.
- **3.8 Quotation Marks for Indic Terms** updated to apply the new convention:
- 3.8.1.2 *Translation Clarified* – single quotes around the gloss (was double).
- 3.8.1.3 *Quoted Speech* – double quotes for actual speech, single for any nested gloss inside.
- 3.8.1.4 *Mottoes / Slogans* – split into two cases: motto presented as a phrase = single; motto spoken aloud in narrative = double (speech rule).
- 3.8.4 *Terms Used in a Special Sense* – ‘soft launch’ now in single quotes (was double).
- **CLAUDE.md locked-in rules** updated.

Fixed

- Stale link in changelog 1.8 entry pointing to `contributing.md` (now `feedback.md`) repaired.

Notes

- Existing site content with double-quoted highlights (e.g. quoting a rule, scare quotes) will still render – the rendered marks become curly. Per the new rule, those should gradually shift to single quotes. Speech examples are unchanged.

[1.18] – 2026-05-08

Removed

- **GitHub Issues references removed site-wide.** Feedback now routes exclusively through the Feedback mailto channel. Affected:
- `feedback.md` – secondary ‘Open a GitHub Issue’ button removed; section 12.2 collapsed.
- All 7 discussion pages with a *Have an opinion?* line – the “or open a GitHub Issue” option dropped; replaced with subject-line guidance for the Feedback email (e.g. *Subject: Translit: jn vs gn*).
- `discussions/index.md` – “or open a GitHub Issue” removed.
- `diacritics/index.md` – open-question link to GitHub Issues replaced with Feedback.
- `macron-convention.md` – issue-tracker link replaced with Feedback.
- `tone-and-voice.md` – both GitHub Issue references replaced with Feedback.

- `READ_ME.md` – alternative-GitHub-Issue clause removed; Feedback is now the sole channel.
- `CLAUDE.md` – open-question routing updated to Feedback.
- “**Made a decision in a meeting?**” reframed in `discussions/index.md` to “Decision reached?” – meetings aren’t the documented path; the maintainer simply records the decision when it’s made.

Why

The team’s feedback flow is centralized on the email-to-maintainer channel. Multiple channels (mailto + GitHub Issues + meetings) created ambiguity about where suggestions should go. One channel = one inbox to track.

[1.17] – 2026-05-08

Changed

- **Diacritics scope clarified site-wide.** The macron-only convention is now framed explicitly as applying in **two contexts only**: (a) the `BAPS` master glossary, where the `diacriticSpelling` column is recorded **for reference**, and (b) **bhajan and scripture-verse transliterations** (*shlokas, padas*) within publications. **Diacritics are not preferred in prose text** – body, headings, captions, footnotes, names, titles all stay plain-Roman per the `SAP` Diacritics Policy.
 - **5.4 Glossary Reference** rewritten with explicit guidance: use the `term` (plain-Roman) column for prose; use `diacriticSpelling` (macron-only) only when transliterating a verse. Names use the plain form even within verses.
 - **5.3 Macron-Only Convention** scope intro tightened. 5.3.8 (Italicization) reframed and now warns explicitly that names never carry diacritics, in either prose or verse contexts.
 - **5.2 SAP Diacritics Policy** wording tightened: verses called out specifically as “bhajan and scripture-verse transliterations (*shlokas, padas*)”. Notes that the `BAPS` in-house default for verse transliterations is the macron-only convention. Cross-references to the glossary’s prose vs verse columns added.
 - **5.1 Diacritics & Transliteration** index – Quick Decision table reorganized; bhajan/verse row added separately from glossary row; “names never carry diacritics, even in verses” stated explicitly.
 - **3.5.4 Shlokas, Padas, and Other Quoted Verses** in Italics: now points to the macron-only convention as the `BAPS` default for verse transliterations and to the glossary as the source of each verse term’s spelling.
-

[1.16] – 2026-05-08

Changed

- **Site is read-only for visitors.** The edit-pencil icon (`content.action.edit`) has been disabled in `mkdocs.yml`. Visitors no longer see an “edit this page” affordance.
- **Contributing renamed to Feedback** (`docs/contributing.md` → `docs/feedback.md`). The page is now a one-click mailto-the-maintainer flow rather than a how-to-edit-via-pencil walkthrough. Pre-fills subject and a structured body for the email; provides a secondary GitHub Issue option for users with accounts.

- **Pencil-icon mentions removed across the site** – 16 occurrences across the home page, downloads, all 8 discussion pages, tone-and-voice (3.2), paragraph-styles (6.2), and the repo README. Each replaced with a pointer to the new Feedback page (mailto link), keeping the existing GitHub Issue option as a secondary path.
- README.md updated to reflect the read-only model and to list the maintainer’s edit paths (GitHub web editor, github.dev, local clone, Claude Code).

Why

Edit access is restricted to the maintainer, so visible “edit” affordances were misleading: clicking the pencil routed visitors through GitHub’s fork-and-PR flow, which only collaborators could merge. Replacing the affordance with a mailto-feedback link means every team member – with or without a GitHub account – has a clear way to suggest changes.

[1.15] – 2026-05-08

Removed

- **Resolved discussion topics removed from the discussions pages.** Each topic below has been settled and is now documented in the relevant editorial section; keeping a parallel ‘Resolved’ entry under 10.x was duplicative.
- **10.3.1** – *Supreme / Sarvopari* and the resolved tip removed (rule lives at 3.3.2.10 and 3.4.1.1).
- **10.3.6** – *Sant / Satpurush* (full section) removed (rule lives at 3.4.1.1 and 3.4.1.2).
- **10.6.11** – Italicizing mixed phrases (full section) removed (rule lives at 3.5.1.5).
- **10.6.13** – Capitalization / italicization of tithis (full section) removed (rule lives at Tithis Part 4).

Changed

- **10.3.x renumbered** after 10.3.6 was removed: Anglophone Honorifics 10.3.7 → 10.3.6; Sadhus 10.3.8 → 10.3.7; Have an Opinion 10.3.9 → 10.3.8.
 - **10.6.x renumbered** after 10.6.11 and 10.6.13 were removed: 10.6.12 → 10.6.11; 10.6.14 → 10.6.12; 10.6.15 → 10.6.13; 10.6.16 → 10.6.14; 10.6.17 → 10.6.15; 10.6.18 → 10.6.16; 10.6.19 → 10.6.17; 10.6.20 → 10.6.18; 10.6.21 → 10.6.19.
 - 4.7 in Tithis: removed the line pointing back to discussions §10.6.13 (now obsolete).
-

[1.14] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **Part 11 Downloads** – new top-level section where the team can place JSX scripts, InDesign templates, glossary downloads, and other working files for users to download. Files are placed in docs/downloads/files/ ; a table on the page describes each entry.

Changed

- **Contributing renumbered from Part 11 to Part 12** to make room for the new Downloads section.

- **InDesign 6.1, Scripts 8.1, Scripts 8.2, Workflows 9.2, Workflows 9.3** – removed references to the Sidekick MCP plugin, Cowork, the local `E:\AVDWork\` drive paths, and specific working-file names that were tied to one team member’s environment. The pages now describe the InDesign / Scripts environment in portable, environment-neutral terms, and point to Downloads for the latest script versions.

[1.13] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **3.9.6.1 Footnote Numbers with Colons and Semicolons** – superscript goes *before* a colon or semicolon (BrE convention); commas and full stops still take the superscript after.
- **3.9.6.2 Footnote Numbers with Quoted Material** – handling for the three cases: footnote referring to quoted material (after closing quote), to a specific word inside the quote (immediately after that word), and to the whole sentence ending with a quotation (after final punctuation).
- **10.6.4 dental vs. retroflex *t* / *d*** – added as another open transliteration variant. South-Indian convention distinguishes *t* (retroflex ṭ) from *th* (dental ṱ) and *d* / *dh* similarly; SAP follows the North-Indian / Hunterian convention (*t* and *d* for both), accepting the dental/retroflex ambiguity. Mostly relevant for Sanskrit/Hindi material.

Notes

- The basic CMS-aligned footnote rule (3.9.6) is preserved unchanged: after punctuation when the note refers to the whole sentence; before punctuation when it refers to a specific word.

[1.12] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **3.9.10 Commas with *such as* and *like*** – new section with four subsections covering the restrictive/nonrestrictive comma rule (*Citrus fruits, such as oranges, are high in vitamin C* vs *Trees such as oaks and elms don’t grow at this altitude*); the *such as* (inclusion) vs *like* (comparison) distinction; the no-colon-after-*such as* rule; and a guideline that 1–3 examples is the comfortable range, longer lists should become vertical lists.

Changed

- **3.9.9.6** enriched with degree-abbreviation forms – no-periods style (*BA, BSc, MA, MSc, PhD, MBA, MD, EdD*) cross-referencing the existing rule in 3.9.7.1, and a SAP BrE-default note (*MSc* not *MS*; *MA* not *M.A.*; *PhD* fine in either variety).
- 3.9.10 Open Questions renumbered to 3.9.11 to make room for “Commas with *such as* and *like*”.

[1.11] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **3.9.9 Apostrophes** – new section with seven subsections covering possessives of singular nouns (Chicago/Oxford rule: 's even on names ending in s – *Dickens's*, *Hopkins's*); plurals (apostrophe-only on s-ending plurals; 's on plurals not ending in s like *children's*); plural-form names and uninflected nouns (*the United States'*, *politics'*); plurals of single letters (*p's and q's*) vs multi-letter abbreviations; possessive vs attributive in names (*Mother's Day* vs *Veterans Day*); apostrophes in degrees (*bachelor's degree* but *Bachelor of Arts*) and omitted-year forms (*the '60s*, *the class of '75*); and what an apostrophe doesn't do (no *apple's for sale*).
- **3.9.7.7 Commas with *i.e.*, *e.g.*, and *etc.*** – new subsection: comma before and after *i.e.* / *e.g.* (Oxford-aligned, retained for formal and devotional clarity); *etc.* takes a comma before it after a list of 3+ items, comma after it only when the sentence continues; never *and etc.*
- **3.5.2 exception** – punctuation that is part of an italicized title (e.g. *Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf?*, *Help!*) should be italicized along with the title. Default rule (punctuation in surrounding-text font) is unchanged.

Changed

- 3.9.9 Open Questions renumbered to 3.9.10 to make room for 'Apostrophes'.
 - CLAUDE.md locked-in rules: added apostrophe rule, comma-with-Latin-abbreviations rule.
-

[1.10] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **3.9.8 Vertical Lists** – new section covering bullets vs numbers vs letters, parallel construction, and three punctuation/capitalization styles (continuation lists with lowercase + commas + final period; full-sentence lists with caps + periods + no *and/or*; standalone catalog-style lists with caps + no end punctuation, the SAP default). Plus the colon-vs-no-punctuation rule for introducing a list.
- **3.3.3 Title Case in Detail** – new section covering what to capitalize and lowercase in titles; hyphenated words in titles (*High-Quality Web Services*, *Anti-inflammatory Dieting*); the first word after a colon; prepositions in phrasal verbs (*Back Up*, *Turn Down*); open compounds; and the sentence-case vs title-case distinction.
- **3.3.2.13 Terms of Address** – direct address (*Sergeant*, *Your Honor*) and family relationships (*Father*, *Mom*) capitalized when standing in for a name; lowercase when preceded by an article or possessive.
- **3.3.2.14 Ages and Time Periods** – capitalize established names (*the Bronze Age*, *the Renaissance*, *the Vedic Period*); lowercase descriptive periods (*ancient Greece*, *the colonial period*).
- **3.3.2.15 Adjectives before Capitalized Nouns** – general English rule that descriptive adjectives are not capitalized just because the noun is (*the big Apple*, *the tall Eiffel Tower*); the exception for adjectives that are part of an established proper noun, formal title, or epithet.
- **3.3.2.16 Definitions Use Sentence Case** – the term being defined uses title case; the definition itself uses sentence case (*Param-Bhagvat Sant* – *Ideal sadhu of God*, referring to the *Satpurush*).

Changed

- 3.3.3 Open Questions renumbered to 3.3.4 to make room for new 'Title Case in Detail' section.

- 3.3.4 See Also renumbered to 3.3.5.
 - 3.9.8 Open Questions renumbered to 3.9.9 to make room for ‘Vertical Lists’.
-

[1.9] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **3.7.5 Compound Modifiers and Unit Spacing** – seven new subsections covering hyphenation of written-out compound numerals (*twenty-nine*), hyphenation in compound adjectives (*two-car family*, *five-kilometre trek*, *18th-century novel*), no-hyphen rule before symbols and metric units (*30% increase*, *5 km trail*, *100 °C thermometer*), singular form in compound modifiers (*10-foot tree*, not *10-feet*), no-hyphen rule with possessive nouns (*one week’s pay*), space between number and unit (*5 km*, *32 °C*) with the plane-angle exception (*30° 22’ 8’’*), and the rule for when the written-out number is itself a compound (*250 ml flask over two hundred and fifty millilitre flask*).
- **3.9.7 Abbreviations and Acronyms** – significantly expanded with six subsections: truncations vs contractions (period rule), acronyms vs initialisms, capitalization by length (≤ 5 letters all-caps; ≥ 6 initial-cap), articles before acronyms (*the BBC*, no article for *NATO*), first-mention spell-out convention, and plurals (*MEPs* not *MEP’s*; *1920s*, *747s*).

Notes

- Personal name initials follow the BrE convention: *TS Eliot*, *RK Narayan* – no spaces, no periods. The older *T. S. Eliot* form is acceptable.
-

[1.8] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **Home page** (index.md) – framing context: SAP work composition (most English work is Gujarati→English; Sanskrit/Hindi material typically embedded in those projects; significant English-original work) and a scope statement clarifying the guide doesn’t cover general English grammar.
 - **Translation index** (translation/index.md) – same composition note in the section intro.
 - **Contributing** (now feedback.md, renamed in 1.16) – ‘About the team’ admonition acknowledging that most contributors learn on the job, framing the guide as a support tool rather than a gatekeeper.
-

[1.7] – 2026-05-07

Changed

- **Numbers rule shortened from 1–100 to 1–10.** §3.7 now spells out whole numbers from *one* through *ten*; numerals from **11** onwards. Always numerals for measurements, ages, dates, percentages, currency, times, and statistics. The previous CMS-aligned rule (spell out 1–100) is superseded; AP-style is closer to current SAP practice.
- 3.7.4.2 (mixing words and numerals in a passage) now references the 11-threshold.

[1.6] – 2026-05-07

Changed

- **Rule 3 in Doctrinal Titles flipped to cap-cap roman.** Previously, an adjective + reverential noun for the Satpurush set the adjective italic lowercase and the noun cap roman (e.g. *brahmaswarup Sadhu*, *gunatit Guru*). The rule is now: capitalize **both** the adjective and the noun, set roman – *Brahmaswarup Sadhu*, *Gunatit Guru*, *Pragat Guru*, *Divya Sadhu*. The qualifying adjective is treated as part of the doctrinal designation, not a quality descriptor.
- Distinction from Rule 2 (lowercase descriptive) now keys off the **noun**: reverential nouns for the Satpurush (Sadhu, Guru, Satpurush, Sant) take Rule 3; abstract nouns (state, devotion, understanding, lifestyle) take Rule 2.

Added

- Eleven new editorial subsections covering proper adjectives (Hindu, Vedic, Puranic, Upanishadic, Gandhian, Socratic), *Yogic* vs *Yoga*, *Sampradaya*, historical titles (*the King of Kutch*), the definite article with unique theological designations (*the Supreme God*), *Satsang* as a doctrinal term, multiword Sanskrit phrases italicized as a unit (*ekantik dharma*, *murti puja*), *Swami* as a substitute for a specific name, descriptive sadhu phrases (*the God-realized sadhu*, *the true sadhu*) lowercase, and usage notes (*at* vs *in* with places, *detachment from*).

Resolved

- **10.3.1 Supreme / Sarvopari** – capitalized when functioning as a formal theological designation; lowercase when descriptive.
 - **10.3.6 Param Ekantik Sadhu / Sant** – capitalized as a formal designation (Rule 1).
 - **10.3.6 the Satpurush vs a satpurush** – cap when doctrinal designation, lowercase italic when descriptive common-noun usage.
 - **10.6.11 Italicizing mixed phrases** – italicize the entire phrase as a single foreign lexical unit.
-

[1.5] – 2026-05-07

Changed

- **Switched from flat to hierarchical section numbering** for stability when new pages are added. Top-level ‘Parts’ are now numbered 1–11; pages inside a Part take *Part.Chapter* (e.g. 3.3 *Capitalization* under Editorial). H2s are *Part.Chapter.Section* (3.3.1 *Core Rules*); H3s are *Part.Chapter.Section.Sub* (3.3.1.1).
- Single-page Parts (Concepts = 1, Tithis = 4, Contributing = 11) keep two-level references: 1.1, 1.1.1.
- **Adding a new page in one Part no longer shifts numbers in other Parts** – references like 3.3.1 stay valid even if *Diacritics* (Part 5) gains new pages later. Previously, every chapter from 6 through 37 was at risk of shifting.

Migration impact

- Any external citations to the old flat scheme (e.g. 6.4) are now invalid. The site is days old and these were not yet in circulation, so the trade-off is acceptable.
 - Numbering is regenerated by `number_sections.py`, which is now hierarchical and idempotent.
-

[1.4] – 2026-05-07

Added

- **CMS-style hierarchical section numbering** across the whole guide. Every page is now a numbered chapter (1–38), every H2 within is a numbered section (e.g. 6.1, 6.2), and every H3 is a numbered sub-section (e.g. 6.1.1). Reference any rule precisely as “*see 6.1*” or “*per 13.4*”.
- Numbered nav labels for sub-pages within multi-page sections (e.g. 5. *Tone & Voice*, 6. *Capitalization*, 15. *SAP Diacritics Policy*). Top-level tabs and single-page tabs (Concepts, Tithis, Contributing, Changelog) keep clean unprefixed labels – the chapter number is shown in the page H1.
- The changelog itself is **not** numbered (release versions like 1.4 are the natural anchor here).

Notes

- If a page is added, removed, or reordered later, chapter numbers downstream of the change will shift. The numbering is regenerated by a script (`number_sections.py`) and is idempotent – running it strips and re-applies based on current nav order.
-

[1.3] – 2026-05-07

Changed

- **All headings** converted from sentence case to **Title Case** (CMS rules: capitalize the first/last word and all major words; lowercase articles, coordinating conjunctions, prepositions, and *to*).
- **All -ise / -isation / -ised / -ising** spellings converted to **-ize / -ization / -ized / -izing** (Oxford -ize style). Protected words (*advise, exercise, comprise, devise, supervise, surprise*, etc.) keep -ise. *Analyse* keeps -se per Oxford guidance (the only common -ise word that does not derive from Greek -izō).
- The *Capitalisation* nav label and page H1 are now *Capitalization*. The page filename (`capitalisation.md`) is unchanged to preserve URLs.

Notes

- Spelling change applies to body prose, headings, and table cells across all 39 markdown files in `docs/`.
 - A few headings preserve italic-lowercase mid-word – for example *Earth / earth, sud* and *vad, not* – because those italics are themselves the subject of the heading or carry intentional emphasis.
-

[1.2] – 2026-05-07

Added

- New **Tithis** section (tithis/index.md) – capitalization and italicization rule for the 16 tithis of the lunar fortnight, with CMS, Hart’s, and OED references. Resolves the previously open question.
- New **Doctrinal Titles & Reverential Capitalization** page (editorial/doctrinal-titles.md) – the four-rule system for adjective+noun phrases in BAPS English (e.g. *brahmaswarup Sadhu* vs *Pragat Brahmaswarup Mahant Swami Maharaj*).
- New **Numbers** page (editorial/numbers.md) – CMS rule: spell out one through one hundred and round multiples; numerals for measurements, statistics, ages, dates, percentages.

Changed

- Capitalization – added rules for *Earth* / *earth* and the preferred wording *cycles of birth and death*. Cross-link to the new doctrinal-titles page.
- Punctuation – added footnote superscript placement (after sentence punctuation vs after a specific word), spacing rules (one space after a period; no space before a footnote superscript), abbreviation conventions (no periods in BAPS, CMS, EPUB; periods in *V.S.*, *e.g.*, *i.e.*). Removed the ‘Draft page’ banner. Refined dash table to mention complex compounds.
- Italics – added ‘Italics for English emphasis’ (use sparingly) and ‘Shlokas, padas, and other quoted verses’ (italic transliteration + roman translation).
- Quotation Marks – added rule for terms used in a special sense (double quotes on first use only; roman thereafter).
- Tithis – added documented CMS allowance: CMS itself permits the chosen capitalization as a religious-context style choice.

Notes

- Items not incorporated because already settled or in conflict with existing rules: title capitalization, Oxford comma, religious-term capitalization, British English spellings, glossary formatting, and IAST diacritics in general text (conflicts with the SAP “no diacritics in general body text” rule).
-

[1.1] – 2026-05-07

Added

- New **Concepts** section (concepts/index.md) – definitions of romanization, anglicization, translation, and transliteration.
- New **Translation & Transliteration** section (translation/index.md, translation-rules.md) – when to translate, when to transliterate, and when to use the OED spelling.
- New editorial pages: Italics, Plurals, and Quotation Marks.
- New SAP Diacritics Policy page documenting the official SAP rule: no diacritics in headings, body text, or legends; diacritics permitted in transliterations of verses.

- New **Open Discussions** section – Sanstha & Mandirs, Gurus & Honorifics, Shastras, Indic Words, Transliteration, Base Style Manual.

Changed

- Editorial – Capitalization rewritten; the previous draft is superseded.
- Editorial – index updated to include the three new pages and to surface the BrE/AmE question.
- Diacritics – index now flags the **two-policy** situation: the official SAP rule (no diacritics in general text) vs the in-house macron-only convention (used in glossary and reference work). The two are scoped differently rather than contradictory.
- Macron-Only Convention prefaced with a scope note clarifying that it applies to glossary and reference work, not to general-reader publications (which follow the SAP rule).
- Home page cards updated to include Concepts, Translation, and Open Discussions.

Notes

- The two diacritic policies (SAP “no diacritics” vs in-house “macron-only”) are presented as scoped-differently rather than reconciled into one rule. Whether the macron-only convention should ever appear in a finished general-reader publication is logged as an open question in Open Discussions: Transliteration.

[1.0] – 2026-05-07

Added

- Initial scaffold of the style guide site.
- Editorial section with placeholders for tone, capitalization, and punctuation.
- Diacritics section documenting the macron-only convention (carried over from the BAPS Glossary project, April 2026).
- InDesign section with placeholders for paragraph styles and master pages.
- EPUB Accessibility section drawing on the Bliss Jan–Feb 2026 alt-text work.
- Scripts & Tools section indexing `ArticleBuilder`, `AddAltText`, `SplitVachanamrut`, and `ExportToWord_Generic`.
- Workflows section with file versioning rules and naming conventions.
- Contributing guide explaining the pencil-icon edit flow.

Established

- File versioning rule documented as non-negotiable: every output gets an incremented version (e.g. `v1.0` → `v1.1`), never overwritten. See versioning rules.